

سِفْرُ الحِكمة

يوناني – انكليزي - عربي

The Book of Wisdom

Greek - English - Arabic

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الأصحاح الأول

ΑΓΑΠΗΣΑΤΕ δικαιοσύνην, οἱ κρίνοντες τὴν γῆν, φρονήσατε περὶ τοῦ Κυρίου ἐν ἀγαθότητι, καὶ ἐν ἀπλότῃ καρδίᾳ ζητήσατε αὐτόν· 2 ὅτι εὐρίσκεται τοῖς μὴ πειράζουσιν αὐτόν, ἐμφανίζεται δὲ τοῖς μὴ ἀπιστοῦσιν αὐτῷ. 3 σκολιοὶ γὰρ λογισμοὶ χωρίζουσιν ἀπὸ Θεοῦ, δοκιμαζομένη τε ἡ δύναμις ἐλέγχει τοὺς ἄφρονας. 4 ὅτι εἰς κακότεχνον ψυχὴν οὐκ εἰσελεύσεται σοφία, οὐδὲ κατοικήσει ἐν σώματι κατὰχρεω ἁμαρτίας· 5 ἅγιον γὰρ πνεῦμα παιδείας φεύξεται δόλον καὶ ἀπαναστήσεται ἀπὸ λογισμῶν ἀσυνέτων καὶ ἐλεγχθήσεται ἐπελθούσης ἀδικίας. 6 φιλάνθρωπον γὰρ πνεῦμα σοφία καὶ οὐκ ἀθρώσει βλάσφημον ἀπὸ χειλέων αὐτοῦ· ὅτι τῶν νεφρῶν αὐτοῦ μάρτυς ὁ Θεὸς καὶ τῆς καρδίας αὐτοῦ ἐπίσκοπος ἀληθῆς καὶ τῆς γλώσσης ἀκουστής· 7 ὅτι πνεῦμα Κυρίου πεπλήρωκε τὴν οἰκουμένην, καὶ τὸ συνέχον τὰ πάντα γνῶσιν ἔχει φωνῆς. 8 διὰ τοῦτο φθεγγόμενος ἄδικα οὐδεὶς μὴ λάθῃ, οὐδὲ μὴ παροδεύσῃ αὐτὸν ἐλέγχουσα ἡ δίκη. 9 ἐν γὰρ διαβουλίῳς	1 Love uprightness you who are rulers on earth, be properly disposed towards the Lord and seek him in simplicity of heart; 2 for he will be found by those who do not put him to the test, revealing himself to those who do not mistrust him. 3 Perverse thoughts, however, separate people from God, and power, when put to the test, confounds the stupid. 4 Wisdom will never enter the soul of a wrong-doer, nor dwell in a body enslaved to sin; 5 for the holy spirit of instruction flees deceitfulness, recoils from unintelligent thoughts, is thwarted by the onset of vice. 6 Wisdom is a spirit friendly to humanity, though she will not let a blasphemer's words go unpunished; since God observes the very soul and accurately surveys the heart, listening to every word. 7 For the spirit of the Lord fills the world, and that which holds everything together knows every word said. 8 No one who speaks what is wrong will go undetected,	1 أَحِبُّوا الْعَدْلَ، يَا قُضَاةَ الْأَرْضِ، وَاعْتَقِدُوا فِي الرَّبِّ خَيْرًا، وَالتَّمَسُّوهُ بِقُلُوبٍ سَلِيمٍ. 2 فَإِنَّمَا يَجِدُهُ الَّذِينَ لَا يَجْرِبُونَهُ، وَيَتَجَلَّى لِلَّذِينَ لَا يَكْفُرُونَ بِهِ. 3 لِأَنَّ الْأَفْكَارَ الزَّائِغَةَ تَقْصِي مِنَ اللَّهِ، وَاخْتِبَارَ قُدْرَتِهِ يَتَقَفَّ الْجَهَالُ. 4 إِنَّ الْحِكْمَةَ لَا تَلْجُ النَّفْسَ السَّاعِيَةَ بِالْمَكْرِ، وَلَا تَحِلُّ فِي الْجَسَدِ الْمُسْتَرْقِ لِلْخَطِيئَةِ. 5 لِأَنَّ رُوحَ التَّأْدِيبِ الْقُدُّوسِ يَهْرَبُ مِنَ الْغَشِّ، وَيَتَحَوَّلُ عَنِ الْأَفْكَارِ السَّفِيهِةِ، وَيَنْهَزُ إِذَا حَضَرَ الْإِثْمُ. 6 إِنَّ رُوحَ الْحِكْمَةِ مُحِبٌّ لِلْإِنْسَانِ؛ فَلَا يَبْرِئُ الْمُجْدَفَ مِمَّا نَطَقَ، لِأَنَّ اللَّهَ نَاطِرٌ لِكَلِمَتَيْهِ وَرَقِيبٌ لِقَلْبِهِ لَا يَغْفُلُ وَسَامِعٌ لَفَمِهِ. 7 لِأَنَّ رُوحَ الرَّبِّ مَلَأَ الْمَسْكُونَةَ، وَوَأَسَعَ الْكُلَّ عِنْدَهُ عِلْمٌ كُلِّ كَلِمَةٍ. 8 فَلِذَلِكَ لَا يَخْفَى عَلَيْهِ نَاطِقٌ بِسَوْءٍ، وَلَا يَنْجُو مِنَ الْقَضَاءِ الْمَفْحَمِ. 9 لَكِنْ سَيَفْحَصُ عَنْ أَفْكَارِ الْمُنَافِقِ، وَكُلُّ مَا سَمِعَ مِنْ أَقْوَالِهِ يَبْلُغُ إِلَى الرَّبِّ فَيُحْكَمُ عَلَى آثَامِهِ،
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ἀσεβοῦς ἐξέτασις ἔσται, λόγων
 δὲ αὐτοῦ ἀκοή πρὸς Κύριον ἤξει
 εἰς ἔλεγχον ἀνομημάτων
 αὐτοῦ. 10 ὅτι οὕς ζηλώσεως
 ἀκροᾶται τὰ πάντα, καὶ θροῦς
 γογγυσμῶν οὐκ ἀποκρύπτεται.
 11 φυλάξασθε τοίνυν
 γογγυσμὸν ἀνωφελῇ καὶ ἀπὸ
 καταλαλιᾶς φείσασθε
 γλώσσης· ὅτι φθέγμα λαθραῖον
 κενὸν οὐ πορεύσεται, στόμα δὲ
 καταψευδόμενον ἀναιρεῖ
 ψυχὴν. 12 μὴ ζηλοῦτε θάνατον
 ἐν πλάνῃ ζωῆς ὑμῶν, μηδὲ
 ἐπισπᾶσθε ὄλεθρον ἔργοις
 χειρῶν ὑμῶν. 13 ὅτι ὁ Θεὸς
 θάνατον οὐκ ἐποίησεν, οὐδὲ
 τέρεται ἐπ' ἀπωλείᾳ ζώντων.
 14 ἔκτισε γὰρ εἰς τὸ εἶναι τὰ
 πάντα, καὶ σωτήριοι αἱ γενέσεις
 τοῦ κόσμου, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν ἐν
 αὐταῖς φάρμακον ὀλέθρου οὔτε
 ἄδου βασίλειον ἐπὶ γῆς. 15
 δικαιοσύνη γὰρ ἀθάνατός
 ἐστιν. 16 Ἀσεβεῖς δὲ ταῖς χερσὶ
 καὶ τοῖς λόγοις
 προσεκαλέσαντο αὐτόν, φίλον
 ἡγησάμενοι αὐτὸν ἐτάκησαν
 καὶ συνθήκην ἔθεντο πρὸς
 αὐτόν, ὅτι ἄξιοί εἰσι τῆς ἐκείνου
 μερίδος εἶναι.

nor will avenging Justice pas
 s by such a one.

9 For the schemes of the
 godless will be examined,
 and a report of his
 words will reach the Lord to
 convict him of his crimes.
 10 There is a jealous ear
 that overhears everything,
 not even a murmur of
 complaint escapes it.
 11 So beware of uttering
 frivolous complaints,
 restrain your tongue from
 finding fault; even what is
 said in secret has
 repercussions, and
 a lying mouth deals death to
 the soul.
 12 Do not court death by
 the errors of your ways, nor
 invite destruction through
 the work of your hands.
 13 For God did not make
 Death, he takes no pleasure
 in destroying the living.
 14 To exist -- for this he
 created all things; the
 creatures of the world have
 health in them, in them is no
 fatal poison, and Hades has
 no power over the world:
 15 for uprightness is
 immortal. But the godless
 call for Death with deed and
 word, counting him friend,
 they wear themselves out
 for him; with him they make
 a pact, worthy as they are to
 belong to him.

10 لِأَنَّ الْأُذُنَ الْغَيْرَى تَسْمَعُ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ، وَصِيَاحُ الْمُتَذَمِّرِينَ لَا يَخْفَى عَلَيْهَا.

11 فَاحْتَرِزُوا مِنَ التَّذَمُّرِ الَّذِي لَا خَيْرَ فِيهِ، وَكُفُّوا أَلْسِنَتَكُمْ عَنِ الثَّلْبِ؛ فَإِنَّ الْمُنْطَوِّقَ بِهِ فِي الْخُفْيَةِ لَا يَذْهَبُ سُدًى، وَالْفَمُ الْكَاذِبُ يَقْتُلُ النَّفْسَ.

12 لَا تَغَارُوا عَلَى الْمَوْتِ فِي ضَلَالِ حَيَاتِكُمْ، وَلَا تَجْلِبُوا عَلَيْكُمُ الْهَلَكَ بِأَعْمَالِ أَيْدِيكُمْ، إِذْ لَيْسَ الْمَوْتُ مِنْ صُنْعِ اللَّهِ، وَلَا هَلَكَ الْأَحْيَاءُ يَسْرَهُ.

14 لِأَنَّهُ إِنَّمَا خَلَقَ الْجَمِيعَ لِلْبَقَاءِ؛ فَمَوَالِيدُ الْعَالَمِ إِنَّمَا كُونَتْ مُعَافَاةً، وَلَيْسَ فِيهَا سَمٌ مُهْلِكٌ، وَلَا وِلَايَةٌ لِلْجَحِيمِ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ،

15 لِأَنَّ الْبِرَّ خَالِدٌ. 16 لَكِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ هُمْ اسْتَدْعَوُا الْمَوْتَ بِأَيْدِيهِمْ وَأَقْوَالِهِمْ. ظَنُّوهُ حَلِيفًا لَهُمْ فَاضْمَحَلُّوا، وَإِنَّمَا عَاهَدُوهُ لِأَنَّهُمْ أَهْلٌ أَنْ يَكُونُوا مِنْ حِزْبِهِ.

الأصاح الثاني

ΕΙΠΟΝ γὰρ ἐν ἑαυτοῖς λογισάμενοι οὐκ ὀρθῶς· ὀλίγος ἐστὶ καὶ λυπηρὸς ὁ βίος ἡμῶν, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν ἱασις ἐν τελευτῇ ἀνθρώπου, καὶ οὐκ ἐγνώσθη ὁ ἀναλύσας ἐξ ἄδου. 2 ὅτι αὐτοσχεδίως ἐγεννήθημεν, καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο ἐσόμεθα ὡς οὐχ ὑπάρξαντες· ὅτι καπνὸς ἢ πνοὴ ἐν ρισὶν ἡμῶν, καὶ ὁ λόγος σπινθήρ ἐν κινήσει καρδίας ἡμῶν, 3 οὗ σβεσθέντος τέφρα ἀποβήσεται τὸ σῶμα καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα διαχυθήσεται ὡς χαῦνος ἀήρ. 4 καὶ τὸ ὄνομα ἡμῶν ἐπιλησθήσεται ἐν χρόνῳ, καὶ οὐθεὶς μνημονεύσει τῶν ἔργων ἡμῶν· καὶ παρελεύσεται ὁ βίος ἡμῶν ὡς ἵχνη νεφέλης καὶ ὡς ὀμίχλη διασκεδασθήσεται διωχθεῖσα ὑπὸ ἀκτίνων ἡλίου καὶ ὑπὸ θερμότητος αὐτοῦ βαρυνθεῖσα. 5 σκιᾶς γὰρ πάροδος ὁ βίος ἡμῶν, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν ἀναποδισμὸς τῆς τελευτῆς ἡμῶν, ὅτι κατεσφραγίσθη, καὶ οὐδεὶς ἀναστρέφει. 6 δεῦτε οὖν καὶ ἀπολαύσωμεν τῶν ὄντων ἀγαθῶν καὶ χρῆσώμεθα τῇ κτίσει ὡς ἐν νεότητι σπουδαίως. 7 οἶνου	¹ And this is the false argument they use, 'Our life is short and dreary, there is no remedy when our end comes, no one is known to have come back from Hades. ² We came into being by chance and afterwards shall be as though we had never been. The breath in our nostrils is a puff of smoke, reason a spark from the beating of our hearts; ³ extinguish this and the body turns to ashes, and the spirit melts away like the yielding air. ⁴ In time, our name will be forgotten, nobody will remember what we have done; our life will pass away like wisps of cloud, dissolving like the mist that the sun's rays drive away and that its heat dispels. ⁵ For our days are the passing of a shadow, our end is without return, the seal is affixed and nobody comes back. ⁶ 'Come then, let us enjoy the good things of today, let us use created things with the zest of youth: ⁷ take our fill of the dearest wines and perfumes, on no account forgo the flowers of spring ⁸ but crown ourselves with	1 فَإِنَّهُمْ بَزِغَ أَفْكَارِهِمْ قَالُوا فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ: «إِنَّ حَيَاتَنَا قَصِيرَةٌ شَقِيَّةٌ، وَلَيْسَ لِمَمَاتِ الْإِنْسَانِ مِنْ دَوَاءٍ، وَلَمْ يَعْلَمْ قَطُّ أَنَّ أَحَدًا رَجَعَ مِنَ الْحَيَمِ. 2 إِنَّا وَلِدْنَا اتِّفَاقًا، وَنَكُونُ مِنْ بَعْدُ كَأَنَّا لَمْ نَكُنْ قَطُّ، لِأَنَّ النَّسَمَةَ فِي أَنْفَانَا دُخَانٌ، وَالنُّطْقَ شَرَارَةٌ مِنْ حَرَكَةِ قُلُوبِنَا. 3 فَإِذَا انْطَفَأَتْ عَادَ الْجِسْمُ رَمَادًا، وَأَنْحَلَّ الرُّوحُ كَنَسِيمٍ رَقِيقٍ، وَزَالَتْ حَيَاتُنَا كَأَثَرِ غَمَامَةٍ، وَاضْمَحَلَّتْ مِثْلَ ضَبَابٍ يَسُوقُهُ شُعَاعُ الشَّمْسِ، وَيَسْقُطُ بِحَرِّهَا، 4 وَبَعْدَ حِينٍ يَنْسَى اسْمُنَا، وَلَا يَذْكُرُ أَحَدٌ أَعْمَالَنَا. 5 إِنَّمَا حَيَاتُنَا ظِلٌّ يَمْضِي، وَلَا مَرْجِعَ لَنَا بَعْدَ الْمَوْتِ؛ لِأَنَّهُ يَخْتَمُ عَلَيْنَا فَلَا يَعُودُ أَحَدٌ. 6 فَتَعَالَوْا نَتَمَتَّعْ بِالطَّيِّبَاتِ الْحَاضِرَةِ، وَنَتَبَدَّرِ مَنَافِعَ الْوُجُودِ مَا دُمْنَا فِي الشَّبَابِ، 7 وَنَتَرَوْا مِنَ الْخَمْرِ الْفَاحِرَةِ، وَنَتَضَمَّخَ بِالْأَدْهَانِ، وَلَا تَفْتَنَّا زَهْرَةٌ
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πολυτελοῦς καὶ μύρων πλησθῶμεν, καὶ μὴ παροδευσάτω ἡμᾶς ἄνθος ἀέρος. 8 στεψώμεθα ρόδων κάλυξι πρὶν ἢ μαρανθῆναι. 9 μηδεὶς ἡμῶν ἄμοιρος ἔστω τῆς ἡμετέρας ἀγερωγίας, πανταχῇ καταλίπωμεν σύμβολα τῆς εὐφροσύνης, ὅτι αὕτη ἡ μερὶς ἡμῶν καὶ ὁ κληῖρος οὗτος. 10 καταδυναστεύσωμεν πένητα δίκαιον, μὴ φεισώμεθα χήρας, μηδὲ πρεσβύτου ἐντραπῶμεν πολιάς πολυχρονίους. 11 ἔστω δὲ ἡμῶν ἡ ἰσχὺς νόμος τῆς δικαιοσύνης, τὸ γὰρ ἀσθενὲς ἄχρηστον ἐλέγχεται. 12 ἐνεδρεύσωμεν δὲ τὸν δίκαιον, ὅτι δύσχρηστος ἡμῖν ἐστι καὶ ἐναντιοῦται τοῖς ἔργοις ἡμῶν καὶ ὀνειδίζει ἡμῖν ἀμαρτήματα νόμου καὶ ἐπιφημίζει ἡμῖν ἀμαρτήματα παιδείας ἡμῶν. 13 ἐπαγγέλλεται γινῶσιν ἔχειν Θεοῦ καὶ παῖδα Κυρίου ἐαυτὸν ὀνομάζει. 14 ἐγένετο ἡμῖν εἰς ἔλεγχον ἐννοιῶν ἡμῶν· βαρὺς ἐστὶν ἡμῖν καὶ βλεπόμενος, 15 ὅτι ἀνόμοιος τοῖς ἄλλοις ὁ βίος αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐξηλλαγμέναι αἱ τρίβοι αὐτοῦ. 16 εἰς κίβδηλον ἐλογίσθημεν αὐτῷ, καὶ	rosebuds before they wither, ⁹ no meadow excluded from our orgy; let us leave the signs of our revelry everywhere, since this is our portion, this is our lot! ¹⁰ 'As for the upright man who is poor, let us oppress him; let us not spare the widow, nor respect old age, white-haired with many years. ¹¹ Let our might be the yardstick of right, since weakness argues its own futility. ¹² Let us lay traps for the upright man, since he annoys us and opposes our way of life, reproaches us for our sins against the Law, and accuses us of sins against our upbringing. ¹³ He claims to have knowledge of God, and calls himself a child of the Lord. ¹⁴ We see him as a reproof to our way of thinking, the very sight of him weighs our spirits down; ¹⁵ for his kind of life is not like other people's, and his ways are quite different. ¹⁶ In his opinion we are counterfeit; he avoids our ways as he would filth; he proclaims the final end of the upright as blessed and boasts of having God for his father. ¹⁷ Let us see if what he says is true, and test him to see what sort of	الأوان، 8 وَتَكَلَّلَ بِالْوَرْدِ قَبْلَ ذُبُولِهِ، وَلَا يَكُنْ مَرَجٌ إِلَّا تَمَرَ لَنَا فِيهِ لَذَّةٌ. 9 وَلَا يَكُنْ فِينَا مَنْ لَا يَشْتَرِكُ فِي لَذَاتِنَا، وَلِنَتْرَكَ فِي كُلِّ مَكَانٍ آثَارَ الْفَرَحِ؛ فَإِنَّ هَذَا حِطُّنَا وَنَصِينَا. 10 لِنَجْرَ عَلَى الْفَقِيرِ الصَّادِقِ، وَلَا نَشْفُقَ عَلَى الْأَرْمَلَةِ، وَلَا نَهَبَ شَبِيَّةَ الشَّيْخِ الْكَثِيرِ الْأَيَّامِ. 11 وَلِتَكُنْ قُوَّتُنَا هِيَ شَرِيعَةُ الْعَدْلِ؛ فَإِنَّهُ مِنَ الثَّابِتِ أَنَّ الضَّعْفَ لَا يَغْنِي شَيْئًا. 12 وَلِنَكْمُنْ لِلصَّادِقِ؛ فَإِنَّهُ ثَقِيلٌ عَلَيْنَا يَقَاوِمُ أَعْمَالَنَا، وَيَقْرَعُنَا عَلَى مُخَالَفَتِنَا لِلنَّامُوسِ، وَيَفْضَحُ ذُنُوبَ سِيرَتِنَا. 13 يَزْعُمُ أَنَّ عِنْدَهُ عِلْمَ اللَّهِ، وَيَسْمِي نَفْسَهُ ابْنَ الرَّبِّ. 14 وَقَدْ صَارَ لَنَا عَدُوًّا حَتَّى عَلَى أَفْكَارِنَا. 15 بَلْ مَنْظَرُهُ ثَقِيلٌ عَلَيْنَا، لِأَنَّ سِيرَتَهُ تَخَالَفُ سِيرَةَ النَّاسِ، وَسَبْلُهُ تَبَايِنٌ سَبْلِهِمْ. 16 قَدْ حَسَبْنَا كَرِيُوفَ؛ فَهُوَ يَجَانِبُ طَرَفَنَا مُجَانِبَةَ الرَّجْسِ،
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ἀπέχεται τῶν ὁδῶν ἡμῶν ὡς
ἀπὸ ἀκαθαρσιῶν· μακαρίζει
ἔσχατα δικαίων καὶ
ἀλαζονεύεται πατέρα Θεόν.
17 ἴδωμεν εἰ οἱ λόγοι αὐτοῦ
ἀληθεῖς, καὶ πειράσωμεν τὰ
ἐν ἐκβάσει αὐτοῦ· 18 εἰ γάρ
ἐστὶν ὁ δίκαιος υἱὸς Θεοῦ,
ἀντιλήψεται αὐτοῦ καὶ
ρύσεται αὐτὸν ἐκ χειρὸς
ἀνθεστηκότων. 19 ὕβρει καὶ
βασάνῳ ἐτάσωμεν αὐτόν,
ἵνα γνῶμεν τὴν ἐπιείκειαν
αὐτοῦ καὶ δοκιμάσωμεν τὴν
ἀνεξικακίαν αὐτοῦ· 20
θανάτῳ ἀσχήμονι
καταδικάσωμεν αὐτόν,
ἔσται γὰρ αὐτοῦ ἐπισκοπὴ
ἐκ λόγων αὐτοῦ. 21 Ταῦτα
ἐλογίσαντο, καὶ
ἐπλανήθησαν· ἀπετύφλωσε
γὰρ αὐτοὺς ἡ κακία αὐτῶν,
22 καὶ οὐκ ἔγνωσαν
μυστήρια Θεοῦ, οὐδὲ μισθὸν
ἠλπισαν ὁσιότητος, οὐδὲ
ἐκρίναν γέρας ψυχῶν
ἀμώμων. 23 ὅτι ὁ Θεὸς
ἐκτίσε τὸν ἄνθρωπον ἐπὶ
ἀφθαρσία καὶ εἰκόνα τῆς
ιδίας ιδιότητος ἐποίησεν
αὐτόν· 24 φθόνῳ δὲ
διαβόλου θάνατος εἰσηλθεν
εἰς τὸν κόσμον, 25
πειράζουσι δὲ αὐτὸν οἱ τῆς
ἐκείνου μερίδος ὄντες.

end he will have.

18 For if the upright man is God's son, God will help him and rescue him from the clutches of his enemies.

19 Let us test him with cruelty and with torture, and thus explore this gentleness of his and put his patience to the test.

20 Let us condemn him to a shameful death since God will rescue him -- or so he claims.'

21 This is the way they reason, but they are misled, since their malice makes them blind.

22 They do not know the hidden things of God, they do not hope for the reward of holiness, they do not believe in a reward for blameless souls.

23 For God created human beings to be immortal, he made them as an image of his own nature;

24 Death came into the world only through the Devil's envy,

25 As those who belong to him find to their cost.

وَيَغْبِطُ مَوْتَ الصَّادِقِينَ، وَيَتَبَاهَى
ب أَنَّ اللَّهَ أَبُوهُ.

17 فَلْنَنْظُرْ هَلْ أَقْوَالُهُ حَقٌّ؟
وَلْنَخْتَبِرْ كَيْفَ تَكُونُ عَاقِبَتُهُ؟

18 فَإِنَّهُ إِنْ كَانَ الصَّادِقُ ابْنَ اللَّهِ؛
فَهُوَ يَنْصُرُهُ وَيَنْقِذُهُ مِنْ أَيْدِي
مُقَاوِمِيهِ.

19 فَلْنَمْتَحِنْهُ بِالشَّتْمِ وَالْعَذَابِ،
حَتَّى نَعْلَمَ حِلْمَهُ وَنَخْتَبِرَ صَبْرَهُ،
20 وَلْنَقْضِ عَلَيْهِ بِأَقْبَحِ مِيتَةٍ؛ فَإِنَّهُ
سَيَفْتَقِدُ كَمَا يَزْعُمُ.

21 هَذَا مَا ارْتَأَوْهُ فَضَلُّوا؛ لِأَنَّ
شَرَّهُمْ أَعْمَاهُمْ،

22 فَلَمْ يَدْرِكُوا أَسْرَارَ اللَّهِ، وَلَمْ
يَرْجُوا جَزَاءَ الْقِدَاسَةِ، وَلَمْ يَتَعَبَّرُوا
ثَوَابَ النُّفُوسِ الطَّاهِرَةِ.

23 فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ خَالِدًا،
وَصَنَعَهُ عَلَى صُورَةِ ذَاتِهِ،

24 لَكِنْ بِحَسَدِ إِبْلِيسَ دَخَلَ
الْمَوْتُ إِلَى الْعَالَمِ،

25 فَيَذُوقُهُ الَّذِينَ هُمْ مِنْ حِزْبِهِ.

الأصحاح الثالث

ΔΙΚΑΙΩΝ δὲ ψυχὰι ἐν χειρὶ Θεοῦ, καὶ οὐ μὴ ἄψηται αὐτῶν βάσανος. 2 ἔδοξαν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖς ἀφρόνων τεθνάναι, καὶ ἐλογίσθη κάκωσις ἢ ἔξοδος αὐτῶν 3 καὶ ἢ ἀφ' ἡμῶν πορεία σύντριμμα, οἱ δὲ εἰσιν ἐν εἰρήνῃ. 4 καὶ γὰρ ἐν ὄψει ἀνθρώπων ἐὰν καλασθῶσιν, ἢ ἐλπίς αὐτῶν ἀθανασίας πλήρης· 5 καὶ ὀλίγα παιδευθέντες μεγάλα εὐεργετηθήσονται, ὅτι ὁ Θεὸς ἐπείρασεν αὐτοὺς καὶ εὗρεν αὐτοὺς ἀξιούς ἑαυτοῦ· 6 ὡς χρυσὸν ἐν χωνευτηρίῳ ἐδοκίμασεν αὐτοὺς καὶ ὡς ὀλοκάρπωμα θυσίας προσεδέξατο αὐτούς. 7 καὶ ἐν καιρῷ ἐπισκοπῆς αὐτῶν ἀναλάμψουσι καὶ ὡς σπινθήρες ἐν καλάμῃ διαδραμοῦνται· 8 κρινουῦσιν ἔθνη καὶ κρατήσουσι λαῶν, καὶ βασιλεύσει αὐτῶν Κύριος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας. 9 οἱ πεποιθότες ἐπ' αὐτῷ συνήσουσιν ἀλήθειαν, καὶ οἱ πιστοὶ ἐν ἀγάπῃ προσμενουῦσιν αὐτῷ, ὅτι χάρις καὶ ἔλεος ἐν τοῖς	¹ But the souls of the upright are in the hands of God, and no torment can touch them. ² To the unenlightened, they appeared to die, their departure was regarded as disaster, ³ their leaving us like annihilation; but they are at peace. ⁴ If, as it seemed to us, they suffered punishment, their hope was rich with immortality; ⁵ slight was their correction, great will their blessings be. God was putting them to the test and has proved them worthy to be with him; ⁶ he has tested them like gold in a furnace, and accepted them as a perfect burnt offering. ⁷ At their time of visitation, they will shine out; as sparks run through the stubble, so will they. ⁸ They will judge nations, rule over peoples, and the Lord will be their king for ever. ⁹ Those who trust in him will understand the truth, those who are faithful will live with him in love; for grace and mercy await his holy ones, and he intervenes on behalf of his	1 أَمَّا نَفُوسُ الصَّادِقِينَ فَهِيَ بِيَدِ اللَّهِ، فَلَا يَمَسُّهَا الْعَذَابُ. 2 وَفِي ظَنِّ الْجُهَالِ أَنَّهُمْ مَاتُوا، وَقَدْ حَسِبَ خُرُوجُهُمْ شَقَاءً، 3 وَذَهَابُهُمْ عَنَا عَطْبًا، أَمَّا هُمْ فَفِي السَّلَامِ. 4 وَمَعَ أَنَّهُمْ قَدْ عَوِقُوا فِي عَيُونِ النَّاسِ؛ فَجَاؤُهُمْ مَمْلُوءٌ خُلُودًا، 5 وَبَعْدَ تَأْدِيبٍ يَسِيرٍ لَهُمْ ثَوَابٌ عَظِيمٌ، لِأَنَّ اللَّهَ امْتَحَنَهُمْ فَوَجَدَهُمْ أَهْلًا لَهُ. 6 مَحْصُهُمْ كَالذَّهَبِ فِي الْبُودَقَةِ، وَقَبْلَهُمْ كَذَيْبَةٌ مُحْرَقَةٌ. 7 فَهُمْ فِي وَقْتِ افْتِقَادِهِمْ يَتَلَأَلُونَ، وَيَسْعَوْنَ سَعَى الشَّرَارِ بَيْنَ الْقَصَبِ، 8 وَيَدِينُونَ الْأُمَمَ وَيَتَسَلَطُونَ عَلَى الشُّعُوبِ، وَيَمْلِكُ رَبُّهُمْ إِلَيْهِ الْأَبَدَ. 9 الْمُتَوَكِّلُونَ عَلَيْهِ سَيَفْهَمُونَ الْحَقَّ، وَالْأَمْنَاءُ فِي الْمَحَبَّةِ سَيَلْزَمُونَهُ، لِأَنَّ النِّعْمَةَ وَالرَّحْمَةَ لِمُخْتَارِيهِ. 10 أَمَّا الْمُنَافِقُونَ فَسَيُنَالُهُمُ
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όσοις αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐπισκοπῇ ἐν τοῖς ἐκλεκτοῖς αὐτοῦ. 10 Οἱ δὲ ἀσεβεῖς καθὰ ἐλογίσαντο ἔξουσιν ἐπιτιμίαν, οἱ ἀμελήσαντες τοῦ δικαίου καὶ τοῦ Κυρίου ἀποστάντες. 11 σοφίαν γὰρ καὶ παιδείαν ὁ ἐξουθενῶν ταλαίπωρος, καὶ κενὴ ἡ ἐλπίς αὐτῶν, καὶ οἱ κόποι ἀνόνητοι καὶ ἄχρηστα τὰ ἔργα αὐτῶν. 12 αἱ γυναῖκες αὐτῶν ἄφρονες, καὶ πονηρὰ τὰ τέκνα αὐτῶν, ἐπικατάρατος ἡ γένεσις αὐτῶν. 13 ὅτι μακαρία στεῖρα ἡ ἀμίαντος, ἥτις οὐκ ἔγνω κοίτην ἐν παραπτώματι, ἔξει καρπὸν ἐν ἐπισκοπῇ ψυχῶν, 14 καὶ εὐνοῦχος ὁ μὴ ἐργασάμενος ἐν χειρὶ ἀνόμημα, μηδὲ ἐνθυμηθεὶς κατὰ τοῦ Κυρίου πονηρά, δοθήσεται γὰρ αὐτῷ τῆς πίστεως χάρις ἐκλεκτὴ καὶ κληρὸς ἐν ναῷ Κυρίου θυμηρέστερος. 15 ἀγαθῶν γὰρ πόνων καρπὸς εὐκλείης, καὶ ἀδιάπτωτος ἡ ρίζα τῆς φρονήσεως. 16 τέκνα δὲ μοιχῶν ἀτέλεστα ἔσται, καὶ ἐκ παρανόμου κοίτης σπέρμα	chosen. ¹⁰ But the godless will be duly punished for their reasoning, for having neglected the upright and deserted the Lord. ¹¹ Yes, wretched are they who scorn wisdom and discipline: their hope is void, their toil unavailing, their achievements unprofitable; ¹² their wives are reckless, their children depraved, their descendants accursed. ¹³ Blessed the sterile woman if she be blameless, and has not known an unlawful bed, for she will have fruit at the visitation of souls. ¹⁴ Blessed, too, the eunuch whose hand commits no crime, and who harbours no resentment against the Lord: a special favour will be granted to him for his loyalty, a most desirable portion in the temple of the Lord. ¹⁵ For the fruit of honest labours is glorious, and the root of understanding does not decay. ¹⁶ But the children of adulterers will not reach maturity, the offspring of an unlawful bed will disappear. ¹⁷ Even if they live long, they will count for nothing, their	العقاب الخلق بمشوراتهم، إذ استهانوا بالصدق، وارتدوا عن الرب، 11 لأنّ مزدرى الحكمة والتأديب شقي. إنّما رجأؤهم باطل، وأتعبهم بلا ثمرة، وأعمالهم لا فائدة فيها. 12 نساؤهم سفهات، وأولادهم أشرار، 13 ونسلهم ملعون. أمّا العاقر الطاهرة التي لم تعرف المضجع الفاحش فطوبى لها. إنّها ستحوز ثمرتها في افتقاد النفوس. 14 وطوبى للخصي الذي لم تبأسر يده مائماً، ولا افترق قلبه بشر على الرب؛ فإنه سيعطى نعمة سامية لأمانته، وحظاً شهياً في هيكل الرب. 15 لأنّ ثمرة الأتعاب الصالحة فاخترة، وجرثومة الفطنة راسخة. 16 أمّا أولاد الزناة فلا يبلغون أشدهم، وذرية المضجع الأثيم تنقرض. 17 إنّ طالت حياتهم فإنهم يحسبون كلاً شيئاً، وفي
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ἀφανισθήσεται. 17 ἐάν τε γὰρ μακρόβιοι γένωνται, εἰς οὐθὲν λογισθήσονται, καὶ ἄτιμον ἐπ' ἐσχάτων τὸ γῆρας αὐτῶν. 18 ἐάν τε ὀξέως τελευτήσωσιν, οὐχ ἔξουσιν ἐλπίδα, οὐδὲ ἐν ἡμέρᾳ διαγνώσεως παραμύθιον. 19 γενεᾶς γὰρ ἀδίκου χαλεπὰ τὰ τέλη.	old age will go unhonoured at the last; ¹⁸ while if they die early, they have neither hope nor comfort on the day of judgement, ¹⁹ for the end of a race of evil-doers is harsh.	أَوَآخِرِهِمْ تَكُونُ شَيْخُوخَتَهُمْ بِلَا كَرَامَةٍ. 18 وَإِنْ مَاتُوا سَرِيعًا؛ فَلَا يَكُونُ لَهُمْ رَجَاءٌ وَلَا عَزَاءٌ فِي يَوْمِ الْحِسَابِ، 19 لِأَنَّ عَاقِبَةَ الْجِيلِ الْآثِمِ هَائِلَةٌ.
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الأصاح الرابع

ΚΡΕΙΣΣΩΝ ἀτεκνία μετὰ ἀρετῆς· ἀθανασία γάρ ἐστιν ἐν μνήμῃ αὐτῆς, ὅτι καὶ παρὰ Θεῷ γινώσκεται καὶ παρὰ ἀνθρώποις. 2 παροῦσάν τε μιμοῦνται αὐτήν καὶ ποθοῦσιν ἀπελθοῦσαν· καὶ ἐν τῷ αἰῶνι στεφανηφοροῦσα πομπεύει τὸν τῶν ἀμιάντων ἄθλων ἀγῶνα νικήσασα. 3 πολύγονον δὲ ἀσεβῶν πλῆθος οὐ χρησιμεύσει, καὶ ἐκ νόθων μοσχευμάτων οὐ δώσει ρίζαν εἰς βάθος, οὐδὲ ἀσφαλῆ βάσιν ἐδράσει. 4 κὰν γὰρ ἐν κλάδοις πρὸς καιρὸν ἀναθάλη, ἐπισφαλῶς βεβηκότα ὑπὸ ἀνέμου σαλευθήσεται καὶ ὑπὸ βίας ἀνέμων	¹ Better to have no children yet to have virtue, since immortality perpetuates its memory; for God and human beings both recognise it. ² Present, we imitate it, absent, we long for it; crowned, it holds triumph through eternity, having striven for untainted prizes and emerged the victor. ³ But the offspring of the godless come to nothing, however prolific, sprung from a bastard stock, they will never strike deep roots, never put down firm foundations. ⁴ They may branch out for a time, but, on unsteady foundations, they will be rocked by the wind and uprooted by the force of the storm;	1 إِنْ الْبَتُولِيَّةُ مَعَ الْفَضِيلَةِ أَجْمَلُ؛ فَإِنَّ مَعَهَا ذِكْرًا خَالِدًا، لِأَنَّهَا تَبْقَى مَعْلُومَةً عِنْدَ اللَّهِ وَالنَّاسِ. 2 إِذَا حَضَرَتْ يَقْتَدِي بِهَا، وَإِذَا غَابَتْ يَشْتَاقُ إِلَيْهَا، وَمَدَى الدَّهْوَرِ تَفْتَخِرُ بِأَكْلِيلِ الظَّفَرِ بَعْدَ انْتِصَارِهَا فِي سَاحَةِ الْمَعَارِكِ الطَّاهِرَةِ. 3 أَمَّا لَفِيفُ الْمُنَافِقِينَ الْكَثِيرِ التَّوَالِدِ فَلَا يَنْجَحُ، وَفَرَاخُهُمُ النَّغْلَةُ لَا تَتَعَمَّقُ أَصُولُهَا، وَلَا تَقُومُ عَلَى سَاقٍ رَاسِخَةٍ، 4 وَإِنْ أَخْرَجَتْ فُرُوعًا إِلَى حِينٍ؛ فَإِنَّهَا لَعَدَمٍ رَسُوخَهَا تَزْعَزَعُهَا الرِّيحُ وَتَقْتُلِعُهَا الزُّوبَعَةُ. 5 فَتَنْقَصِفُ فُرُوعُهَا قَبْلَ إِنَاهَا،
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ἐκριζωθήσεται. 5 περικλασθήσονται κλῶνες ἀτέλεστοι, καὶ ὁ καρπὸς αὐτῶν ἄχρηστος, ἄωρος εἰς βρῶσιν καὶ εἰς οὐθὲν ἐπιτήδειος. 6 ἐκ γὰρ ἀνόμων ὑπνῶν τέκνα γεννώμενα μάρτυρές εἰσι πονηρίας κατὰ γονέων ἐν ἐξετασμῷ αὐτῶν. 7 Δίκαιος δὲ ἐὰν φθάσῃ τελευτῆσαι, ἐν ἀναπαύσει ἔσται. 8 γῆρας γὰρ τίμιον οὐ τὸ πολυχρόνιον οὐδὲ ἀριθμῷ ἐτῶν μεμέτρηται. 9 πολιὰ δέ ἐστι φρόνησις ἀνθρώποις καὶ ἡλικία γήρως βίος ἀκηλίδωτος. 10 εὐάρεστος τῷ Θεῷ γενόμενος ἠγαπήθη καὶ ζῶν μεταξὺ ἁμαρτωλῶν μετετέθη. 11 ἡρπάγη, μὴ κακία ἀλλάξη σύνεσιν αὐτοῦ ἢ δόλος ἀπατήσῃ ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ. 12 βασκανία γὰρ φαυλότητος ἁμαυροῖ τὰ καλά, καὶ ρεμβασμὸς ἐπιθυμίας μεταλλεύει νοῦν ἄκακον. 13 τελειωθεὶς ἐν ὀλίγῳ ἐπλήρωσε χρόνους μακροῦς, 14 ἀρεστὴ γὰρ ἦν Κυρίῳ ἡ ψυχὴ αὐτοῦ. διὰ τοῦτο ἔσπευσεν ἐκ μέσου πονηρίας. οἱ δὲ λαοὶ ἰδόντες καὶ μὴ νοήσαντες, μηδὲ	⁵ their branches, yet unformed, will be snapped off, their fruit be useless, too unripe to eat, fit for nothing. ⁶ For children begotten of unlawful bed witness, when put on trial, to their parents' wickedness. ⁷ The upright, though he die before his time, will find rest. ⁸ Length of days is not what makes age honourable, nor number of years the true measure of life; ⁹ understanding, this is grey hairs, untarnished life, this is ripe old age. ¹⁰ Having won God's favour, he has been loved and, as he was living among sinners, has been taken away. ¹¹ He has been carried off so that evil may not warp his understanding or deceitfulness seduce his soul; ¹² for the fascination of evil throws good things into the shade, and the whirlwind of desire corrupts a simple heart. ¹³ Having come to perfection so soon, he has lived long; ¹⁴ his soul being pleasing to the Lord, he has hurried away from the wickedness around him. Yet	وَتَكُونُ ثَمَرُهَا خَبِيثَةً غَيْرَ نَاضِجَةٍ لِلْأَكْلِ، وَلَا تَصْلُحُ لَشَيْءٍ. 6 وَالْمَوْلُودُونَ مِنَ الْمَضْجَعِ الْأَثِيمِ يَشْهَدُونَ بِفَاحِشَةٍ وَالِدِيهِمْ عِنْدَ اسْتِنْطَاقِ حَالِهِمْ. 7 أَمَّا الصَّدِيقُ؛ فَإِنَّهُ وَإِنْ تَعَجَّلَهُ الْمَوْتُ، يَسْتَقِرُّ فِي الرَّاحَةِ. 8 لِأَنَّ الشَّيْخُوخَةَ الْمُكْرَمَةَ لَيْسَتْ هِيَ الْقَدِيمَةُ الْأَيَّامِ، وَلَا هِيَ تَقْدَرُ بَعْدَدَ السِّنِينَ. 9 وَلَكِنْ شَيْبَ الْإِنْسَانِ هُوَ الْفُطْنَةُ، وَسِنَّ الشَّيْخُوخَةِ هِيَ الْحَيَاةُ الْمُنْزَهَةُ عَنِ الْعَيْبِ. 10 إِنَّهُ كَانَ مُرْضِيًّا لِلَّهِ فَأُحِبَّهُ، وَكَانَ يَعْيشُ بَيْنَ الْخَطَاةِ فَنُقِلَ. 11 خَطَفَهُ لِكَيْ لَا يَغَيِّرَ الشَّرُّ عَقْلَهُ، وَلَا يَطْغِي الْغَشُّ نَفْسَهُ. 12 لِأَنَّ سِحْرَ الْأَبَاطِيلِ يَغْشِي الْخَيْرَ، وَدَوَارُ الشَّهْوَةِ يَطِيشُ الْعَقْلَ السَّالِمَ. 13 قَدْ بَلَغَ الْكَمَالَ فِي أَيَّامٍ قَلِيلَةٍ؛ فَكَانَ مُسْتَوْفِيًّا سِنِينَ كَثِيرَةً. 14 وَإِذْ كَانَتْ نَفْسُهُ مَرْضِيَّةً لِلرَّبِّ؛ فَقَدْ أُخْرِجَ سَرِيعًا مِنْ بَيْنِ الشُّرُورِ. أَمَّا الشُّعُوبُ فَأَبْصَرُوا وَلَمْ
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θέντες ἐπὶ διανοίᾳ τὸ τοιοῦτον, 15 ὅτι χάρις καὶ ἔλεος ἐν τοῖς ἐκλεκτοῖς αὐτοῦ καὶ ἐπισκοπὴ ἐν τοῖς ὁσίοις αὐτοῦ. 16 κατακρινεῖ δὲ δίκαιος καμῶν τοὺς ζῶντας ἀσεβεῖς καὶ νεότης τελεσθεῖσα ταχέως πολυετὲς γῆρας ἀδίκου· 17 ὄψονται γὰρ τελευτὴν σοφοῦ καὶ οὐ νοήσουσι τί ἐβουλεύσατο περὶ αὐτοῦ καὶ εἰς τί ἡσφαλίσατο αὐτὸν ὁ Κύριος. 18 ὄψονται καὶ ἐξουθενήσουσιν, αὐτοὺς δὲ ὁ Κύριος ἐκγελάσεται 19 καὶ ἔσονται μετὰ τοῦτο εἰς πτῶμα ἄτιμον καὶ εἰς ὕβριν ἐν νεκροῖς δι' αἰῶνος, ὅτι ρήξει αὐτοὺς ἀφώνους πρηνεῖς καὶ σαλεύσει αὐτοὺς ἐκ θεμελίων καὶ ἕως ἐσχάτου χερσωθήσονται καὶ ἔσονται ἐν ὁδύνῃ, καὶ ἡ μνήμη αὐτῶν ἀπολεῖται. 20 ἐλεύσονται ἐν συλλογισμῷ ἁμαρτημάτων αὐτῶν δειλοί, καὶ ἐλέγξει αὐτοὺς ἐξεναντίας τὰ ἀνομήματα αὐτῶν.	people look on, uncomprehending; and it does not enter their heads 15 that grace and mercy await his chosen ones and that he intervenes on behalf of his holy ones. 16 The upright who dies condemns the godless who survive, and youth quickly perfected condemns the lengthy old age of the wicked. 17 These people see the end of the wise without understanding what the Lord has in store or why he has taken such a one to safety; 18 they look on and sneer, but the Lord will laugh at them. 19 Soon they will be corpses without honour, objects of horror among the dead for ever. For he will shatter them and fling them headlong and dumbfounded. He will shake them from their foundations; they will be utterly laid waste, a prey to grief, and their memory will perish. 20 When the count of their sins has been drawn up, in terror they will come, and their crimes, confronting them, will accuse them.	يَفْقَهُوا وَلَمْ يَجْعَلُوا هَذَا فِي 15 أَنَّ نِعْمَتَهُ وَرَحْمَتَهُ لِمَخْتَارِيهِ، وَأَفْتَقَادَهُ لِقُدَيْسِيهِ. 16 لَكِنَّ الصَّدِيقَ الَّذِي قَدْ مَاتَ يَحْكُمُ عَلَى الْمُنَافِقِينَ الْبَاقِينَ بَعْدَهُ، وَالشَّيْبَةَ السَّرِيعَةَ الْكَمَالَ تَحْكُمُ عَلَى شَيْخُوخَةِ الْأَثِيمِ الْكَثِيرَةِ السِّنِينَ. 17 فَإِنَّهُمْ يَبْصُرُونَ مَوْتَ الْحَكِيمِ، وَلَا يَفْقَهُونَ مَاذَا أَرَادَ الرَّبُّ بِهِ، وَلَمَّاذَا نَقَلَهُ إِلَى عَصْمَتِهِ. 18 يَبْصُرُونَ وَيَزْدَرُونَ، وَالرَّبُّ يَسْتَهْزِئُ بِهِمْ. 19 سَيَسْقُطُونَ مِنْ بَعْدِ سَقُوطًا مُهِينًا، وَيَكُونُونَ عَارًا بَيْنَ الْأَمْوَاتِ مَدَى الدَّهْرِ. فَإِنَّهُ يَحْطِمُهُمْ وَهُمْ مَبْلِسُونَ مَطْرُقُونَ، وَيَقْتُلُهُمْ مِنْ الْأَسْسِ، وَيَتِمُّ خَرَابُهُمْ؛ فَيَكُونُونَ فِي الْعَذَابِ وَذَكَرُهُمْ يَهْلِكُ. 20 يَتَقَدَّمُونَ فَزَعِينَ مِنْ تَذَكُّرِ خَطَايَاهُمْ، وَأَنَامُهُمْ تَحْجُمُهُمْ فِي وُجُوهِهِمْ.
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الأصحاح الخامس

TOTE στήσεται ἐν παρρησίᾳ πολλῇ ὁ δίκαιος κατὰ πρόσωπον τῶν θλιψάντων αὐτὸν καὶ τῶν ἀθετούντων τοὺς πόνους αὐτοῦ. 2 ἰδόντες ταραχθήσονται φόβῳ δεινῷ καὶ ἐκστήσονται ἐπὶ τῷ παραδόξῳ τῆς σωτηρίας. 3 ἐροῦσιν ἐν ἑαυτοῖς μετανοοῦντες καὶ διὰ στενοχωρίαν πνεύματος στενάξονται καὶ ἐροῦσιν· 4 οὗτος ἦν ὃν ἔσχομέν ποτε εἰς γέλωτα καὶ εἰς παραβολὴν ὀνειδισμοῦ οἱ ἄφρονες· τὸν βίον αὐτοῦ ἐλογισάμεθα μανίαν καὶ τὴν τελευτὴν αὐτοῦ ἄτιμον. 5 πῶς κατελογίσθη ἐν υἱοῖς Θεοῦ καὶ ἐν ἁγίοις ὁ κληρὸς αὐτοῦ ἐστίν; 6 ἄρα ἐπλανήθημεν ἀπὸ ὁδοῦ ἀληθείας, καὶ τὸ τῆς δικαιοσύνης φῶς οὐκ ἔλαμψεν ἡμῖν, καὶ ὁ ἥλιος οὐκ ἀνέτειλεν ἡμῖν· 7 ἀνομίας ἐνεπλήσθημεν τρίβοις καὶ ἀπωλείας καὶ διωδεύσαμεν ἐρήμους ἀβάτους, τὴν δὲ ὁδὸν Κυρίου οὐκ ἔγνωμεν. 8 τί ὠφέλησεν ἡμᾶς ἡ ὑπερηφανία; καὶ τί πλοῦτος μετὰ ἀλαζονίας	¹ Then the upright will stand up boldly to face those who had oppressed him and had thought so little of his sufferings. ² And, seeing him, they will be seized with terrible fear, amazed that he should have been so unexpectedly saved. ³ Stricken with remorse, they will say to one another with groans and labouring breath, ⁴ 'This is the one whom we used to mock, making him the butt of our insults, fools that we were! His life we regarded as madness, his ending as without honour. ⁵ How has he come to be counted as one of the children of God and to have his lot among the holy ones? ⁶ Clearly we have strayed from the way of truth; the light of justice has not shone for us, the sun has not risen for us. ⁷ We have left no path of lawlessness or ruin unexplored, we have crossed deserts where there was no track, but the way of the Lord is one we have never known. ⁸ What good has arrogance been to us? What has been the	1 حِينَئِذٍ يَقُومُ الصَّادِقُ بِجُرْأَةٍ عَظِيمَةٍ فِي وُجُوهِ الَّذِينَ ضَايَقُوهُ، وَجَعَلُوا أَتْعَابَهُ بَاطِلَةً. 2 فَإِذَا رَأَوْهُ يَضْطَرِبُونَ مِنْ شِدَّةِ الْجَزَعِ، وَيَنْذَهَلُونَ مِنْ خِلَاصٍ لَمْ يَكُونُوا يَظُنُّونَهُ، 3 وَيَقُولُونَ فِي أَنْفُسِهِمْ نَادِمِينَ، وَهُمْ يَنْوَحُونَ مِنْ ضَيْقٍ صُدُورِهِمْ: «هَذَا الَّذِي كُنَّا حِينًا نَتَّخِذُهُ سَخِرَةً وَمَثَلًا لِلْعَارِ. 4 وَكُنَّا نَحْنُ الْجَهَالُ نَحْسَبُ حَيَاتَهُ جُنُونًا، وَمَوْتَهُ هَوَانًا. 5 فَكَيْفَ أَصْبَحَ مَعْدُودًا فِي بَنِي اللَّهِ، وَحَظَّهُ بَيْنَ الْقُدِّيسِينَ؟! 6 لَقَدْ ضَلَلْنَا عَنْ طَرِيقِ الْحَقِّ، وَلَمْ يُضَيِّ لَنَا نُورُ الْبَرِّ، وَلَمْ تُشْرِقْ عَلَيْنَا الشَّمْسُ. 7 أَعْيَيْنَا فِي سَبِيلِ الْإِثْمِ وَالْهَلَاكِ، وَهَمْنَا فِي مَتَايَةِ لَا طَرِيقَ فِيهَا، وَلَمْ نَعْلَمْ طَرِيقَ الرَّبِّ. 8 فَمَاذَا نَفْعَتَنَا الْكِبْرِيَاءُ، وَمَاذَا أَفَادَنَا افْتِخَارُنَا بِالْأَمْوَالِ. 9 قَدْ مَضَى ذَلِكَ كُلُّهُ كَالظِّلِّ وَكَالْخَبَرِ السَّائِرِ.
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συμβέβληται ἡμῖν; 9
παρῆλθεν ἐκεῖναι πάντα ὡς
σκιά καὶ ὡς ἀγγελία
παρατρέχουσα· 10 ὡς ναῦς
διερχομένη κυμαινόμενον
ὑδωρ, ἥς διαβάσης οὐκ ἔστιν
ἵχνος εὐρεῖν, οὐδὲ ἀτραπὸν
τρόπιος αὐτῆς ἐν κύμασιν·
11 ἢ ὡς ὀρνέου διαπτάντος
ἀέρα οὐθὲν εὐρίσκεται
τεκμήριον πορείας, πληγῇ
δὲ ταρσῶν μαστιζόμενον
πνεῦμα κοῦφον καὶ
σχιζόμενον βία ροίζου,
κινουμένων πτερύγων
διωδευθή, καὶ μετὰ τοῦτο
οὐχ εὐρέθη σημεῖον
ἐπιβάσεως ἐν αὐτῷ· 12 ἢ ὡς
βέλους βληθέντος ἐπὶ
σκοπόν, τμηθεὶς ὁ ἀήρ
εὐθέως εἰς ἑαυτὸν ἀνελύθη
ὡς ἀγνοῆσαι τὴν δίοδον
αὐτοῦ. 13 οὕτως καὶ ἡμεῖς
γεννηθέντες ἐξελίπομεν καὶ
ἀρετῆς μὲν σημεῖον οὐδὲν
ἔσχομεν δεῖξαι, ἐν δὲ τῇ
κακία ἡμῶν
κατεδαπανήθημεν. 14 ὅτι
ἐλπίς ἀσεβοῦς ὡς φερόμενος
χνοῦς ὑπὸ ἀνέμου καὶ ὡς
πάχνη ὑπὸ λαίλαπος
διωχθεῖσα λεπτὴ καὶ ὡς
καπνὸς ὑπὸ ἀνέμου διεχύθη
καὶ ὡς μνεῖα καταλύτου

purpose of our riches and
boastfulness?

⁹ All those things have passed
like a shadow, passed like a
fleeting rumour.

¹⁰ Like a ship that cuts through
heaving waves -- leaving no
trace to show where it has
passed, no wake from its keel in
the waves.

¹¹ Or like a bird flying through
the air -- leaving no proof of its
passing; it whips the light air
with the stroke of its pinions,
tears it apart in its whirring rush,
drives its way onward with
sweeping wing, and afterwards
no sign is seen of its passage.

¹² Or like an arrow shot at a
mark, the pierced air closing so
quickly on itself, there is no
knowing which way the arrow
has passed.

¹³ So with us: scarcely born, we
disappear; of virtue not a trace
have we to show, we have spent
ourselves in our own
wickedness!

¹⁴ Thus says the sinners in hades
THIS VERSE NIT IN THE ENGLISH TRANSLATIONS,
ONLY IN ARABIC

¹⁵ For the hope of the godless is
like chaff carried on the wind,
like fine spray driven by the
storm; it disperses like smoke

10 أَوْ كَالسَّفِينَةِ الْجَارِيَةِ عَلَى
الْمَاءِ الْمَتَمَوِّجِ، الَّتِي بَعْدَ مَرُورِهَا
لَا تَجِدُ أَثَرَهَا، وَلَا خَطَّ حَيْزُومِهَا
فِي الْأُمُوجِ.

11 أَوْ كَطَائِرٍ يَطِيرُ فِي الْجَوِّ؛
فَلَا يَبْقَى دَلِيلٌ عَلَى مَسِيرِهِ.
يَضْرِبُ الرِّيحَ الْخَفِيفَةَ بِقَوَادِمِهِ،
وَيَشُقُّ الْهَوَاءَ بِشِدَّةِ سُرْعَتِهِ،

وَبِرَفْرِفَةِ جَنَاحِيهِ يَعْبُرُ، ثُمَّ لَا تَجِدُ
لِمُرُورِهِ مِنْ عِلَامَةٍ.

12 أَوْ كَسَهْمٍ يَرْمِي إِلَى
الْهَدَفِ؛ فَيُخَرِّقُ بِهِ الْهَوَاءَ،
وَلَوْقَتَهُ يَعُودُ إِلَى حَالِهِ، حَتَّى لَا
يَعْرِفَ مَمَرُ السَّهْمِ.

13 كَذَلِكَ نَحْنُ، وَلِدْنَا ثُمَّ
اضْمَحَلَلْنَا، وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَنَا أَنْ نُبْدِيَ
عِلَامَةً فَضِيلَةٍ، بَلْ فِينَا فِي
رَذِيلَتِنَا.

14 كَذَا قَالَ الْخُطَاةُ فِي
الْجَحِيمِ.

15 لِأَنَّ رَجَاءَ الْمُنَافِقِ كَغَبَارٍ
تَذَهَبُ بِهِ الرِّيحُ، وَكَزَبَدٍ رَقِيقٍ
تَطَارِدُهُ الزُّوبَعَةُ، وَكَدَخَانٍ تَبْدَدُهُ
الرِّيحُ، وَكَذِكْرِ ضَيْفٍ نَزَلَ يَوْمًا
ثُمَّ ارْتَحَلَ.

μονοήμερου παρώδευσε. 15 Δίκαιοι δὲ εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα ζῶσι, καὶ ἐν Κυρίῳ ὁ μισθὸς αὐτῶν, καὶ ἡ φροντίς αὐτῶν παρὰ Ὑψίστου. 16 διὰ τοῦτο λήψονται τὸ βασίλειον τῆς εὐπρεπείας καὶ τὸ διάδημα τοῦ κάλλους ἐκ χειρὸς Κυρίου, ὅτι τῇ δεξιᾷ σκεπάσει αὐτοὺς καὶ τῷ βραχίονι ὑπερασπιεῖ αὐτῶν. 17 λήψεται πανοπλίαν τὸν ζῆλον αὐτοῦ καὶ ὀπλοποιήσει τὴν κτίσιν εἰς ἄμυναν ἐχθρῶν. 18 ἐνδύσεται θώρακα δικαιοσύνης καὶ περιθήσεται κόρυθα κρίσιν ἀνυπόκριτον. 19 λήψεται ἀσπίδα ἀκαταμάχητον ὁσιότητα, 20 ὁξυνεῖ δὲ ἀπότομον ὀργὴν εἰς ρομφαίαν, συνεκπολεμήσει δὲ αὐτῷ ὁ κόσμος ἐπὶ τοὺς παράφρονas. 21 πορεύσονται εὐστοχοὶ βολίδες ἀστραπῶν καὶ ὡς ἀπὸ εὐκύκλου τόξου τῶν νεφῶν ἐπὶ σκοπὸν ἀλοῦνται, 22 καὶ ἐκ πετροβόλου θυμοῦ πλήρεις ριφήσονται χάλασαι. ἀγανακτήσει κατ' αὐτῶν ὕδωρ θαλάσσης, ποταμοὶ δὲ συγκλύσουσιν

before the wind, goes away like the memory of a one-day guest.

¹⁶ But the upright live for ever, their recompense is with the Lord, and the Most High takes care of them.

¹⁷ So they will receive the glorious crown and the diadem of beauty from the Lord's hand; for he will shelter them with his right hand and with his arm he will shield them.

¹⁸ For armour he will take his jealous love, he will arm creation to punish his enemies;

¹⁹ he will put on justice as a breastplate, and for helmet wear his forthright judgement;

²⁰ he will take up invincible holiness for shield,

²¹ of his pitiless wrath he will forge a sword, and the universe will march with him to fight the reckless.

²² Bolts truly aimed, the shafts of lightning will leap, and from the clouds, as from a full-drawn bow, fly to their mark;

²³ and the catapult will hurl hailstones charged with fury. The waters of the sea will rage against them, the rivers engulf them without pity,

16 أَمَّا الصَّادِقُونَ فَسَيَحْيَوْنَ إِلَى الْأَبَدِ، وَعِنْدَ الرَّبِّ ثَوَابُهُمْ،

وَلَهُمْ عَنَاءٌ مِنْ لَدُنِ الْعَلِيِّ.

17 فَلِذَلِكَ سَيَنَالُونَ مُلْكَ

الْكَرَامَةِ، وَتَاجَ الْجَمَالِ مِنْ يَدِ

الرَّبِّ، لِأَنَّهُ يَسْتَرْهُمْ بِيَمِينِهِ

وَبِذِرَاعِهِ يَقِيهِمْ.

18 يَتَسَلَّحُ بِغَيْرَتِهِ وَيَسْلُحُ الْخَلْقَ

لِلانْتِقَامِ مِنَ الْأَعْدَاءِ.

19 يَلْبَسُ الْبِرَّ دَرْعًا وَحُكْمَ

الْحَقِّ خُوْذَةً،

20 وَيَتَّخِذُ الْقُدَاسَةَ تَرَسًا لَا

يَقْهَرُ،

21 وَيَحْدُدُ غَضَبَهُ سَيْفًا مَاضِيًا،

وَالْعَالَمَ يَحَارِبُ مَعَهُ الْجَهَالَ.

22 فَتَنْطَلِقُ صَوَاعِقُ الْبُرُوقِ

انْطِلَاقًا لَا يَخْطِئُ، وَعَنْ قَوْسٍ

الْغَيُومِ الْمَحْكَمَةِ التَّوْتِيرِ تَطِيرُ إِلَى

الْهَدَفِ.

23 وَسَخَطُهُ يَرْجِمُهُمْ بِبَرْدِ

ضَخَمٍ، وَمِيَاهُ الْبَحَارِ تَسْتَشِيْطُ

عَلَيْهِمْ، وَالْأَنْهَارُ تَلْتَقِي بِطُغْيَانٍ

شَدِيدٍ.

24 وَتَنْثُورُ عَلَيْهِمْ رِيْحٌ شَدِيدَةٌ

زَوْبَعَةً تَذْرِِيهِمْ، وَالْإِثْمُ يَدْمُرُ

ἀποτόμως. 23 ἀντιστήσεται αὐτοῖς πνεῦμα δυνάμεως καὶ ὡς λαῖλαψ ἐκλικμήσει αὐτούς. καὶ ἐρημώσει πᾶσαν τὴν γῆν ἀνομία, καὶ ἡ κακοπραγία περιτρέψει θρόνους δυναστῶν.	²⁴ a mighty gale will rise against them and winnow them like a hurricane. Thus wickedness will lay the whole earth waste and evil-doing bring down the thrones of the mighty.	جَمِيعَ الْأَرْضِ، وَالْفَجُورُ يَقْلِبُ عُرُوشَ الْمُقْتَدِرِينَ.
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الأصحاح السادس

ΑΚΟΥΣΑΤΕ οὖν, βασιλεῖς, καὶ σύνετε· μάθετε, δικασταὶ περάτων γῆς. 2 ἐνωτίσασθε οἱ κρατοῦντες πλήθους καὶ γεγαιρωμένοι ἐπὶ ὄχλοις ἐθνῶν· 3 ὅτι ἐδόθη παρὰ τοῦ Κυρίου ἡ κράτησις ὑμῖν καὶ ἡ δυναστεία παρὰ Ὑψίστου, ὃς ἐξετάσει ὑμῶν τὰ ἔργα καὶ τὰς βουλὰς διερευνήσει· 4 ὅτι ὑπηρέται ὄντες τῆς αὐτοῦ βασιλείας οὐκ ἐκρίνατε ὀρθῶς, οὐδὲ ἐφυλάξατε νόμον, οὐδὲ κατὰ τὴν βουλὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐπορεύθητε. 5 φρικτῶς καὶ ταχέως ἐπιστήσεται ὑμῖν, ὅτι κρίσις ἀπότομος ἐν τοῖς ὑπερέχουσι γίνεται. 6 ὁ γὰρ ἐλάχιστος συγγνωστός ἐστιν ἐλέους, δυνατοὶ δὲ δυνατῶς	¹ Listen then, kings, and understand; rulers of remotest lands, take warning; ² hear this, you who govern great populations, taking pride in your hosts of subject nations! ³ For sovereignty is given to you by the Lord and power by the Most High, who will himself probe your acts and scrutinise your intentions. ⁴ If therefore, as servants of his kingdom, you have not ruled justly nor observed the law, nor followed the will of God, ⁵ he will fall on you swiftly and terribly. On the highly placed a ruthless judgement falls; ⁶ the lowly are pardoned, out of pity, but the mighty will be mightily tormented. ⁷ For the Lord of all does not cower before anyone, he does	1 الْحِكْمَةُ خَيْرٌ مِنَ الْقُوَّةِ، وَالْحَكِيمُ أَفْضَلُ مِنَ الْجَبَّارِ. 2 وَأَنْتُمْ أَيُّهَا الْمُلُوكُ، فَاسْمَعُوا وَتَعَقَّلُوا، وَيَا قُضَاةَ أَقَاصِي الْأَرْضِ، اتَّعْظُوا. 3 أَصْغُوا أَيُّهَا الْمُسَلِّطُونَ عَلَى الْجَمَاهِيرِ، الْمَفْتَحِرُونَ بِجَمْعِ الْأُمَمِ، 4 فَإِنْ سُلْطَانَكُمْ مِنَ الرَّبِّ، وَقَدَرْتَكُمْ مِنَ الْعَلِيِّ، الَّذِي سَيَفْحَصُ أَعْمَالَكُمْ، وَيَسْتَقْصِي نِيَّاتَكُمْ 5 فَإِنَّكُمْ أَنْتُمْ الْخَادِمِينَ لِمُلْكِهِ، لَمْ تَحْكُمُوا حُكْمَ الْحَقِّ، وَلَمْ تَحْفَظُوا الشَّرِيعَةَ، وَلَمْ تَسِيرُوا بِحَسَبِ مَشِئَةِ اللَّهِ. 6 فَسَيَطْلُعُ عَلَيْكُمْ بَغْتَةً مَطْلَعًا مُخِيفًا، لِأَنَّهُ سَيَمْضِي عَلَى الْحُكَّامِ
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ἐτασθήσονται· 7 οὐ γὰρ ὑποστελεῖται πρόσωπον ὁ πάντων δεσπότης, οὐδὲ ἐντραπήσεται μέγεθος, ὅτι μικρὸν καὶ μέγαν αὐτὸς ἐποίησεν ὁμοίως τε προνοεῖ περὶ πάντων· 8 τοῖς δὲ κραταιοῖς ἰσχυρὰ ἐφίσταται ἔρευνα. 9 πρὸς ὑμᾶς οὖν, ὦ τύραννοι, οἱ λόγοι μου, ἵνα μάθητε σοφίαν καὶ μὴ παραπέσητε· 10 οἱ γὰρ φυλάξαντες ὁσίως τὰ ὅσια ὁσιωθήσονται, καὶ οἱ διδαχθέντες αὐτὰ εὐρήσουσιν ἀπολογία. 11 ἐπιθυμήσατε οὖν τῶν λόγων μου, ποθήσατε καὶ παιδευθήσεσθε. 12 Λαμπρὰ καὶ ἀμάραντός ἐστιν ἡ σοφία καὶ εὐχερῶς θεωρεῖται ὑπὸ τῶν ἀγαπώντων αὐτήν καὶ εὐρίσκεται ὑπὸ τῶν ζητούντων αὐτήν, 13 φθάνει τοὺς ἐπιθυμοῦντας προγνωσθῆναι. 14 ὁ ὀρθρίσας πρὸς αὐτήν οὐ κοπιάσει, πάρεδρον γὰρ εὐρήσει τῶν πυλῶν αὐτοῦ. 15 τὸ γὰρ ἐνθυμηθῆναι περὶ αὐτῆς φρονήσεως	not stand in awe of greatness, since he himself has made small and great and provides for all alike; ⁸ but a searching trial awaits those who wield power. ⁹ So, monarchs, my words are meant for you, so that you may learn wisdom and not fall into error; ¹⁰ for those who in holiness observe holy things will be adjudged holy, and, accepting instruction from them, will find their defence in them. ¹¹ Set your heart, therefore, on what I have to say, listen with a will, and you will be instructed. ¹² Wisdom is brilliant, she never fades. By those who love her, she is readily seen, by those who seek her, she is readily found. ¹³ She anticipates those who desire her by making herself known first. ¹⁴ Whoever gets up early to seek her will have no trouble but will find her sitting at the door. ¹⁵ Meditating on her is understanding in its perfect form, and anyone keeping awake for her will soon be free	قَضَاءٌ شَدِيدٌ. 7 فَإِنَّ الصَّغِيرَ أَهْلٌ لِلرَّحْمَةِ، أَمَّا أَرْبَابُ الْقُوَّةِ فَبِقُوَّةٍ يَفْحَصُونَ. 8 وَرَبُّ الْجَمِيعِ لَا يَسْتَشْنِي أَحَدًا، وَلَا يَهَابُ الْعُظْمَى، لِأَنَّ الصَّغِيرَ وَالْعَظِيمَ كِلَيْهِمَا صَنَعَهُ عَلَى السَّوَاءِ، وَعِنَايَتُهُ تَعْمُ الْجَمِيعِ. 9 لَكِنَّ عَلَى الْأَشْدَّاءِ امْتِحَانًا شَدِيدًا. 10 إِلَيْكُمْ أَيُّهَا الْمُلُوكُ تَوَجِّهِهِ كَلَامِي، لِكَيْ تَتَعَلَّمُوا الْحِكْمَةَ وَلَا تَسْقُطُوا. 11 فَإِنَّ الَّذِينَ يَحْفَظُونَ بِقَدَاسَةٍ مَا هُوَ مُقَدَّسٌ يَقْدَسُونَ، وَالَّذِينَ يَتَعَلَّمُونَ هَذِهِ، يَجِدُونَ مَا يَحْتَاجُونَ بِهِ. 12 فَابْتَغُوا كَلَامِي، وَاحْرِصُوا عَلَيْهِ فَتَتَّادِبُوا. 13 فَإِنَّ الْحِكْمَةَ ذَاتُ بَهَاءٍ وَنَضْرَةٍ لَا تَذْبُلُ، وَمَشَاهِدَتُهَا مَتَيْسِرَةٌ لِلَّذِينَ يَحِبُّونَهَا، وَوَجْدَانُهَا سَهْلٌ عَلَى الَّذِينَ يَلْتَمِسُونَهَا. 14 فَهِيَ تَسْبِقُ فَتَتَجَلَّى لِلَّذِينَ يَبْتَغُونَهَا، 15 وَمَنْ ابْتَكَّرَ فِي طَلِبِهَا لَا يَتْعَبُ،
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τελειότης, καὶ ὁ ἀγρυπνήσας δι' αὐτὴν ταχέως ἀμέριμνος ἔσται· 16 ὅτι τοὺς ἀξίους αὐτῆς αὕτη περιέρχεται ζητοῦσα καὶ ἐν ταῖς τρίβοις φαντάζεται αὐτοῖς εὐμενῶς καὶ ἐν πάσῃ ἐπινοίᾳ ὑπαντᾷ αὐτοῖς. 17 ἀρχὴ γὰρ αὐτῆς ἡ ἀληθεστάτη παιδείας ἐπιθυμία, φροντὶς δὲ παιδείας ἀγάπη, 18 ἀγάπη δὲ τήρησις νόμων αὐτῆς, προσοχὴ δὲ νόμων βεβαιώσεις ἀφθαρσίας, 19 ἀφθαρσία δὲ ἐγγὺς εἶναι ποιεῖ Θεοῦ. 20 ἐπιθυμία ἄρα σοφίας ἀνάγει ἐπὶ βασιλείαν. 21 εἰ οὖν ἦδεσθε ἐπὶ θρόνοις καὶ σκήπτροις, τύραννοι λαῶν, τιμήσατε σοφίαν, ἵνα εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα βασιλεύσητε. 22 τί δέ ἐστι σοφία καὶ πῶς ἐγένετο, ἀπαγγελῶ καὶ οὐκ ἀποκρύψω ὑμῖν μυστήρια, ἀλλὰ ἀπ' ἀρχῆς γενέσεως ἐξιχνιάσω καὶ θήσω εἰς τὸ ἐμφανὲς τὴν γνῶσιν αὐτῆς καὶ οὐ μὴ παροδεύσω τὴν ἀλήθειαν. 23 οὔτε μὴν φθόνῳ	from care. ¹⁶ For she herself searches everywhere for those who are worthy of her, benevolently appearing to them on their ways, anticipating their every thought. ¹⁷ For Wisdom begins with the sincere desire for instruction, care for instruction means loving her, ¹⁸ loving her means keeping her laws, attention to her laws guarantees incorruptibility, ¹⁹ and incorruptibility brings us near to God; ²⁰ the desire for Wisdom thus leads to sovereignty. ²¹ If then thrones and sceptres delight you, monarchs of the nations, honour Wisdom, so that you may reign for ever. ²² What Wisdom is and how she was born, I shall now explain; I shall hide no mysteries from you, but shall follow her steps from the outset of her origin, setting out what we know of her in full light, without departing from the truth. ²³ Blighting envy is no companion for me, for envy has nothing in common with Wisdom.	لأنه يجدها جالسة عند أبوابه. 16 فَالتأملُ فيها كمالُ الفطنة، ومن سهر لأجلها فلا يلبث له هم. 17 لأنها تجولُ في طلب الذين هم أهل لها، وتتمثل لهم في الطرق بأسمه، وتتلقاهم كلما تأملوا فيها. 18 فأولها الخلوص في ابتغاء التأديب. 19 وتطلب التأديب هو المحبة، والمحبة حفظ الشرائع، ومراعاة الشرائع ثبات الطهارة. 20 والطهارة تقرب إلى الله. 21 فابتغاء الحكمة يبلغ إلى الملكوت. 22 فإن كنتم تلتذون بالعرش والصولجان، يا ملوك الشعوب، فأكرموا الحكمة لكي تملكوا إلى الأبد، 23 وأحبوا نور الحكمة يا حكام الشعوب. 24 وأنا أخبركم ما الحكمة وكيف صدرت، ولا أكنتم عنكم الأسرار، لكن أبحت عنها من أول كونها، وأجعل معرفتها بينة، ولا أتجاوز من الحق شيئاً،
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τετηκότι συνοδεύσω, ὅτι οὗτος οὐ κοινωνήσει σοφία. 24 πλῆθος δὲ σοφῶν σωτηρία κόσμου, καὶ βασιλεὺς φρόνιμος εὐστάθεια δήμου. 25 ὥστε παιδεύσθε τοῖς ῥήμασί μου, καὶ ὠφελήθησθε.	²⁴ In the greatest number of the wise lies the world's salvation, in a sagacious king the stability of a people. ²⁵ Learn, therefore, from my words; the gain will be yours.	25 وَلَا أَسِيرُ مَعَ مَنْ يَذُوبُ حَسَدًا، لِأَنَّ مِثْلَ هَذَا لَا حَظَّ لَهُ فِي الْحِكْمَةِ. 26 إِنَّ كَثْرَةَ الْحُكَمَاءِ خَلَاصُ الْعَالَمِ، وَالْمَلِكِ الْفَطْنُ ثَبَاتُ الشَّعْبِ، 27 فَتَادَبُوا بِأَقْوَالِي وَاسْتَفِيدُوا بِهَا.
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الأصحاح السابع

EIMI μὲν καὶ γὰρ θνητὸς ἄνθρωπος ἴσος ἅπασιν καὶ γηγενοῦς ἀπόγονος πρωτοπλάστου· καὶ ἐν κοιλίᾳ μητρὸς ἐγλύφην σὰρξ 2 δεκαμηνιαίῳ χρόνῳ παγεῖς ἐν αἵματι ἐκ σπέρματος ἀνδρὸς καὶ ἡδονῆς ὑπνῶ συνελθούσης. 3 καὶ ἐγὼ δὲ γενόμενος ἔσπασα τὸν κοινὸν ἀέρα καὶ ἐπὶ τὴν ὁμοιοπαθῆ κατέπεσον γῆν, πρώτην φωνὴν τὴν ὁμοίαν πᾶσιν ἴσα κλαίων· 4 ἐν σπαργάνοις ἀνετράφην καὶ ἐν φροντίσιν· 5 οὐδεὶς γὰρ βασιλεὺς ἐτέραν ἔσχε γενέσεως ἀρχήν, 6 μία δὲ πάντων εἰσοδος εἰς τὸν βίον, ἔξοδος τε ἴση. 7 διὰ τοῦτο ηὐξάμην, καὶ	¹ I too am mortal like everyone else, a descendant of the first man formed from the earth. I was modelled in flesh inside a mother's womb, ² where, for ten months, in blood I acquired substance -- the result of virile seed and pleasure, sleep's companion. ³ I too, when I was born, drew in the common air, I fell on the same ground that bears us all, and crying was the first sound I made, like everyone else. ⁴ I was nurtured in swaddling clothes, with every care. ⁵ No king has known any other beginning of existence; ⁶ for there is only one way into life, and one way out of it. ⁷ And so I prayed, and	1 إِنَّمَا أَنَا إِنْسَانٌ يَمُوتُ، مُشَاكِلٌ لِسَائِرِ النَّاسِ، مِنْ جَنْسِ أَوَّلٍ مِنْ جَبَلٍ مِنَ الْأَرْضِ، وَقَدْ صُورْتُ جَسَدًا فِي 2 وَفِي مَدَّةٍ عَشْرَةِ أَشْهُرٍ صَنَعْتُ مِنَ الدَّمِ بَزْرَعَ الرَّجُلِ، وَاللَّذَّةِ الَّتِي تُصَاحِبُ النَّوْمِ. 3 وَلَمَّا وُلِدْتُ انْتَشَيْتُ هَذَا الْهَوَاءَ الشَّائِعَ، وَسَقَطْتُ عَلَى هَذِهِ الْأَرْضِ الْمُشْتَرَكَةِ، وَأَوَّلَ مَا اسْتَهَلَلْتُ بِالْبُكَاءِ عَلَى حَدِّ الْجَمِيعِ، 4 وَرَبِيتُ فِي الْقَمْطِ وَبَاهْتِمَامٍ كَثِيرٍ. 5 فَإِنَّهُ لَيْسَ لِمَلِكٍ بَدْءُ مَوْلَدٍ غَيْرِ هَذَا؛
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φρόνησις ἐδόθη μοι·
ἐπεκαλεσάμην, καὶ ἦλθέ
μοι πνεῦμα σοφίας. 8
προέκρινα αὐτὴν
σκήπτρων καὶ θρόνων καὶ
πλοῦτον οὐδὲν ἡγησάμην
ἐν συγκρίσει αὐτῆς. 9 οὐδὲ
ὡμοίωσα αὐτῇ λίθον
ἀτίμητον, ὅτι ὁ πᾶς χρυσὸς
ἐν ὄψει αὐτῆς ψάμμος
ὀλίγη, καὶ ὡς πηλὸς
λογισθήσεται ἄργυρος
ἐναντίον αὐτῆς. 10 ὑπερ
ὑγίειαν καὶ εὐμορφίαν
ἠγάπησα αὐτὴν καὶ
προειλόμην αὐτὴν ἀντὶ
φωτὸς ἔχειν, ὅτι ἀκοίμητον
τὸ ἐκ ταύτης φέγγος. 11
ἦλθε δέ μοι τὰ ἀγαθὰ ὁμοῦ
πάντα μετ' αὐτῆς καὶ
ἀναρίθμητος πλοῦτος ἐν
χερσὶν αὐτῆς. 12
εὐφράνθην δὲ ἐπὶ πᾶσιν,
ὅτι αὐτῶν ἡγεῖται σοφία,
ἡγνόουν δὲ αὐτὴν γενέτιν
εἶναι τούτων. 13 ἀδόλως τε
ἔμαθον ἀφθόνως τε
μεταδίδωμι, τὸν πλοῦτον
αὐτῆς οὐκ ἀποκρύπτομαι·
14 ἀνεκλιπῆς γὰρ
θησαυρὸς ἐστὶν ἀνθρώποις,
ὃν οἱ χρησάμενοι πρὸς
Θεὸν ἐστείλαντο φιλίαν διὰ
τὰς ἐκ παιδείας δωρεὰς

understanding was given me; I
entreated, and
the spirit of Wisdom came to
me.

⁸ I esteemed her more than
sceptres and thrones; compared
with her, I held riches as
nothing.

⁹ I reckoned no precious stone
to be her equal, for compared
with her, all gold is a pinch of
sand, and beside her, silver
ranks as mud.

¹⁰ I loved her more than health
or beauty, preferred her to the
light, since her radiance never
sleeps.

¹¹ In her company
all good things came to me, and
at her hands incalculable
wealth.

¹² All these delighted me,
since Wisdom brings them,
though I did not then realise
that she was their mother.

¹³ What I learned diligently, I
shall pass on liberally, I shall not
conceal how rich she is.

¹⁴ For she is to human beings an
inexhaustible treasure, and
those who acquire this win
God's friendship, commended to
him by the gifts of instruction.

¹⁵ May God grant me to speak as

6 بَلْ دُخُولُ الْجَمِيعِ إِلَى الْحَيَاةِ
وَاحِدٌ، وَخُرُوجُهُمْ سَوَاءٌ.
7 حِينَئِذٍ تَمْنِيْتُ؛ فَأُوتِيتُ الْفُطْنَةَ،
وَدَعَوْتُ فَحَلَ عَلَيَّ رُوحَ الْحِكْمَةِ.
8 فَفَضَّلْتُهَا عَلَى الصَّوَالِحَةِ
وَالْعُرُوشِ، وَلَمْ أَحْسَبِ الْغِنَى شَيْئًا
بِالْقِيَاسِ إِلَيْهَا،
9 وَلَمْ أَعْدِلْ بِهَا الْحَجَرَ الْكَرِيمَ،
لَأَنَّ جَمِيعَ الذَّهَبِ بِإِزَائِهَا قَلِيلٌ مِنَ
الرَّمْلِ، وَالْفِضَّةُ عِنْدَهَا تُحْسَبُ
طِينًا.

10 وَأَحْبَبْتُهَا فَوْقَ الْعَافِيَةِ
وَالْحَمَالِ، وَاتَّخَذْتُهَا لِي نُورًا، لَأَنَّ
ضَوْعَهَا لَا يَغْرُبُ،
11 فَأُوتِيتُ مَعَهَا كُلَّ صِنْفٍ مِنَ
الْخَيْرِ، وَنَلْتُ مِنْ يَدَيْهَا غِنًى لَا
يَحْصَى.

12 فَتَمَتَّعْتُ بِهِذِهِ كُلِّهَا، لَأَنَّ
الْحِكْمَةَ قَائِدَةٌ لَهَا، وَلَمْ أَعْلَمْ أَنَّهَا
أُمُّ جَمِيعِهَا.

13 تَعَلَّمْتُهَا بِغَيْرِ مَكْرٍ، وَأَشْرِكُ
فِيهَا بِغَيْرِ حَسَدٍ، وَغَنَاهَا لَا أَسْتَرُهُ.
14 فَإِنَّهَا كَنْزٌ لِلنَّاسِ لَا يَنْقُصُ،
وَالَّذِينَ اسْتَفَادُوا مِنْهُ أَشْرَكُوا فِي
مَحَبَّةِ اللَّهِ، لَأَنَّ مَوَاهِبَ التَّأْدِيبِ

συσταθέντες. 15 Ἐμοὶ δὲ δῶρη ὁ Θεὸς εἰπεῖν κατὰ γνῶμην καὶ ἐνθυμηθῆναι ἀξίως τῶν δεδομένων, ὅτι αὐτὸς καὶ τῆς σοφίας ὁδηγός ἐστι καὶ τῶν σοφῶν διορθωτής. 16 ἐν γὰρ χειρὶ αὐτοῦ καὶ ἡμεῖς καὶ οἱ λόγοι ἡμῶν πᾶσά τε φρόνησις καὶ ἐργατειῶν ἐπιστήμη. 17 αὐτὸς γὰρ μοι ἔδωκε τῶν ὄντων γνῶσιν ἀψευδῇ εἰδέναι σύστασιν κόσμου καὶ ἐνέργειαν στοιχείων, 18 ἀρχὴν καὶ τέλος καὶ μεσότητα χρόνων, τροπῶν ἀλλαγὰς καὶ μεταβολὰς καιρῶν, 19 ἐνιαυτῶν κύκλους καὶ ἀστέρων θέσεις, 20 φύσεις ζώων καὶ θυμοὺς θηρίων, πνευμάτων βίας καὶ διαλογισμοὺς ἀνθρώπων, διαφορὰς φυτῶν καὶ δυνάμεις ριζῶν, 21 ὅσα τέ ἐστι κρυπτὰ καὶ ἐμφανῇ ἔγνων· ἡ γὰρ πάντων τεχνίτις ἐδίδαξέ με σοφία. 22 Ἔστι γὰρ ἐν αὐτῇ πνεῦμα νοερόν, ἅγιον, μονογενές, πολυμερές, λεπτόν, εὐκίνητον, τρανόν, ἀμόλυντον, σαφές, ἀπήμαντον, φιλάγαθον,	he would wish and conceive thoughts worthy of the gifts I have received, since he is both guide to Wisdom and director of sages; 16 for we are in his hand, yes, ourselves and our sayings, and all intellectual and all practical knowledge. 17 He it was who gave me sure knowledge of what exists, to understand the structure of the world and the action of the elements, 18 the beginning, end and middle of the times, the alternation of the solstices and the succession of the seasons, 19 the cycles of the year and the position of the stars, 20 the natures of animals and the instincts of wild beasts, the powers of spirits and human mental processes, the varieties of plants and the medical properties of roots. 21 And now I understand everything, hidden or visible, for Wisdom, the designer of all things, has instructed me. 22 For within her is a spirit intelligent, holy, unique, manifold, subtle, mobile, incisive, unsullied, lucid, invulnerable, benevolent,	قربتهم إليه. 15 وَقَدْ وَهَبَنِي اللَّهُ أَنْ أُبْدِيَ عَمَّا فِي نَفْسِي، وَأَنْ أُجْرَى فِي خَاطِرِي مَا يَلِيقُ بِمَوَاهِبِهِ؛ فَإِنَّهُ هُوَ الْمُرْشِدُ إِلَى الْحِكْمَةِ وَثَقَفَ الْحُكَمَاءَ. 16 وَفِي يَدِهِ نَحْنُ، وَأَقْوَالُنَا وَالْفُطْنَةُ كُلُّهَا وَمَعْرِفَةُ مَا يَصْنَعُ. 17 وَوَهَبَنِي عِلْمًا يَقِينًا بِالْأَكْوَانِ، حَتَّى أَعْرِفَ نِظَامَ الْعَالَمِ وَقَوَاتِ الْعَنَاصِرِ، 18 وَمَبْدَأَ الْأَزْمَنَةِ وَمُنْتَهَاهَا وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا، وَتَغْيِيرَ الْأَحْوَالِ وَتَحَوُّلَ الْأَوْقَاتِ، 19 وَمَدَاوِرَ السِّنِينَ وَمَرَكَزَ النُّجُومِ، 20 وَطِبَائِعَ الْحَيَوَانِ وَأَخْلَاقَ الْوُحُوشِ وَعُصُوفِ الرِّيَّاحِ وَخَوَاطِرِ النَّاسِ وَتَبَايُنَ الْأَنْبَتَةِ وَقُوَى الْعَقَاقِيرِ. 21 فَعَلِمْتُ جَمِيعَ الْمَكْنُونَاتِ وَالظُّوَاهِرِ، لِأَنَّ الْحِكْمَةَ مُهَنْدِسَةٌ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، هِيَ عَلَّمَتْنِي. 22 فَإِنَّ فِيهَا الرُّوحَ الْفَهِمَ الْقُدُّوسَ، الْمَوْلُودَ الْوَحِيدَ ذَا
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ὄξύ, ἀκώλυτον, εὐεργετικόν, 23 φιλάνθρωπον, βέβαιον, ἀσφαλές, ἀμέριμνον, παντοδύναμον, πανεπίσκοπον καὶ διὰ πάντων χωροῦν πνευμάτων νοερῶν καθαρῶν λεπτοτάτων. 24 πάσης γὰρ κινήσεως κινητικώτερον σοφία, διήκει δὲ καὶ χωρεῖ διὰ πάντων διὰ τὴν καθαρότητα· 25 ἀτμὶς γάρ ἐστι τῆς τοῦ Θεοῦ δυνάμεως καὶ ἀπόρροια τῆς τοῦ Παντοκράτορος δόξης εἰλικρινής· διὰ τοῦτο οὐδὲν μεμιαμμένον εἰς αὐτὴν παρεμπίπτει. 26 ἀπαύγασμα γάρ ἐστι φωτὸς αἰδίου καὶ ἔσοπτρον ἀκηλίδωτον τῆς τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐνεργείας καὶ εἰκὼν τῆς ἀγαθότητος αὐτοῦ. 27 μία δὲ οὖσα πάντα δύναται καὶ μένουσα ἐν αὐτῇ τὰ πάντα καινίζει καὶ κατὰ γενεὰς εἰς ψυχὰς ὁσίας μεταβαίνουσα φίλους Θεοῦ καὶ προφήτας κατασκευάζει· 28 οὐθὲν γὰρ ἀγαπᾷ ὁ Θεὸς εἰ μὴ τὸν σοφία συνοικοῦντα. 29 ἔστι	shrewd, 23 irresistible, beneficent, friendly to human beings, steadfast, dependable, unperturbed, almighty, all- surveying, penetrating all intelligent, pure and most subtle spirits. 24 For Wisdom is quicker to move than any motion; she is so pure, she pervades and permeates all things. 25 She is a breath of the power of God, pure emanation of the glory of the Almighty; so nothing impure can find its way into her. 26 For she is a reflection of the eternal light, untarnished mirror of God's active power, and image of his goodness. 27 Although she is alone, she can do everything; herself unchanging, she renews the world, and, generation after generation, passing into holy souls, she makes them into God's friends and prophets; 28 for God loves only those who dwell with Wisdom. 29 She is indeed more splendid than the sun, she outshines all the constellations; compared with light, she takes first place,	المزايَا الكَثِيرَةَ، اللطيفَ السريعَ الحركة، الفصيحَ الطاهرَ النيرَ السليمَ المحبَّ للخير، الحديدَ الحرَّ المحسنَ، 23 المحبَّ للبشر، الثابتَ الراسخَ المطمئنَّ القديرَ الرقيبَ، الذي ينفذُ جميعَ الأرواحِ الفهمَةِ الطاهرة اللطيفة. 24 لَأَنَّ الْحِكْمَةَ أَسْرَعُ حَرَكَةً مِنْ كُلِّ مُتَحَرِّكٍ؛ فَهِيَ لَطَهَارَتِهَا تَلَجُّ وَتَنْفِذُ فِي كُلِّ شَيْءٍ. 25 فَإِنَّهَا بَخَارُ قُوَّةِ اللَّهِ، وَصُدُورُ مَجْدِ الْقَدِيرِ الْخَالِصِ؛ فَلِذَلِكَ لَا يَشُوبُهَا شَيْءٌ نَجَسٍ، 26 لِأَنَّهَا ضِيَاءُ النُّورِ الْأَزَلِيِّ، وَمِرَّةٌ عَمَلِ اللَّهِ النَّقِيَّةِ، وَصُورَةُ جُودَتِهِ. 27 تَقْدِرُ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، وَهِيَ وَاحِدَةٌ، وَتَجْدُدُ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ وَهِيَ ثَابِتَةٌ فِي ذَاتِهَا. وَفِي كُلِّ جِيلٍ تَحُلُّ فِي النَفُوسِ الْقَدِيسَةِ؛ فَتَنْشِئُ أَحِبَّاءَ لِلَّهِ وَأَنْبِيَاءَ، 28 لِأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُحِبُّ أَحَدًا؛ إِلَّا مَنْ يَسَاكُنُ الْحِكْمَةَ. 29 إِنَّهَا أَبْهَى مِنَ الشَّمْسِ،
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γὰρ αὕτη εὐπρεπεστέρα ἡλίου καὶ ὑπὲρ πᾶσαν ἄστρον θέσιν, φωτὶ συγκρινομένη, εὐρίσκεται προτέρα· 30 τοῦτο μὲν γὰρ διαδέχεται νύξ, σοφίας δὲ οὐ κατισχύει κακία.	³⁰ for light must yield to night, but against Wisdom evil cannot prevail.	وَأَسْمَى مِنْ كُلِّ مَرَكَزٍ لِلنَّجُومِ، وَإِذَا قِيسَتْ بِالنُّورِ تَقَدَّمَتْ عَلَيْهِ، 30 لِأَنَّ النُّورَ يَعْقِبُهُ اللَّيْلُ، أَمَّا الْحِكْمَةُ فَلَا يَغْلِبُهَا الشَّرُّ.
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الأصاح الثامن

ΔΙΑΤΕΙΝΕΙ δὲ ἀπὸ πέρας εἰς πέρας εὐρώστως καὶ διοικεῖ τὰ πάντα χρηστῶς. 2 Ταύτην ἐφίλησα καὶ ἐξεζήτησα ἐκ νεότητός μου καὶ ἐζήτησα νύμφην ἀγαγέσθαι ἐμαυτῷ καὶ ἐραστὴς ἐγενόμην τοῦ κάλλους αὐτῆς. 3 εὐγένειαν δοξάζει συμβίωσιν Θεοῦ ἔχουσα, καὶ ὁ πάντων δεσπότης ἠγάπησεν αὐτήν· 4 μύστις γὰρ ἐστὶ τῆς τοῦ Θεοῦ ἐπιστήμης καὶ αἰρετὶς τῶν ἔργων αὐτοῦ. 5 εἰ δὲ πλοῦτός ἐστιν ἐπιθυμητὸν κτῆμα ἐν βίῳ, τί σοφίας πλουσιώτερον τῆς τὰ πάντα ἐργαζομένης; 6 εἰ δὲ φρόνησις ἐργάζεται, τίς αὐτῆς τῶν ὄντων μᾶλλον ἐστὶ τεχνίτης; 7 καὶ εἰ δικαιοσύνην ἀγαπᾷ τις, οἱ πόνοι ταύτης εἰσὶν ἀρεταί·	¹ Strongly she reaches from one end of the world to the other and she governs the whole world for its good. ² Wisdom I loved and searched for from my youth; I resolved to have her as my bride, I fell in love with her beauty. ³ She enhances her noble birth by sharing God's life, for the Master of All has always loved her. ⁴ Indeed, she shares the secrets of God's knowledge, and she chooses what he will do. ⁵ If in this life wealth is a desirable possession, what is more wealthy than Wisdom whose work is everywhere? ⁶ Or if it be the intellect that is at work, who, more than she, designs whatever exists? ⁷ Or if it be uprightness you love,	1 إِنَّهَا تَبْلُغُ مِنْ غَايَةِ إِلَى غَايَةِ بِالْقُوَّةِ، وَتَدْبِرُ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ بِالرَّفْقِ. 2 لَقَدْ أَحْبَبْتُهَا وَالتَّمَسْتُهَا مِنْذُ صَبَائِي، وَابْتَغَيْتُ أَنْ أَتَّخِذَهَا لِي عَرُوسًا، وَصِرْتُ لِحِمَالِهَا عَاشِقًا. 3 فَإِنَّ فِي نَسَبِهَا مَجْدًا، لِأَنَّهَا تَحْيَا عِنْدَ اللَّهِ، وَرَبُّ الْجَمِيعِ قَدْ أَحَبَّهَا، 4 فَهِيَ صَاحِبَةُ أَسْرَارِ عِلْمِ اللَّهِ، وَالْمُتَخَيِّرَةُ لِأَعْمَالِهِ. 5 إِذَا كَانَ الْغَنَى مُلْكًا نَفِيسًا فِي الْحَيَاةِ؛ فَأَيُّ شَيْءٍ أَغْنَى مِنَ الْحِكْمَةِ صَانِعَةِ الْجَمِيعِ؟ 6 وَإِنْ كَانَتِ الْفُطْنَةُ هِيَ الَّتِي تَعْمَلُ؛ فَمَنْ أَحْكَمُ مِنْهَا فِي هِنْدَسَةِ الْأَكْوَانِ؟ 7 وَإِذَا كَانَ أَحَدٌ يُحِبُّ الْبِرَّ؛
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σωφροσύνην γὰρ καὶ
φρόνησιν ἐκδιδάσκει,
δικαιοσύνην καὶ ἀνδρείαν,
ᾧν χρησιμώτερον οὐδέν
ἐστὶν ἐν βίῳ ἀνθρώποις. 8
εἰ δὲ καὶ πολυπειρίαν ποθεῖ
τις, οἶδε τὰ ἀρχαῖα καὶ τὰ
μέλλοντα εἰκάζειν,
ἐπίσταται στροφὰς λόγων
καὶ λύσεις αἰνιγμάτων,
σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα
προγινώσκει καὶ ἐκβάσεις
καιρῶν καὶ χρόνων. 9
ἔκρινα τοίνυν ταύτην
ἀγαγέσθαι πρὸς
συμβίωσιν, εἰδὼς ὅτι ἔσται
μοι σύμβουλος ἀγαθῶν καὶ
παραίνεσις φροντίδων καὶ
λύπης. 10 ἔξω δι' αὐτὴν
δόξαν ἐν ὄχλοις καὶ τιμὴν
παρὰ πρεσβυτέροις ὁ νέος·
11 ὁξὺς εὐρεθήσομαι ἐν
κρίσει καὶ ἐν ὄψει
δυναστῶν θαυμασθήσομαι·
12 σιγῶντά με περιμενοῦσι
καὶ φθεγγομένῳ
προσέξουσιν καὶ λαλοῦντος
ἐπὶ πλεῖον χεῖρα
ἐπιθήσουσιν ἐπὶ στόμα
αὐτῶν. 13 ἔξω δι' αὐτὴν
ἀθανασίαν καὶ μνήμην
αἰώνιον τοῖς μετ' ἐμὲ
ἀπολείψω. 14 διοικήσω
λαοὺς, καὶ ἔθνη

why, virtues are the fruit of her
labours, since it is she who
teaches temperance and
prudence, justice and fortitude;
nothing in life is more useful for
human beings.

⁸ Or if you are eager for wide
experience, she knows the past,
she forecasts the future; she
knows how to turn maxims, and
solve riddles; she has
foreknowledge of signs and
wonders, and of the unfolding of
the ages and the times.

⁹ I therefore determined to take
her to share my life, knowing
that she would be my counsellor
in prosperity and comfort me in
cares and sorrow.

¹⁰ Thanks to her, I shall be
admired by the masses and
honoured, though young, by the
elders.

¹¹ I shall be reckoned shrewd as a
judge, and the great will be
amazed at me.

¹² They will wait on my silences,
and pay attention when I speak;
if I speak at some length,
they will lay their hand on their
lips.

¹³ By means of
her, immortality will be mine, I
shall leave an
everlasting memory to my

فَالْفَضَائِلُ هِيَ أَتْعَابُهَا، لِأَنَّهَا تَعْلَمُ
الْعِفَّةَ وَالْفُطْنَةَ وَالْعَدْلَ وَالْقُوَّةَ الَّتِي
لَا شَيْءٌ لِلنَّاسِ فِي الْحَيَاةِ أَنْفَعُ
مِنْهَا.

8 وَإِذَا كَانَ أَحَدٌ يُرْثِرُ أَنْوَاعَ
الْعِلْمِ؛ فَهِيَ تَعْرِفُ الْقَدِيمَ وَتَتَمَثَّلُ
الْمُسْتَقْبَلَ وَتَفْقَهُ فُنُونَ الْكَلَامِ
وَحُلَّ الْأَحَاجِي وَتَعْلَمُ الْآيَاتِ
وَالْعَجَائِبَ قَبْلَ أَنْ تَكُونَ،
وَحَوَادِثَ الْأَوْقَاتِ وَالْأَزْمَنَةِ.

9 لِذَلِكَ عَزَمْتُ أَنْ أَتَّخِذَهَا قَرِينَةً
لِحَيَاتِي، عِلْمًا بِأَنَّهَا تَكُونُ لِي
مُشِيرَةً بِالصَّالِحَاتِ، وَمُفْرِجَةً
لِهَمُومِي وَكَرْبِي.

10 فَيَكُونُ لِي بِهَا مَجْدٌ عِنْدَ
الْجَمُوعِ، وَكَرَامَةٌ لَدَى الشُّيُوخِ
عَلَى مَا أَنَا فِيهِ مِنَ الْفَتَاءِ،
11 وَأَعْدُ حَازِقًا فِي الْقَضَاءِ،
وَعَجَبًا أَمَامَ الْمُقْتَدِرِينَ.

12 إِذَا صَمْتُ يَنْتَظِرُونَ، وَإِذَا
نَطَقْتُ يَصْغُونَ، وَإِذَا أَفْضْتُ فِي
الْكَلَامِ يَضَعُونَ أَيْدِيَهُمْ عَلَى
أَفْوَاهِهِمْ.

13 وَأَنَالَ بِهَا الْخُلُودَ، وَأُخَلِّفُ
عِنْدَ الَّذِينَ بَعْدِي ذِكْرًا مُؤَبَّدًا.

ὑποταγήσεται μοι 15 φοβηθήσονται με ἀκούσαντες τύραννοι φρικτοί, ἐν πλήθει φανοῦμαι ἀγαθὸς καὶ ἐν πολέμῳ ἀνδρεῖος. 16 εἰσελθὼν εἰς τὸν οἶκόν μου προσαναπαύσομαι αὐτῇ· οὐ γὰρ ἔχει πικρίαν ἢ συναναστροφὴ αὐτῆς, οὐδὲ ὀδύνην ἢ συμβίωσις αὐτῆς, ἀλλὰ εὐφροσύνην καὶ χαράν. 17 ταῦτα λογισάμενος ἐν ἑμαυτῷ καὶ φροντίσας ἐν καρδίᾳ μου ὅτι ἐστὶν ἀθανασία ἐν συγγενείᾳ σοφίας 18 καὶ ἐν φιλίᾳ αὐτῆς τέρψις ἀγαθὴ καὶ ἐν πόνοις χειρῶν αὐτῆς πλοῦτος ἀνεκλιπῆς καὶ ἐν συγγυμνασίᾳ ὁμιλίας αὐτῆς φρόνησις καὶ εὐκλεία ἐν κοινωνίᾳ λόγων αὐτῆς, περιήειν ζητῶν ὅπως λάβω αὐτὴν εἰς ἑμαυτόν. 19 παῖς δὲ ἡμην εὐφυῆς ψυχῆς τε ἔλαχον ἀγαθῆς, 20 μᾶλλον δὲ ἀγαθὸς ὢν ἦλθον εἰς σῶμα ἀμίαντον. 21 γνοὺς δὲ ὅτι οὐκ ἄλλως ἔσομαι ἐγκρατῆς, ἐὰν μὴ ὁ Θεὸς δῶ -καὶ τοῦτο δ' ἦν φρονήσεως τὸ εἰδέναι τίνος ἢ χάρις-	successors. 14 I shall govern peoples, and nations will be subject to me; 15 at the sound of my name fearsome despots will be afraid; I shall show myself kind to the people and valiant in battle. 16 'When I go home I shall take my ease with her, for nothing is bitter in her company, when life is shared with her there is no pain, nothing but pleasure and joy.' 17 Having meditated on all this, and having come to the conclusion that immortality resides in kinship with Wisdom, 18 noble contentment in her friendship, inexhaustible riches in her activities, understanding in cultivating her society, and renown in conversing with her, I went all ways, seeking how to get her. 19 I was a boy of happy disposition, I had received a good soul as my lot, 20 or rather, being good, I had entered an undefiled body; 21 but, realising that I could never possess Wisdom unless God gave her to me, -a sign of intelligence	14 أَدْبِرُ الشُّعُوبَ، وَتَخْضَعُ لِي الْأُمَمُ. 15 يَسْمَعُ الْمُلُوكُ الْمَرْهُوبُونَ فِيخَافُونَنِي، وَيَظْهَرُ فِي الْجَمْعِ صَلَاحِي، وَفِي الْحَرْبِ بَأْسِي. 16 وَإِذَا دَخَلْتُ بَيْتِي سَكَنْتُ إِلَيْهَا، لِأَنَّهُ لَيْسَ فِي مَعَاشَرَتِهَا مَرَارَةٌ، وَلَا فِي الْحَيَاةِ مَعَهَا غَمَةٌ، بَلْ سُرُورٌ وَفَرَحٌ. 17 فَلَمَّا تَفَكَّرْتُ فِي نَفْسِي بِهَذِهِ، وَتَأَمَّلْتُ فِي قَلْبِي، أَنَّ فِي قُرْبَى الْحِكْمَةِ خُلُودًا، 18 وَفِي مُصَافَاتِهَا لَذَّةً صَالِحَةً، وَفِي أَتْعَابِ يَدَيْهَا غِنًى لَا يَنْقُصُ، وَفِي التَّرَشُّحِ لِمُؤَانَسَتِهَا فِطْنَةٌ، وَفِي الْإِشْتِرَاكِ فِي حَدِيثِهَا فَخْرٌ، طَفَقْتُ أَطُوفُ طَالِبًا أَنْ أَتَّخِذَهَا لِنَفْسِي. 19 وَقَدْ كُنْتُ صَبِيًّا حَسَنَ الطَّبَاعِ، وَرَزَقْتُ نَفْسًا صَالِحَةً، 20 ثُمَّ بَارِزِيَادِي صَالِحًا حَصَلْتُ عَلَى جَسَدٍ غَيْرِ مُدْنَسٍ. 21 وَلَمَّا عَلِمْتُ بِأَنِّي لَا أَكُونُ عَفِيفًا مَا لَمْ يَهْبِنِي اللَّهُ الْعَفَّةَ، وَقَدْ كَانَ مِنَ الْفِطْنَةِ أَنْ أَعْلَمَ مِمَّنْ هَذِهِ
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ἐνέτυχον τῷ Κυρίῳ καὶ ἐδεήθην αὐτοῦ καὶ εἶπον ἐξ ὅλης τῆς καρδίας μου,	in itself, to know in whose gift she lay -- I prayed to the Lord and entreated him, and with all my heart I said:	الموهبة، توجهت إلى الرب وسألتته من كل قلبي قائلاً:
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الأصحاح التاسع

ΘΕΕ πατέρων καὶ Κύριε τοῦ ἐλέους ὁ ποιήσας τὰ πάντα ἐν λόγῳ σου 2 καὶ τῇ σοφίᾳ σου κατεσκεύευσας ἄνθρωπον, ἵνα δεσπόζη τῶν ὑπὸ σοῦ γενομένων κτισμάτων 3 καὶ διέπη τὸν κόσμον ἐν ὁσιότητι καὶ δικαιοσύνῃ καὶ ἐν εὐθύτῃ ψυχῆς κρίσιν κρίνη, 4 δός μοι τὴν τῶν σῶν θρόνων πάρεδρον σοφίαν καὶ μὴ με ἀποδοκιμάσῃς ἐκ παίδων σου. 5 ὅτι ἐγὼ δοῦλος σὸς καὶ υἱὸς τῆς παιδίσκης σου, ἄνθρωπος ἀσθενὴς καὶ ὀλιγοχρόνιος καὶ ἐλάσσων ἐν συνέσει κρίσεως καὶ νόμων· 6 κἂν γάρ τις ᾗ τέλειος ἐν υἱοῖς ἀνθρώπων, τῆς ἀπὸ σοῦ σοφίας ἀπούσης, εἰς οὐδὲν λογισθήσεται. 7 σύ με προεῖλω βασιλέα λαοῦ σου καὶ δικαστὴν υἱῶν σου καὶ θυγατέρων· 8 εἶπας οἰκοδομῆσαι ναὸν ἐν ὄρει	¹ 'God of our ancestors, Lord of mercy, who by your word have made the universe, ² and in your wisdom have fitted human beings to rule the creatures that you have made, ³ to govern the world in holiness and saving justice and in honesty of soul to dispense fair judgement, ⁴ grant me Wisdom, consort of your throne, and do not reject me from the number of your children. ⁵ For I am your servant, son of your serving maid, a feeble man, with little time to live, with small understanding of justice and the laws. ⁶ Indeed, were anyone perfect among the sons of men, if he lacked the Wisdom that comes from you, he would still count for nothing. ⁷ 'You have chosen me to be king over your people, to be judge of your sons and daughters.	1 يَا إِلَهَ الْأَبَاءِ، يَا رَبَّ الرَّحْمَةِ، يَا صَانِعَ الْجَمِيعِ بِكَلِمَتِكَ، 2 وَفَاطَرَ الْإِنْسَانَ بِحُكْمَتِكَ، لِكَيْ يَسُودَ عَلَى الْخَلَائِقِ الَّتِي كَوْنَتْهَا، 3 وَيَسُوسَ الْعَالَمَ بِالْقَدَاسَةِ وَالْبَرِّ، وَيَجْرِيَ الْحُكْمَ بِاسْتِقَامَةِ النَّفْسِ. 4 هَبْ لِي الْحِكْمَةَ الْجَالِسَةَ إِلَيَّ عَرْشِكَ، وَلَا تَرُدَّنِي مِنْ بَيْنِ بَنِيكَ، 5 فَإِنِّي أَنَا عَبْدُكَ وَابْنُ أَمَتِكَ، إِنْسَانٌ ضَعِيفٌ قَلِيلُ الْبَقَاءِ، وَنَاقِصُ الْفَهْمِ فِي الْقَضَاءِ وَالشَّرَائِعِ. 6 عَلَى أَنَّهُ إِنْ كَانَ فِي بَنِي الْبَشَرِ أَحَدٌ كَامِلٌ؛ فَمَا لَمْ تَكُنْ مَعَهُ الْحِكْمَةُ الَّتِي مِنْكَ، لَا يَحْسَبُ شَيْئًا. 7 إِنَّكَ قَدْ اخْتَرْتَنِي لِشَعْبِكَ
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ἀγίῳ σου καὶ ἐν πόλει
κατασκηνώσεώς σου
θυσιαστήριον, μίμημα
σκηνῆς ἁγίας, ἣν
προητοίμασας ἀπ' ἀρχῆς. 9
καὶ μετὰ σοῦ ἡ σοφία ἡ
εἰδυῖα τὰ ἔργα σου καὶ
παρουῖσα, ὅτε ἐποίεις τὸν
κόσμον, καὶ ἐπισταμένη τί
ἀρεστὸν ἐν ὀφθαλμοῖς σου
καὶ τί εὐθὲς ἐν ἐντολαῖς
σου. 10 ἐξαπόστειλον
αὐτήν ἐξ ἁγίων οὐρανῶν
καὶ ἀπὸ θρόνου δόξης σου
πέμψον αὐτήν, ἵνα
συμπαρουσά μοι κοπιάσῃ
καὶ γνῶ τί εὐάρεστόν ἐστι
παρά σοί. 11 οἶδε γὰρ
ἐκείνη πάντα καὶ συνίει καὶ
ὁδηγήσει με ἐν ταῖς
πράξεσί μου σωφρόνως καὶ
φυλάξει με ἐν τῇ δόξῃ
αὐτῆς. 12 καὶ ἔσται
προσδεκτὰ τὰ ἔργα μου,
καὶ διακρινῶ τὸν λαόν σου
δικαίως καὶ ἔσομαι ἄξιος
θρόνων πατρὸς μου. 13 τίς
γὰρ ἄνθρωπος γνώσεται
βουλὴν Θεοῦ; ἢ τίς
ἐνθυμηθήσεται τί θέλει ὁ
Κύριος; 14 λογισμοὶ γὰρ
θνητῶν δειλοί, καὶ
ἐπισφαλεῖς αἱ ἐπίνοιαι
ἡμῶν. 15 φθαρτὸν γὰρ

⁸ You have bidden me build
a temple on your holy mountain,
and an altar in the city where you
have pitched your tent, a copy of
the holy Tent which you prepared
at the beginning.

⁹ With you is Wisdom, she who
knows your works, she who was
present when you made the
world; she understands what is
pleasing in your eyes and what
agrees with your
commandments.

¹⁰ Despatch her from the holy
heavens, send her forth from
your throne of glory to help me
and to toil with me and teach me
what is pleasing to you;

¹¹ since she knows and
understands everything
she will guide me prudently in my
actions and will protect me with
her glory.

¹² Then all I do will be acceptable,
I shall govern your people justly
and be worthy of my father's
throne.

¹³ 'What human being indeed can
know the intentions of God? And
who can comprehend the will of
the Lord?

¹⁴ For the reasoning of mortals is
inadequate, our attitudes
of mind unstable;

¹⁵ for a perishable body presses

ملكا، ولبنيك وبناتك قاضيا،
8 وَأَمَرْتَنِي أَنْ أَبْنِيَ هَيْكَلًا فِي
جَبَلٍ قُدْسِكَ، وَمَذْبَحًا فِي مَدِينَةِ
سُكْنَاكَ عَلَى مِثَالِ الْمَسْكَنِ
الْمُقَدَّسِ الَّذِي هَيَّأْتَهُ مِنْذُ الْبَدَءِ.
9 إِنَّ مَعَكَ الْحِكْمَةَ الْعَلِيمَةَ
بِأَعْمَالِكَ، وَالَّتِي كَانَتْ حَاضِرَةً
إِذْ صَنَعْتَ الْعَالَمَ، وَهِيَ عَارِفَةٌ مَا
الْمَرْضِيُّ فِي عَيْنِكَ، وَالْمُسْتَقِيمُ
فِي وَصَايَاكَ،

10 فَأَرْسَلَهَا مِنَ السَّمَوَاتِ
الْمُقَدَّسَةِ، وَابْعَثَهَا مِنْ عَرْشِ
مَجْدِكَ، حَتَّى إِذَا حَضَرَتْ تَجِدَ
مَعِيَ، وَأَعْلَمَ مَا الْمَرْضِيُّ لَدَيْكَ.
11 فَإِنَّهَا تَعْلَمُ وَتَفْهَمُ كُلَّ
شَيْءٍ؛ فَتَكُونُ لِي فِي أَعْمَالِي
مُرْشِدًا فَطِينًا، وَبِعِزِّهَا تَحْفَظُنِي،
12 فَتَعْدُو أَعْمَالِي مَقْبُولَةً،
وَأَحْكُمُ لَشَعْبِكَ بِالْعَدْلِ، وَأَكُونُ
أَهْلًا لِعَرْشِ أَبِي.

13 فَأَيُّ إِنْسَانٍ يَعْلَمُ مَشُورَةَ
اللَّهِ، أَوْ يَفْطِنُ لِمَا يُرِيدُ الرَّبُّ؟
14 إِنَّ أَفْكَارَ الْبَشَرِ ذَاتُ
إِحْجَامٍ، وَبَصَائِرُنَا غَيْرُ رَاسِخَةٍ،
15 إِذِ الْجَسَدُ الْفَاسِدُ يَثْقُلُ

σῶμα βαρύνει ψυχὴν, καὶ βρίθει τὸ γεῶδες σκῆνος νοῦν πολυφρόντιδα. 16 καὶ μόλις εἰκάζομεν τὰ ἐπὶ γῆς καὶ τὰ ἐν χερσὶν εὐρίσκομεν μετὰ πόνου· τὰ δὲ ἐν οὐρανοῖς τίς ἐξιχνίασε; 17 βουλήν δέ σου τίς ἔγων, εἰ μὴ σὺ ἔδωκας σοφίαν καὶ ἔπεμψας τὸ ἅγιόν σου πνεῦμα ἀπὸ ὑψίστων; 18 καὶ οὕτως διωρθώθησαν αἱ τρίβοι τῶν ἐπὶ γῆς, καὶ τὰ ἀρεστά σου ἐδιδάχθησαν ἄνθρωποι, 19 καὶ τῇ σοφίᾳ ἐσώθησαν.	down the soul, and this tent of clay weighs down the mind with its many cares. ¹⁶ It is hard enough for us to work out what is on earth, laborious to know what lies within our reach; who, then, can discover what is in the heavens? ¹⁷ And who could ever have known your will, had you not given Wisdom and sent your holy Spirit from above? ¹⁸ Thus have the paths of those on earth been straightened and people have been taught what pleases you, and have been saved, by Wisdom.'	النَّفْسُ، وَالْمَسْكَنُ الْأَرْضِيَّ يُخَفِّضُ الْعَقْلَ الْكَثِيرَ الْهَمُومِ. 16 وَنَحْنُ بِالْجَهْدِ نَتَمَثَّلُ مَا عَلَى الْأَرْضِ، وَبِالْكَدِ نَدْرِكُ مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِينَا، فَمَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ مَنْ اطَّلَعَ عَلَيْهِ؟ 17 وَمَنْ عَلِمَ مَشُورَتَكَ لَوْ لَمْ تُؤْتِ الْحِكْمَةَ، وَتَبْعَثَ رُوحَكَ الْقُدُّوسَ مِنَ الْأَعَالِي؟ 18 فَإِنَّهُ كَذَلِكَ قَوْمَتْ سَبِيلُ الَّذِينَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ، وَتَعَلَّمَ النَّاسُ مَرْضَاتَكَ، 19 وَالْحِكْمَةُ هِيَ الَّتِي خَلَّصَتْ كُلَّ مَنْ أَرْضَاكَ، يَا رَبِّ، مِنْذُ الْبَدْءِ.
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الأصحاح العاشر

ΑΥΤΗ πρωτόπλαστον πατέρα κόσμου μόνον κτισθέντα διεφύλαξε καὶ ἐξείλατο αὐτὸν ἐκ παραπτώματος ἰδίου 2 ἔδωκε τε αὐτῷ ἰσχὺν κρατῆσαι πάντων. 3 ἀποστάς δὲ ἀπ' αὐτῆς ἄδικος ἐν ὀργῇ αὐτοῦ, ἀδελφοκτόνοις συναπώλετο θυμοῖς· 4 δι' ὃν	¹ It was Wisdom who protected the first man to be fashioned, the father of the world, who had been created all alone, she it was who rescued him from his fall ² and gave him the strength to subjugate all things. ³ But when in his wrath a wicked man deserted her, he perished in his fratricidal fury.	1 هِيَ الَّتِي حَفَظَتْ أَوَّلَ مَنْ جَبَلَ أَبًا لِلْعَالَمِ لَمَّا خُلِقَ وَحْدَهُ، 2 وَأَنْقَذَتْهُ مِنْ زَلَّتِهِ، وَأَتَتْهُ قُوَّةٌ لِيَتَسَلَّطَ عَلَى الْجَمِيعِ. 3 وَلَمَّا ارْتَدَّ عَنْهَا الظَّالِمُ فِي غَضَبِهِ، هَلَكَ فِي حَنَقِ الَّذِي كَانَ بِهِ قَاتِلَ أَخِيهِ. 4 وَلَمَّا غَمَرَ الطُّوفَانُ الْأَرْضَ
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κατακλυζομένην γῆν πάλιν
διέσωσε σοφία, δι' εὐτελοῦς
ξύλου τὸν δίκαιον
κυβερνήσασα. 5 αὕτη καὶ ἐν
ὁμοιοῖα πονηρίας ἐθνῶν
συγχυθέντων ἔγνω τὸν
δίκαιον καὶ ἐτήρησεν αὐτὸν
ἄμεμπτον Θεῷ καὶ ἐπὶ
τέκνου σπλάγχνοις ἰσχυρὸν
ἐφύλαξεν. 6 αὕτη δίκαιον
ἐξαπολλυμένων ἀσεβῶν
ἐρρύσατο φυγόντα πῦρ
καταβάσιον Πενταπόλεως· 7
ἥς ἔτι μαρτύριον τῆς
πονηρίας καπνιζομένη
καθέστηκε χέρσος, καὶ
ἀτελέσιν ὥραις
καρποφοροῦντα φυτά,
ἀπιστοῦσης ψυχῆς μνημεῖον
ἐστηκυῖα στήλη ἀλός. 8
σοφίαν γὰρ παροδεύσαντες
οὐ μόνον ἐβλάβησαν τοῦ μὴ
γνῶναι τὰ καλά, ἀλλὰ καὶ
τῆς ἀφροσύνης ἀπέλιπον τῷ
βίῳ μνημόσυνον, ἵνα ἐν οἷς
ἐσφάλησαν μηδὲ λαθεῖν
δυνηθῶσι. 9 σοφία δὲ τοὺς
θεραπεύσαντας αὐτὴν ἐκ
πόνων ἐρρύσατο. 10 αὕτη
φυγάδα ὀργῆς ἀδελφοῦ
δίκαιον ὠδήγησεν ἐν τρίβοις
εὐθείαις· ἔδειξεν αὐτῷ
βασιλείαν Θεοῦ καὶ ἔδωκεν
αὐτῷ γνῶσιν ἀγίων·

⁴ When because of him the
earth was drowned, it
was Wisdom again who saved it,
piloting the upright man on
valueless timber.

⁵ Again, when, concurring in
wickedness, the nations had
been thrown into confusion, she
singled out the upright man,
preserved him blameless
before God and fortified him
against pity for his child.

⁶ She it was who, while the
godless perished, saved the
upright man as he fled from the
fire raining down on the Five
Cities,

⁷ in witness against
whose evil ways a desolate land
still smokes, where plants bear
fruit that never ripens and
where, monument to an
unbelieving soul, there stands a
pillar of salt.

⁸ For, by ignoring the path of
Wisdom, not only did they suffer
the loss of not knowing the
good, but they left the world a
memorial to their folly, so that
their offences could not pass
unnoticed.

⁹ But Wisdom delivered her
servants from their ordeals.

¹⁰ The upright man, fleeing from
the anger of his brother, was led

بسببه، عَادَتِ الْحِكْمَةُ فَخَلَصَتْهَا
بِهَدَايَتِهَا لِلصِّدِّيقِ فِي آلَةِ خَشَبٍ
حَقِيرَةٍ.

5 وَهِيَ الَّتِي عِنْدَ اتِّفَاقٍ لَفِيفٍ
الْأُمَمِ عَلَى الشَّرِّ، لَقِيَتْ الصِّدِّيقَ
وَصَاتَتْهُ لِلَّهِ بِغَيْرِ وَصْمَةٍ،
وَحَفِظَتْ أَحْشَاءَهُ صَمَاءً عَنْ
وَلَدِهِ.

6 وَهِيَ الَّتِي أَنْقَذَتِ الصِّدِّيقَ مِنَ
الْمُنَافِقِينَ الْهَالِكِينَ؛ فَهَرَبَ مِنَ
النَّارِ الْهَابِطَةِ عَلَى الْمُدُنِ
الْخَمْسِ.

7 وَإِلَى الْآنَ يَشْهَدُ بِشَرِّهِمْ قَفَرٌ
يَسْطَعُ مِنْهُ الدُّخَانُ، وَنَبَاتٌ يَشْمُرُ
ثَمَرًا لَا يَنْضِجُ، وَعَمُودٌ مِنْ مِلْحٍ
قَائِمٌ تَذَكُّارًا لِنَفْسٍ لَمْ تُؤْمِنْ.
8 وَالَّذِينَ أَهْمَلُوا الْحِكْمَةَ، لَمْ

يَنْحَصِرْ ظَلَمُهُمْ لِأَنْفُسِهِمْ
بِجَهْلِهِمُ الصَّلَاحَ، وَلَكِنَّهُمْ خَلَفُوا
لِلنَّاسِ ذِكْرَ حِمَاقَتِهِمْ، بِحَيْثُ لَمْ
يَسْتَطِيعُوا كِتْمَانَ مَا زَلُّوا فِيهِ.

9 وَأَمَّا الَّذِينَ خَدَمُوا الْحِكْمَةَ؛
فَأَنْقَذَتْهُمْ مِنْ كُلِّ نَصَبٍ.

10 وَهِيَ الَّتِي قَادَتِ الصِّدِّيقَ
الْهَارِبَ مِنْ غَضَبِ أَخِيهِ فِي

εὐπόρησεν αὐτὸν ἐν μόχθοις
καὶ ἐπλήθυνε τοὺς πόνους
αὐτοῦ· 11 ἐν πλεονεξία
κατισχυόντων αὐτὸν
παρέστη καὶ ἐπλούτισεν
αὐτόν· 12 διεφύλαξεν αὐτὸν
ἀπὸ ἐχθρῶν, καὶ ἀπὸ
ἐνεδρευόντων ἠσφαλίσατο
καὶ ἀγῶνα ἰσχυρὸν
ἐβράβευσεν αὐτῷ, ἵνα γνῶ,
ὅτι παντὸς δυνατωτέρα
ἐστὶν εὐσέβεια. 13 αὕτη
πραθέντα δίκαιον οὐκ
ἐγκατέλιπεν, ἀλλὰ ἐξ
ἀμαρτίας ἐρρύσατο αὐτόν·
14 συγκατέβη αὐτῷ εἰς
λάκκον καὶ ἐν δεσμοῖς οὐκ
ἀφῆκεν αὐτόν, ἕως ἡνεγκεν
αὐτῷ σκῆπτρα βασιλείας καὶ
ἐξουσίαν τυραννούντων
αὐτοῦ· ψευδεῖς τε ἔδειξε τοὺς
μωμησαμένους αὐτόν καὶ
ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ δόξαν αἰώνιον.
15 αὕτη λαὸν ὅσιον καὶ
σπέρμα ἄμεμπτον ἐρρύσατο
ἐξ ἔθνους θλιβόντων· 16
εἰσῆλθεν εἰς ψυχὴν
θεράποντος Κυρίου καὶ
ἀντέστη βασιλεῦσι φοβεροῖς
ἐν τέρασι καὶ σημείοις. 17
ἀπέδωκεν ὀσίοις μισθὸν
κόπων αὐτῶν, ὠδήγησεν
αὐτοὺς ἐν ὁδῷ θαυμαστῇ
καὶ ἐγένετο αὐτοῖς εἰς

by her along straight paths. She
showed him the kingdom
of God and taught him
the knowledge of holy things.
She brought him success in his
labours and gave him full return
for all his efforts;

¹¹ she stood by him against
grasping and oppressive men
and she made him rich.

¹² She preserved him from his
enemies and saved him from the
traps they set for him. In an
arduous struggle she awarded
him the prize, to teach him that
piety is stronger than all.

¹³ She did not forsake the
upright man when he was sold,
but snatched him away from sin;

¹⁴ she accompanied him down
into the pit, nor did she
abandon him in his chains until
she had brought him the sceptre
of a kingdom and authority over
his despotic masters, thus
exposing as liars those who had
traduced him, and giving
him honour everlasting.

¹⁵ It was Wisdom who delivered
a holy people, a blameless race,
from a nation of oppressors.

¹⁶ She entered the soul of a
servant of the Lord, and
withstood fearsome kings with
wonders and signs.

سَبِيلَ مُسْتَقِيمَةٍ، وَأَرَتَهُ مَلَكُوتَ
اللَّهِ، وَأَتَتْهُ عِلْمَ الْقُدِّيسِينَ،
وَأَنْجَحَتْهُ فِي أَتْعَابِهِ، وَأَكْثَرَتْ
ثَمَرَاتِ أَعْمَالِهِ.

11 وَعِنْدَ طَمَاعَةِ الْمُسْتَطِيلِينَ
عَلَيْهِ، أَنْتَصَبَتْ لِمَعُونَتِهِ وَأَغْنَتْهُ،
12 وَوَقَّتَهُ مِنْ أَعْدَائِهِ، وَحَمَّتَهُ

مِنَ الْكَامِنِينَ لَهُ، وَأَظْفَرَتْهُ فِي
الْقِتَالِ الشَّدِيدِ، لِكَيْ يَعْلَمَ أَنَّ
التَّقْوَى أَقْدَرُ مِنْ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ.

13 وَهِيَ الَّتِي لَمْ تَخْذُلِ الصَّدِيقَ
الْمُبِيعَ، بَلْ صَانَتْهُ مِنَ الْخَطِيئَةِ،
وَنَزَلَتْ مَعَهُ فِي الْحَبِّ.

14 وَفِي الْقَيْودِ لَمْ تُفَارِقْهُ، حَتَّى
نَاوَلَتْهُ صَوَالِحَةَ الْمَلِكِ، وَسُلْطَانًا
عَلَى الَّذِينَ قَسَرُوهُ، وَكَذَبَتْ
الَّذِينَ عَابَوْهُ، وَأَتَتْهُ مَجْدًا أَبَدِيًّا.

15 وَهِيَ الَّتِي أَنْقَذَتْ شَعْبًا
مُقَدَّسًا، وَذَرِيَّةً لَا وَصْمَةَ فِيهَا مِنْ
أُمَّةٍ مُضَايِقِيهِمْ.

16 وَحَلَّتْ نَفْسَ عَبْدٍ لِلرَّبِّ،
وَقَاوَمَتْ مَلُوكًا مَرَهُوِينَ

بِعَجَائِبِ وَأَيَّاتِ.

17 وَجَزَتْ الْقُدِّيسِينَ ثَوَابَ
أَتْعَابِهِمْ، وَقَادَتْهُمْ فِي طَرِيقِ

σκέπην ἡμέρας καὶ εἰς φλόγα ἄστρων τὴν νύκτα. 18 διεβίβασεν αὐτοὺς θάλασσαν ἐρυθρὰν καὶ διήγαγεν αὐτοὺς δι' ὕδατος πολλοῦ. 19 τοὺς δὲ ἐχθροὺς αὐτῶν κατέκλυσε καὶ ἐκ βάθους ἀβύσσου ἀνέβρασεν αὐτούς. 20 διὰ τοῦτο δίκαιοι ἐσκύλευσαν ἀσεβεῖς καὶ ὑμνησαν, Κύριε, τὸ ὄνομα τὸ ἅγιόν σου, τὴν τε ὑπέρμαχόν σου χεῖρα ἤνεσαν ὁμοθυμαδόν. 21 ὅτι ἡ σοφία ἤνοιξε στόμα κωφῶν καὶ γλώσσας νηπίων ἔθηκε τρανάς.	¹⁷ To the holy people she gave the wages of their labours; she guided them by a marvellous road, herself their shelter by day -- and their starlight through the night. ¹⁸ She brought them across the Red Sea, leading them through an immensity of water, ¹⁹ whereas she drowned their enemies, then spat them out from the depths of the abyss. ²⁰ So the upright despoiled the godless; Lord, they extolled your holy name, and with one accord praised your protecting hand; ²¹ for Wisdom opened the mouths of the dumb and made eloquent the tongues of babes.	عَجِيبٌ، وَكَانَتْ لَهُمْ ظِلًّا فِي النَّهَارِ، وَضِيَاءَ نُجُومٍ فِي اللَّيْلِ. 18 وَعَبَّرَتْ بِهِمُ الْبَحْرَ الْأَحْمَرَ، وَأَجَازَتْهُمْ الْمِيَاهَ الْغَزِيرَةَ. 19 أَمَّا أَعْدَاؤُهُمْ فَأَغْرَقَتْهُمْ، ثُمَّ قَذَفَتْهُمْ مِنْ عُمُقِ الْغَمَارِ عَلَى الشَّاطِئِ؛ فَسَلَبَ الصَّدِيقُونَ الْمُنَافِقِينَ، 20 وَرَنَمُوا لِاسْمِكَ الْقُدُّوسِ، أَيُّهَا الرَّبُّ، وَحَمَدُوا بِقَلْبٍ وَاحِدٍ يَدَكَ النَّاصِرَةَ، 21 لِأَنَّ الْحِكْمَةَ فَتَحَتْ أَفْوَاهَ الْبُكْمِ، وَجَعَلَتْ أَلْسِنَةَ الْأَطْفَالِ تُفَصِّحُ.
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الأصحاح الحادي عشر

ΕΥΩΔΩΣΕ τὰ ἔργα αὐτῶν ἐν χειρὶ προφήτου ἁγίου. 2 διώδευσαν ἔρημον ἀοίκητον καὶ ἐν ἀβάτοις ἔπηξαν σκηνάς. 3 ἀντέστησαν πολεμίοις καὶ ἠμύναντο ἐχθρούς. 4 ἐδίψησαν καὶ ἐπεκαλέσαντό σε, καὶ ἐδόθη αὐτοῖς ἐκ πέτρας ἀκροτόμου ὕδωρ καὶ ἱάμα δίψης ἐκ λίθου σκληροῦ. 5	¹ She made their actions successful, by means of a holy prophet. ² They journeyed through an unpeopled desert and pitched their tents in inaccessible places. ³ They stood firm against their enemies, fought off their foes. ⁴ On you they called when they were thirsty, and from the rocky cliff water was given them, from hard stone a remedy for their	1 ثُمَّ سَدَدْتَ مَسَاعِيَهُمْ بِإِرشَادِ نَبِيِّ قَدِيسٍ، 2 فَسَارُوا فِي بَرِيَّةٍ لَا سَاكنَ بِهَا، وَضَرَبُوا أَخْيَيتَهُمْ فِي أَرْضٍ قَفْرَةٍ، 3 وَقَاوَمُوا مُحَارِبِيَهُمْ، وَدَافَعُوا أَعْدَاءَهُمْ. 4 وَفِي عَطَشِهِمْ دَعَا إِلَيْكَ؛ فَأَعْطَوْا مَاءً مِنْ صَخْرَةِ الصَّوَّانِ، وَشَفَاءً لَغَلِيلِهِمْ مِنَ الْحَجَرِ الْجَلْمُودِ.
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δι' ὧν γὰρ ἐκολάσθησαν οἱ ἐχθροὶ αὐτῶν, διὰ τούτων αὐτοὶ ἀποροῦντες εὐεργετήθησαν. 6 ἀντὶ μὲν πηγῆς ἀεννάου ποταμοῦ αἵματι λυθρώδει ταραχθέντος 7 εἰς ἔλεγχον νηπιοκτόνου διατάγματος, ἔδωκας αὐτοῖς δαψιλὲς ὕδωρ ἀνελπίστως, 8 δείξας διὰ τοῦ τότε δίψους πῶς τοὺς ὑπεναντίους ἐκόλασας. 9 ὅτε γὰρ ἐπειράσθησαν, καὶ περ ἐν ἐλέει παιδευόμενοι, ἔγνωσαν πῶς ἐν ὀργῇ κρινόμενοι ἀσεβεῖς ἐβασανίζοντο. 10 τούτους μὲν γὰρ ὡς πατὴρ νοουθετῶν ἐδοκίμασας, ἐκείνους δὲ ὡς ἀπότομος βασιλεὺς καταδικάζων ἐξήτασας. 11 καὶ ἀπόντες δὲ καὶ παρόντες ὁμοίως ἐτρύχοντο. 12 διπλῇ γὰρ αὐτοὺς ἔλαβε λύπη· καὶ στεναγμὸς μνημῶν τῶν παρελθόντων. 13 ὅτε γὰρ ἤκουσαν διὰ τῶν ιδίων κολάσεων εὐεργετουμένους αὐτούς, ἦσθοντο τοῦ Κυρίου. 14 ὃν γὰρ ἐν ἐκθέσει πάλαι ριφέντα ἀπεῖπον	thirst. ⁵ Thus, what had served to punish their enemies became a benefit for them in their difficulties. ⁶ Whereas their enemies had only the ever-flowing source of a river fouled with mingled blood and mud, ⁷ to punish them for their decree of infanticide, you gave your people, against all hope, water in abundance, ⁸ once you had shown by the thirst that they were experiencing how severely you were punishing their enemies. ⁹ From their own ordeals, which were only loving correction, they realised how an angry sentence was tormenting the godless; ¹⁰ for you had tested your own as a father admonishes, but the others you had punished as a pitiless king condemns, ¹¹ and, whether far or near, they were equally afflicted. ¹² For a double sorrow seized on them, and a groaning at the memory of the past; ¹³ when they learned that the punishments they were receiving were beneficial to the	5 فَكَانَ الَّذِي عَذَّبَ بِهِ أَعْدَاؤَهُمْ، إِذْ أَعْوَزَهُمْ مَا يَشْرَبُونَ، وَبَنُو إِسْرَائِيلَ مُتَهَلِّلُونَ بِكَثْرَتِهِ، 6 هُوَ الَّذِي أَحْسَنَ بِهِ إِلَيْهِمْ فِي عَوَزِهِمْ. 7 فَإِنَّكَ بَلَبْتَ أَوْلَيْكَ، إِذْ بَدَلْتَهُمْ بِمَعِينِ النَّهْرِ الدَّائِمِ دَمًا صَدِيدًا، 8 عِقَابًا لَهُمْ عَلَى قَضَائِهِمْ بِقَتْلِ الْأَطْفَالِ، وَهَؤُلَاءِ أَعْطَيْتَهُمْ مَاءً غَزِيرًا عِنْدَ الْيَأْسِ مِنْهُ، 9 لَكِي تَرِيَهُمْ بَعْطَشَهُمْ هَذَا، كَيْفَ عَاقَبْتَ أَضْدَادَهُمْ. 10 فَإِنَّهُمْ بِامْتِحَانِكَ لَهُمْ، وَإِنْ كَانَ تَأْدِيبٌ رَحْمَةً، فَهَمُّوا كَيْفَ كَانَ عَذَابُ الْمُنَافِقِينَ الْمَقْضِي عَلَيْهِمْ بِالْغَضَبِ. 11 لِأَنَّكَ جَرَبْتَ هَؤُلَاءِ كَأَبٍ، إِنْذَارًا لَهُمْ، وَأَوْلَيْكَ ابْتَلَيْتَهُمْ كَمَلِكٍ قَاسٍ قَضَاءً عَلَيْهِمْ. 12 وَقَدْ مَسَّهُمْ فِي الْغَيْبِ مِنَ الضَّرِّ مَا مَسَّهُمْ فِي الْمَشْهَدِ، 13 إِذْ أَخَذَهُمْ ضِعْفَانِ مِنَ الْحُزَنِ وَالنَّحِيبِ، بِتَذَكُّرِ الضَّرَبَاتِ السَّالِفَةِ، 14 لِأَنَّهُمْ لَمَّا سَمِعُوا أَنَّ مَا كَانَ لَهُمْ عِقَابًا، صَارَ لِأَعْدَائِهِمْ إِحْسَانًا،
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χλευάζοντες, ἐπὶ τέλει
τῶν ἐκβάσεων
ἐθαύμασαν, οὐχ ὅμοια
δικαίοις διψήσαντες. 15
ἀντὶ δὲ λογισμῶν
ἀσυνέτων ἀδικίας αὐτῶν,
ἐν οἷς πλανηθέντες
ἐθρήσκευον ἄλογα ἐρπετὰ
καὶ κνώδαλα εὐτελῇ,
ἐπαπέστειλας αὐτοῖς
πληθος ἀλόγων ζώων εἰς
ἐκδίκησιν, 16 ἵνα γνῶσιν
ὅτι δι' ὧν τις ἁμαρτάνει,
διὰ τούτων κολάζεται. 17
οὐ γὰρ ἠπόρει ἡ
παντοδύναμός σου χεὶρ
καὶ κτίσασα τὸν κόσμον ἐξ
ἀμόρφου ὕλης ἐπιπέμψαι
αὐτοῖς πληθος ἄρκων ἢ
θρασεῖς λέοντας 18 ἢ
νεοκτίστους θυμοῦ
πλήρεις θήρας ἀγνώστους
ἦτοι πυρπνόον φυσῶντας
ἄσθμα ἢ βρόμους
λικμωμένους καπνοῦ ἢ
δεινούς ἀπ' ὀμμάτων
σπινθήρας ἀστράπτοντας,
19 ὧν οὐ μόνον ἡ βλάβη
ἠδύνατο συνεκτριῖσθαι
αὐτούς, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἡ ὄψις
ἐκφοβήσασα διολέσαι. 20
καὶ χωρὶς δὲ τούτων, ἐνὶ
πνεύματι πεσεῖν ἐδύναντο
ὑπὸ τῆς δίκης διωχθέντες

others, they realised it was the
Lord,

¹⁴ while for the man whom long
before they had exposed and
later mockingly rebuffed, they
felt only admiration when all
was done, having suffered a
thirst so different from that of
the upright.

¹⁵ For their foolish and wicked
notions which led them astray
into worshipping mindless
reptiles and contemptible
beetles, you sent a horde of
mindless animals to punish
them

¹⁶ and to teach them that the
agent of sin is the agent of
punishment.

¹⁷ And indeed your all-powerful
hand which created the world
from formless matter, did not
lack means to unleash a horde
of bears or savage lions on them

¹⁸ or unknown beasts, newly
created, full of rage, breathing
out fire, or puffing out stinking
smoke, or flashing fearful sparks
from their eyes,

¹⁹ beasts able not only to
destroy them, being so savage,
but even to strike them dead by
their terrifying appearance.

²⁰ However, without these, one
breath could have blown them

شَعَرُوا بِيَدِ الرَّبِّ
15 وَالَّذِي قَضَوْا مِنْ قَبْلِ بَطْرَحِهِ
فِي النَّهْرِ، وَاسْتَخَفُّوا بِهِ وَرَذَلُوهُ
اسْتَعْظَمُوهُ فِي آخِرِ الْأَمْرِ، إِذْ كَانَ
عَطَشُ الصَّدِيقِينَ عَلَى خِلَافِ
عَطَشِهِمْ.

16 وَإِذْ كَانُوا قَدْ سَفَهُوا فِي
أَفْكَارِهِمُ الْأَثِيمَةَ، وَضَلُّوا حَتَّى
عَبَدُوا زَحَافَاتٍ حَقِيرَةً وَوَحُوشًا لَا
نُطْقَ لَهَا، أَنْتَقَمْتَ مِنْهُمْ بِأَنْ أَرْسَلْتَ
عَلَيْهِمْ جَمًّا مِنَ الْحَيَوَانَاتِ الَّتِي لَا
نُطْقَ لَهَا،

17 لِكَيْ يَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ مَا خَطِيئَ بِهِ
أَحَدٌ بِهِ يُعَاقَبُ.

18 وَلَمْ يَكُنْ صَعْبًا عَلَى يَدِكَ
الْقَادِرَةِ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، الَّتِي صَنَعَتْ
الْعَالَمَ مِنْ مَادَّةٍ غَيْرِ مُصَوَّرَةٍ، أَنْ
تَبْعَثَ عَلَيْهِمْ جَمًّا مِنَ الْأَدْبَابِ أَوْ
الْأَسُودِ الْبَاسِلَةِ،

19 أَوْ مِنْ أَصْنَافٍ جَدِيدَةٍ لَمْ
تُعَرَفْ مِنَ الْوَحُوشِ الضَّارِيَةِ، الَّتِي
تَنْفُخُ نَارًا أَوْ تَبْعَثُ دُخَانًا قَاتِمًا أَوْ
تُرْسِلُ مِنْ عَيُونِهَا شَرَارًا مُخِيفًا.

20 إِذِنْ لَكَانَتْ تَهْلِكُهُمْ خَوْفًا مِنْ
مَنْظَرِهَا، فَضْلًا عَنْ أَنْ تَهْشِمَهُمْ

καὶ λικμηθέντες ὑπὸ
πνεύματος δυνάμεώς σου·
ἀλλὰ πάντα μέτρῳ καὶ
ἀριθμῷ καὶ σταθμῷ
διέταξας. 21 τὸ γὰρ
μεγάλως ἰσχύειν πάρεστί
σοι πάντοτε, καὶ κράτει
βραχίονός σου τίς
ἀντιστήσεται; 22 ὅτι ὡς
ροπὴ ἐκ πλαστίγγων ὅλος
ὁ κόσμος ἐναντίον σου καὶ
ὡς ρανὶς δρόσου ὀρθρινὴ
κατελθοῦσα ἐπὶ γῆν. 23
ἐλεεῖς δὲ πάντας, ὅτι
πάντα δύνασαι, καὶ
παρορᾷς ἁμαρτήματα
ἀνθρώπων εἰς μετάνοιαν.
24 ἀγαπᾷς γὰρ τὰ ὄντα
πάντα καὶ οὐδὲν
βδελύσσει, ὧν ἐποίησας·
οὐδὲ γὰρ ἂν μισῶν τι
κατεσκεύασας. 25 πῶς δὲ
ἔμεινεν ἂν τι, εἰ μὴ σὺ
ἠθέλησας ἢ τὸ μὴ κληθὲν
ὑπὸ σοῦ διετηρήθη; 26
φείδη δὲ πάντων, ὅτι σά
ἐστι, δέσποτα φιλόψυχε.

over, pursued by Justice, whirled
away by the breath of your
power. You, however, ordered
all things by measure, number
and weight.

²¹ For your great power is always
at your service, and who can
withstand the might of your
arm?

²² The whole world, for you, can
no more than tip a balance, like
a drop of morning dew falling on
the ground.

²³ Yet you are merciful to all,
because you are almighty, you
overlook people's sins, so that
they can repent.

²⁴ Yes, you love everything that
exists, and nothing that you
have made disgusts you, since, if
you had hated something, you
would not have made it.

²⁵ And how could a thing subsist,
had you not willed it? Or how be
preserved, if not called forth by
you?

²⁶ No, you spare all, since all is
yours, Lord, lover of life!

بإصابتها.
21 بَلْ قَدْ كَانَ نَفْسٌ كَافِيًا

لِإِسْقَاطِهِمْ؛ فَيَتَعَقِبُهُمُ الْقَضَاءُ وَرُوحٌ
قُدْرَتِكَ يَذَرِيهِمْ. لَكِنَّكَ رَتَبْتَ كُلَّ
شَيْءٍ بِمَقْدَارٍ وَعَدَدٍ وَوزنٍ.

22 وَعِنْدَكَ قُدْرَةٌ عَظِيمَةٌ فِي كُلِّ
حِينٍ؛ فَمَنْ يَقَاوِمُ قُوَّةَ ذِرَاعِكَ.

23 إِنَّ الْعَالَمَ كُلَّهُ أَمَامَكَ مِثْلُ مَا
تَرَجَحُ بِهِ كِفَّةَ الْمِيزَانِ، وَكَنْقِطَةٍ
نَدَى تَسْقُطُ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ عِنْدَ
السَّحَرِ.

24 لَكِنَّكَ تَرْحَمُ الْجَمِيعَ، لِأَنَّكَ
قَادِرٌ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، وَتَتَغَاضَى عَنْ
خَطَايَا النَّاسِ لِكَيْ يَتُوبُوا.

25 لِأَنَّكَ تُحِبُّ جَمِيعَ الْأَكْوَانِ،
وَلَا تَمَقُّتُ شَيْئًا مِمَّا صَنَعْتَ؛ فَإِنَّكَ
لَوْ أَبْغَضْتَ شَيْئًا لَمْ تَكُونَهُ.

26 وَكَيْفَ يَبْقَى شَيْءٌ لَمْ تُرِدْهُ؟ أَمْ
كَيْفَ يُحْفَظُ مَا لَسْتَ أَنْتَ دَاعِيًا
لَهُ؟

27 إِنَّكَ تُشْفِقُ عَلَى جَمِيعِ
الْأَكْوَانِ، لِأَنَّهَا لَكَ أَيُّهَا الرَّبُّ
الْمُحِبُّ لِلنَّفُوسِ.

الأصحاح الثاني عشر

ΤΟ γὰρ ἄφθαρτόν σου
 πνευμά ἐστιν ἐν πᾶσι. 2 διὸ
 τοὺς παραπίπτοντας κατ'
 ὀλίγον ἐλέγχεις καὶ ἐν οἷς
 ἁμαρτάνουσιν
 ὑπομιμνήσκων νουθετεῖς,
 ἵνα ἀπαλλαγέντες τῆς
 κακίας πιστεύσωσιν ἐπὶ σέ,
 Κύριε. 3 καὶ γὰρ τοὺς
 παλαιούς οἰκήτορας τῆς
 ἁγίας σου γῆς μισήσας 4
 ἐπὶ τῷ ἔχθιστα πράσσειν
 ἔργα φαρμακειῶν καὶ
 τελετὰς ἀνοσίους 5 τέκνων
 τε φονέας ἀνελεήμονας καὶ
 σπλαγχνοφάγων
 ἀνθρωπίνων σαρκῶν
 θοῖναν καὶ αἵματος, ἐκ
 μέσου μύστας θιάσου 6 καὶ
 αὐθέντας γονεῖς ψυχῶν
 ἀβοηθήτων, ἐβουλήθης
 ἀπολέσαι διὰ χειρῶν
 πατέρων ἡμῶν, 7 ἵνα ἄξιαν
 ἀποικίαν δέξηται Θεοῦ
 παίδων ἢ παρὰ σοὶ πασῶν
 τιμιωτάτη γῆ. 8 ἀλλὰ καὶ
 τούτων ὡς ἀνθρώπων
 ἐφείσω ἀπέστειλάς τε
 προδρομούς τοῦ
 στρατοπέδου σου σφῆκας,
 ἵνα αὐτοὺς κατὰ βραχὺ
 ἐξολοθρεύσωσιν. 9 οὐκ
 ἀδυνατῶν ἐν παρατάξει

¹ For your imperishable spirit is in everything!

² And thus, gradually, you correct those who offend; you admonish and remind them of how they have sinned, so that they may abstain from evil and trust in you, Lord.

³ The ancient inhabitants of your holy land

⁴ you hated for their loathsome practices, their acts of sorcery, and unholy rites.

⁵ Those ruthless murderers of children, those eaters of entrails at feasts of human flesh and of blood, those initiates of secret brotherhoods,

⁶ those murderous parents of defenceless beings, you determined to destroy at our ancestors' hands,

⁷ so that this land, dearer to you than any other, might receive a worthy colony of God's children.

⁸ Even so, since these were human, you treated them leniently, sending hornets as forerunners of your army, to exterminate them little by little.

⁹ Not that you were unable to hand the godless over to the upright in pitched battle or

1 إِنْ فِي كُلِّ شَيْءٍ رُوحَكَ الَّذِي لَا فَسَادَ فِيهِ.

2 فِيهِ تَوْبَخُ الْخَطَاةَ شَيْئًا فَشَيْئًا، وَفِيمَا يَخْطِئُونَ بِهِ تُذَكِّرُهُمْ وَتُنْذِرُهُمْ لِكَيْ يَقْلَعُوا عَنِ الشَّرِّ، وَيُؤْمِنُوا بِكَ، أَيُّهَا الرَّبُّ.

3 فَإِنَّكَ أَبْغَضْتَ الَّذِينَ كَانُوا قَدِيمًا سُكَّانَ أَرْضِكَ الْمُقَدَّسَةِ،

4 لِأَجْلِ أَعْمَالِهِمِ الْمَمْقُوتَةِ لَدَيْكَ مِنَ السَّحَرِ وَذَبَائِحِ الْفَجُورِ،

5 إِذْ كَانُوا يَقْتُلُونَ أَوْلَادَهُمْ بِغَيْرِ رَحْمَةٍ، وَيَأْكُلُونَ أَحْشَاءَ النَّاسِ، وَيَشْرَبُونَ دِمَاءَهُمْ فِي شَعَائِرِ عِبَادَتِكَ.

6 فَأَثَرْتَ أَنْ تُهْلِكَ بِأَيْدِي آبَائِنَا أَوْلَئِكَ الْوَالِدِينَ، قَتَلْتَ النَفُوسَ الَّتِي لَا نَصْرَةَ لَهَا،

7 لِكَيْ تَكُونَ الْأَرْضُ الَّتِي هِيَ أَكْرَمُ عِنْدَكَ مِنْ كُلِّ أَرْضٍ عَامِرَةٍ بِأَبْنَاءِ اللَّهِ، كَمَا يَلِيقُ بِهَا.

8 عَلَى أَنَّكَ أَشْفَقْتَ عَلَى أَوْلَئِكَ أَيْضًا، لِأَنَّهُمْ بَشَرٌ فَبَعَثْتَ بِالزَّنَابِيرِ

تَتَقَدَّمُ عَسْكَرَكَ، وَتَبِيدُهُمْ شَيْئًا بَعْدَ شَيْءٍ،

ἀσεβεῖς δικαίοις ὑποχειρίους δοῦναι ἢ θηρίοις δεινοῖς ἢ λόγῳ ἀποτόμῳ ὑφ' ἐν ἐκτρίψαι, 10 κρίνων δὲ κατὰ βραχὺ ἐδίδους τόπον μετανοίας, οὐκ ἀγνοῶν ὅτι πονηρὰ ἡ γένεσις αὐτῶν καὶ ἔμφυτος ἡ κακία αὐτῶν καὶ ὅτι οὐ μὴ ἀλλαγῇ ὁ λογισμὸς αὐτῶν εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα. 11 σπέρμα γὰρ ἦν κατηραμένον ἀπ' ἀρχῆς, οὐδὲ εὐλαβούμενός τινα ἐφ' οἷς ἡμάρτανον ἄδειαν ἐδίδους. 12 τίς γὰρ ἐρεῖ· τί ἐποίησας; ἢ τίς ἀντιστήσεται τῷ κρίματί σου; τίς δὲ ἐγκαλέσει σοι κατὰ ἐθνῶν ἀπολωλότων, ἃ σὺ ἐποίησας; ἢ τίς εἰς κατάστασίν σοι ἐλεύσεται ἔκδικος κατὰ ἀδίκων ἀνθρώπων; 13 οὐτε γὰρ Θεός ἐστι πλήν σου, ᾧ μέλει περὶ πάντων, ἵνα δείξης ὅτι οὐκ ἀδίκως ἔκρινας, 14 οὐτε βασιλεὺς ἢ τύραννος ἀντοφθαλμῆσαι δυνήσεται σοι περὶ ὧν ἐκόλασας. 15 δίκαιος δὲ ὧν δικαίως τὰ πάντα διέπεις, αὐτὸν τὸν μὴ ὀφείλοντα κολασθῆναι καταδικάσαι	destroy them at once by savage beasts or one harsh word; 10 but, by carrying out your sentences gradually, you gave them a chance to repent, although you knew that they were inherently evil, innately wicked, 11 and fixed in their cast of mind; for they were a race accursed from the beginning. Nor was it from awe of anyone that you let their sins go unpunished. 12 For who is there to ask, 'What have you done?' Or who is there to disagree with your sentence? Who to arraign you for destroying nations which you have created? Who to confront you by championing the wicked? 13 For there is no god, other than you, who cares for every one, to whom you have to prove that your sentences have been just. 14 No more could any king or despot challenge you over those whom you have punished. 15 For, being upright yourself, you rule the universe uprightly, and hold it as incompatible with your power to condemn anyone who has not deserved to be punished. 16 For your strength is the basis of your saving justice, and your	9 لَا لِأَنَّكَ عَجَزْتَ عَنْ إِخْضَاعِ الْمُنَافِقِينَ لِلصَّادِقِينَ بِالْقِتَالِ، أَوْ تَدْمِيرِهِمْ بِمَرَّةٍ بِالْوَحْشِ الضَّارِيَةِ، أَوْ بِأَمْرِ جَازِمٍ مِنْ عِنْدِكَ، 10 لَكِنْ بِعِقَابِهِمْ شَيْئًا فَشَيْئًا مَنْحَتَهُمْ مَهْلَةً لِلتَّوْبَةِ، وَإِنْ لَمْ يَخَفْ عَلَيْكَ أَنْ جِيلَهُمْ شَرِيرٌ، وَأَنْ خَبَثَهُمْ غَرِيزِيٌّ، وَأَفْكَارُهُمْ لَا تَتَغَيَّرُ إِلَى الْأَبَدِ، 11 لِأَنَّهُمْ كَانُوا ذُرِيَّةً مَلْعُونَةً مِنْذُ الْبَدَأِ. وَلَمْ يَكُنْ عَفْوُكَ عَنْ خَطَايَاهُمْ خَوْفًا مِنْ أَحَدٍ، 12 فَإِنَّهُ مَنْ يَقُولُ مَاذَا صَنَعْتَ أَوْ يَعْتَرِضُ قَضَاءَكَ؟ وَمَنْ يَشْكُوكَ بِهَلَاكِ الْأُمَمِ الَّتِي خَلَقْتَهَا، أَوْ يَقِفُ بَيْنَ يَدَيْكَ مُخَاصِمًا عَنْ أُنَاسٍ مُجْرِمِينَ؟ 13 إِذْ لَيْسَ إِلَهٌ إِلَّا أَنْتَ الْمَعْتَنِي بِالْجَمِيعِ، حَتَّى تَرَى أَنَّكَ لَا تَقْضِي قَضَاءَ الظُّلْمِ، 14 وَلَيْسَ لِمَلِكٍ أَوْ سُلْطَانٍ أَنْ يُطَالِبَكَ بِالَّذِينَ أَهْلَكْتَهُمْ. 15 وَإِذْ أَنْتَ عَادِلٌ تُدِيرُ الْجَمِيعَ بِالْعَدْلِ، وَتَحْسِبُ الْقَضَاءَ عَلَى مَنْ لَا يَسْتَوْجِبُ الْعِقَابَ مُنَافِيًا
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ἀλλότριον ἡγούμενος τῆς σῆς δυνάμεως. 16 ἡ γὰρ ἰσχὺς σου δικαιοσύνης ἀρχή, καὶ τὸ πάντων σε δεσπότην πάντων φείδεσθαι ποιεῖ. 17 ἰσχὺν γὰρ ἐνδείκνυσαι ἀπιστούμενος ἐπὶ δυνάμεως τελειότητι καὶ ἐν τοῖς εἰδόσι τὸ θράσος ἐξελέγχεις. 18 σὺ δὲ δεσπότης ἰσχύος ἐν ἐπιεικείᾳ κρίνεις καὶ μετὰ πολλῆς φειδοῦς διοικεῖς ἡμᾶς· πάρεστι γὰρ σοι, ὅταν θέλῃς, τὸ δύνασθαι. 19 Ἐδίδαξας δέ σου τὸν λαὸν διὰ τῶν τοιούτων ἔργων, ὅτι δεῖ τὸν δίκαιον εἶναι φιλόανθρωπον· καὶ εὐέλπιδας ἐποίησας τοὺς υἱούς σου ὅτι δίδως ἐπὶ ἀμαρτήμασι μετάνοιαν. 20 εἰ γὰρ ἐχθροὺς παίδων σου καὶ ὀφειλομένους θανάτῳ μετὰ τοσαύτης ἐτιμώρησας προσοχῆς καὶ διέσεως, δὸς χρόνους καὶ τόπον, δι' ὧν ἀπαλλαγῶσι τῆς κακίας, 21 μετὰ πόσης ἀκριβείας ἔκρινας τοὺς υἱούς σου, ὧν τοῖς πατράσιν ὅρκους καὶ συνθήκας ἔδωκας ἀγαθῶν ὑποσχέσεων; 22 Ἡμᾶς οὖν	sovereignty over all makes you lenient to all. 17 You show your strength when people will not believe in your absolute power, and you confound any insolence in those who do know it. 18 But you, controlling your strength, are mild in judgement, and govern us with great lenience, for you have only to will, and your power is there. 19 By acting thus, you have taught your people that the upright must be kindly to his fellows, and you have given your children the good hope that after sins you will grant repentance. 20 For, if with such care and indulgence you have punished your children's enemies, though doomed to death, and have given them time and place to be rid of their wickedness, 21 with what exact attention have you not judged your children, to whose ancestors, by oaths and covenants, you made such generous promises? 22 Thus, you instruct us, when you punish our enemies in moderation, that we should reflect on your kindness when we judge, and, when we are	لَقَدْ رَتَكُ. 16 لِأَنَّ قُوَّتَكَ هِيَ مَبْدَأُ عَدْلِكَ، وَبِمَا أَنَّكَ رَبُّ الْجَمِيعِ؛ فَأَنْتَ تُشْفِقُ عَلَى الْجَمِيعِ. 17 وَإِنَّمَا تَبْدِي قُوَّتَكَ لِلَّذِينَ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ أَنَّكَ عَلَى كَمَالِ الْقُدْرَةِ، وَتُعَاقِبُ الْعُلَمَاءَ عَلَى جَسَارَتِهِمْ 18 لَكِنَّكَ، أَيُّهَا السُّلْطَانُ الْقَدِيرُ، تَحْكُمُ بِالرَّفْقِ، وَتَدْبِرُنَا بِإِشْفَاقٍ كَثِيرٍ، لِأَنَّ فِي يَدِكَ أَنْ تَعْمَلَ بِقُدْرَةٍ مَتَى شِئْتَ. 19 فَعَلَّمْتَ شَعْبَكَ بِأَعْمَالِكَ هَذِهِ، أَنَّ الصَّدِيقَ يَنْبَغِي أَنْ يَكُونَ مُحِبًّا لِلنَّاسِ، وَجَعَلْتَ لِبَنِيكَ رَجَاءً حَسَنًا، لِأَنَّكَ تَمْنَحُهُمْ فِي خَطَايَاهُمْ مَهْلَةً لِلتَّوْبَةِ. 20 لِأَنَّكَ إِنْ كُنْتَ عَاقَبْتَ أَعْدَاءَ بَنِيكَ الْمُسْتَوْجِبِينَ لِلْمَوْتِ بِمِثْلِ هَذَا التَّحَرُّزِ وَالتَّرَفُّقِ، وَجَعَلْتَ لَهُمْ زَمَانًا وَمَكَانًا لِلْإِقْلَاعِ عَنِ الشَّرِّ، 21 فَبِأَيِّ اعْتِنَاءٍ دَبَّرْتَ بَنِيكَ الَّذِينَ وَاثَقْتَ آبَاءَهُمْ بِالْأَقْسَامِ وَالْعَهْدِ عَلَى مَوَاعِيدِكَ الصَّالِحَةِ؟ 22 فَتُؤَدِّبُنَا نَحْنُ، وَتَجْلِدُ أَعْدَاءَنَا جَلْدًا كَثِيرًا، لِكَيْ نَتَذَكَّرَ حِلْمَكَ
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παιδεύων τοὺς ἐχθροὺς ἡμῶν ἐν μυριότητι μαστιγοῖς, ἵνα σου τὴν ἀγαθότητα μεριμνῶμεν κρίνοντες, κρινόμενοι δὲ προσδοκῶμεν ἔλεος. 23 ὅθεν καὶ τοὺς ἐν ἀφροσύνη ζωῆς βιώσαντας ἀδίκους διὰ τῶν ιδίων ἐβασάνισας βδελυγμάτων· 24 καὶ γὰρ τῶν πλάνης ὁδῶν μακρότερον ἐπλανήθησαν, θεοὺς ὑπολαμβάνοντες τὰ καὶ ἐν ζώοις τῶν ἐχθρῶν ἄτιμα, νηπίων δίκην ἀφρόνων ψευσθέντες. 25 διὰ τοῦτο ὡς παισὶν ἀλογίστοις τὴν κρίσιν εἰς ἐμπαιγμὸν ἔπεμψας. 26 οἱ δὲ παιγνίοις ἐπιτιμήσεως μὴ νουθετηθέντες ἀξίαν Θεοῦ κρίσιν πειράσουσιν. 27 ἐφ' οἷς γὰρ αὐτοὶ πάσχοντες ἡγανάκτουν, ἐπὶ τούτοις, οὕς ἐδόκουν θεοὺς, ἐν αὐτοῖς κολαζόμενοι, ἰδόντες ὃν πάλαι ἠρνοῦντο εἰδέναι Θεὸν ἐπέγνωσαν ἀληθῆ· διὸ καὶ τὸ τέρμα τῆς καταδίκης ἐπ' αὐτοὺς ἐπῆλθεν.	judged, we should look for mercy. ²³ And this is why people leading foolish and wicked lives were tortured by you with their own abominations; ²⁴ for they had strayed too far on the paths of error by taking the vilest and most despicable of animals for gods, being deluded like silly little children. ²⁵ So, as to children with no sense, you gave them a sentence making fools of them. ²⁶ Those, however, who would not take warning from a mocking reproof were soon to endure a sentence worthy of God. ²⁷ The creatures that made them suffer and against which they protested, those very creatures that they had taken for gods and by which they were punished they saw in their true light; and he whom hitherto they had refused to know, they realised was true God. And this is why the final condemnation fell on them.	إِذَا حَكَمْنَا، وَنَنْتَظِرُ رَحْمَتِكَ إِذَا حُكِمَ عَلَيْنَا. 23 لِأَجْلِ ذَلِكَ فَالْمُنَافِقُونَ الَّذِينَ عَاشُوا بِالسَّفَهَةِ، عَذَّبْتَهُمْ بِأَرْجَاسِهِمْ عَيْنَهَا، 24 فَإِنَّهُمْ فِي ضَلَالِهِمْ تَجَاوَزُوا طُرُقَ الضَّلَالِ، إِذِ اتَّخَذُوا مَا يَسْتَحْقِرُهُ أَعْدَاؤُهُمْ مِنَ الْحَيَوَانَ آلِهَةً، مُغْتَرِينَ كَأَطْفَالٍ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ. 25 لِذَلِكَ بَعَثْتُ عَلَيْهِمْ عِقَابَ أَوْلَادٍ لَا عَقْلَ لَهُمْ لِلْسَخَرِيَّةِ. 26 وَلَمَّا لَمْ يَتَّعْظُوا بِتَأْدِيبِ السَّخَرِيَّةِ، ذَاقُوا الْعِقَابَ اللَّائِقَ بِاللَّهِ. 27 وَفِيمَا تَحَمَّلُوهُ بَغِيزَتِهِمْ، وَقَدْ رَأَوْا أَنَّ مَا اتَّخَذُوهُ إِلَهًا كَانُوا بِهِ يَعَذَّبُونَ، عَرَفُوا إِلَهَ الْحَقِّ الَّذِي كَانُوا يَكْفُرُونَ بِهِ، وَلِذَلِكَ حَلَّتْ بِهِمْ خَاتِمَةُ الْعِقَابِ.
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الأصاح الثالث عشر

ΜΑΤΑΙΟΙ μὲν γὰρ πάντες ἄνθρωποι φύσει, οἷς παρῆν Θεοῦ ἀγνοσία καὶ ἐκ τῶν ὀρωμένων ἀγαθῶν οὐκ ἴσχυσαν εἰδέναι τὸν ὄντα οὔτε τοῖς ἔργοις προσχόντες ἐπέγνωσαν τὸν τεχνίτην· 2 ἄλλ' ἢ πῦρ ἢ πνεῦμα ἢ ταχινὸν ἀέρα ἢ κύκλον ἀστρων ἢ βίαιον ὕδωρ ἢ φωστῆρας οὐρανοῦ πρυτάνεις κόσμου θεοὺς ἐνόμισαν. 3 ὦν εἰ μὲν τῇ καλλονῇ τερπόμενοι ταῦτα θεοὺς ὑπελάμβανον, γνῶντες πόσω τούτων ὁ δεσπότης ἐστὶ βελτίων, ὁ γὰρ τοῦ κάλλους γενεσιάρχης ἔκτισεν αὐτά· 4 εἰ δὲ δύναμιν καὶ ἐνέργειαν ἐκπλαγέντες νοησάτωσαν ἀπ' αὐτῶν πόσω ὁ κατασκευάσας αὐτὰ δυνατώτερός ἐστιν· 5 ἐκ γὰρ μεγέθους καλλονῆς κτισμάτων ἀναλόγως ὁ γενεσιουργὸς αὐτῶν θεωρεῖται. 6 ἄλλ' ὅμως ἐπὶ τούτοις ἐστὶ μέμψις ὀλίγη, καὶ γὰρ αὐτοὶ τάχα πλανῶνται Θεὸν ζητοῦντες καὶ θέλοντες εὐρεῖν· 7 ἐν γὰρ τοῖς ἔργοις αὐτοῦ ἀναστρεφόμενοι διερευνῶσι καὶ πείθονται τῇ	¹ Yes, naturally stupid are all who are unaware of God, and who, from good things seen, have not been able to discover Him-who-is, or, by studying the works, have not recognised the Artificer. ² Fire, however, or wind, or the swift air, the sphere of the stars, impetuous water, heaven's lamps, are what they have held to be the gods who govern the world. ³ If, charmed by their beauty, they have taken these for gods, let them know how much the Master of these excels them, since he was the very source of beauty that created them. ⁴ And if they have been impressed by their power and energy, let them deduce from these how much mightier is he that has formed them, ⁵ since through the grandeur and beauty of the creatures we may, by analogy, contemplate their Author. ⁶ Small blame, however, attaches to them, for perhaps they go astray only in their search for God and their eagerness to find him;	1 إِنْ جَمِيعَ الَّذِينَ لَمْ يَعْرِفُوا اللَّهَ هُمْ حَمَقَى مِنْ طَبْعِهِمْ، لَمْ يَقْدِرُوا أَنْ يَعْلَمُوا الْكَائِنَ مِنَ الْخَيْرَاتِ الْمَنْظُورَةِ، وَلَمْ يَتَأَمَّلُوا الْمَصْنُوعَاتِ حَتَّى يَعْرِفُوا صَانِعَهَا. 2 لَكِنَّهُمْ حَسِبُوا النَّارَ أَوْ الرِّيحَ أَوْ الْهَوَاءَ اللَّطِيفَ أَوْ مَدَارَ النُّجُومِ أَوْ لُحَّةَ الْمِيَاهِ أَوْ نِيرَى السَّمَاءِ آلِهَةً تَسْوَدُّ الْعَالَمَ. 3 فَإِنْ كَانُوا إِنَّمَا اعْتَقَدُوا هَذِهِ آلِهَةً، لِأَنَّهُمْ خَلَبُوا بِجَمَالِهَا؛ فَلْيَتَعَرَّفُوا كَمْ رَبُّهَا أَحْسَنُ مِنْهَا، إِذِ الَّذِي خَلَقَهَا هُوَ مُبْدَأُ كُلِّ جَمَالٍ. 4 أَوْ لِأَنَّهُمْ دَهَشُوا مِنْ قُوَّتِهَا وَفَعْلِهَا؛ فَلْيَتَفَهَّمُوا بِهَا كَمْ مَنْشَأُهَا أَقْوَى مِنْهَا. 5 فَإِنَّهُ بَعْضُ جَمَالِ الْمَبْرُوءَاتِ يَبْصُرُ فَاطَرَهَا عَلَى طَرِيقِ الْمُقَايَسَةِ. 6 غَيْرَ أَنَّ لَهُؤُلَاءِ وَجْهًا مِنَ الْعُذْرِ، لَعَلَّهُمْ ضَلُّوا فِي طَلَبِهِمْ لِلَّهِ وَرَغِبَتِهِمْ فِي وَجْدَانِهِ،
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ὄψει, ὅτι καλὰ τὰ βλεπόμενα. 8 πάλιν δὲ οὐδ' αὐτοὶ συγγνωστοί· 9 εἰ γὰρ τοσοῦτον ἴσχυσαν εἰδέναι, ἵνα δύνωνται στοχάσασθαι τὸν αἰῶνα, τὸν τούτων δεσπότην πῶς τάχιον οὐχ εὖρον; 10 Ταλαίπωροι δὲ καὶ ἐν νεκροῖς αἱ ἐλπίδες αὐτῶν, οἵτινες ἐκάλεσαν θεοὺς ἔργα χειρῶν ἀνθρώπων, χρυσὸν καὶ ἄργυρον τέχνης ἐμμελέτημα καὶ ἀπεικάσματα ζώων ἢ λίθον ἄχρηστον χειρὸς ἔργον ἀρχαίας. 11 εἰ δὲ καὶ τις ὑλοτόμος τέκνων εὐκίνητον φυτὸν ἐκπρίσας περιέξυσεν εὐμαθῶς πάντα τὸν φλοιὸν αὐτοῦ καὶ τεχνησάμενος εὐπρεπῶς κατεσκεύασε χρήσιμον σκεῦος εἰς ὑπηρεσίαν ζωῆς, 12 τὰ δὲ ἀποβλήματα τῆς ἐργασίας εἰς ἐτοιμασίαν τροφῆς ἀναλώσας ἐνεπλήσθη· 13 τὸ δὲ ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπόβλημα εἰς οὐθὲν εὐχρηστον, ξύλον σκολιὸν καὶ ὄζοις συμπεφλεκός, λαβῶν ἔγλυψεν ἐν ἐπιμελείᾳ ἀργίας αὐτοῦ καὶ ἐμπειρία συνέσεως ἐτύπωσεν αὐτό, ἀπείκασεν αὐτὸ εἰκόνι ἀνθρώπου 14 ἢ	7 familiar with his works, they investigate them and fall victim to appearances, seeing so much beauty. 8 But even so, they have no excuse: 9 if they are capable of acquiring enough knowledge to be able to investigate the world, how have they been so slow to find its Master? 10 But wretched are they, with their hopes set on dead things, who have given the title of gods to human artefacts, gold or silver, skilfully worked, figures of animals, or useless stone, carved by some hand long ago. 11 Take a woodcutter. He fells a suitable tree, neatly strips off the bark all over and then with admirable skill works the wood into an object useful in daily life. 12 The bits left over from his work he uses for cooking his food, then eats his fill. 13 There is still a good-for-nothing bit left over, a gnarled and knotted billet: he takes it and whittles it with the concentration of his leisure hours, he shapes it with the	7 إِذْ هُمْ يَبْحَثُونَ عَنْهُ مُتَرَدِّدِينَ بَيْنَ مَصْنُوعَاتِهِ؛ فَيَغْرَهُمْ مَنْظَرُهَا، لَأَنَّ الْمَنْظُورَاتِ ذَاتُ جَمَالٍ. 8 مَعَ ذَلِكَ لَيْسَ لَهُمْ مِنْ مَغْفِرَةٍ، 9 لِأَنَّهُمْ إِنْ كَانُوا قَدْ بَلَّغُوا مِنَ الْعِلْمِ أَنْ اسْتَطَاعُوا إِدْرَاكَ كُنْهِ الدَّهْرِ؛ فَكَيْفَ لَمْ يَكُونُوا أَسْرَعَ إِدْرَاكَاً لِرَبِّ الدَّهْرِ؟ 10 أَمَّا الَّذِينَ سَمَوْا أَعْمَالَ أَيْدِي النَّاسِ آلِهَةً، الذَّهَبَ وَالْفِضَّةَ وَمَا اخْتَرَعَتْهُ الصَّنَاعَةُ، وَتَمَاثِيلَ الْحَيَوَانِ وَالْحَجَرَ الْحَقِيرَ مِمَّا صَنَعْتَهُ يَدٌ قَدِيمَةٌ؛ فَهُمْ أَشْقِيَاءُ وَرَجَاؤُهُمْ فِي الْأَمْوَاتِ. 11 يَقْطَعُ نَجَّارٌ شَجَرَةً مِنَ الْغَابَةِ طَوَّعَ الْعَمَلِ، وَيَجْرُدُهَا بِحَذَقِهِ مِنْ قَشْرِهَا كُلِّهِ، ثُمَّ بِحُسْنِ صِنَاعَتِهِ يَصْنَعُهَا آلَةً تَصْلُحُ لِحَدِمْةِ الْعَيْشِ، 12 وَيَسْتَعْمِلُ نَفَائِثَهَا وَقُوداً لِإِعْدَادِ طَعَامِهِ. 13 ثُمَّ يَأْخُذُ قِطْعَةً مِنْ نَفَائِثِهَا لَا تَصْلُحُ لَشَيْءٍ، خَشَبَةً ذَاتَ اعْوَجَاجٍ وَعَقْدٍ، وَيَعْتَنِي بِنَقْشِهَا فِي أَوَانٍ فَرَاغِهِ، وَيَصُورُهَا بِخَبْرَةٍ
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ζῶν τινὶ εὐτελεῖ ὡμοίωσεν
αὐτό, καταχρίσας μίλτῳ καὶ
φύκει ἐρυθίνας χροάν αὐτοῦ,
καὶ πᾶσαν κηλίδα τὴν ἐν
αὐτῷ καταχρίσας 15 καὶ
ποιήσας αὐτῷ αὐτοῦ ἄξιον
οἶκημα, ἐν τοίχῳ ἔθηκεν αὐτὸ
ἀσφαλισάμενος σιδήρῳ. 16
ἵνα μὲν οὖν μὴ καταπέσῃ,
προενόησεν αὐτοῦ εἰδῶς ὅτι
ἀδυνατεῖ ἑαυτῷ βοηθῆσαι
καὶ γὰρ ἐστὶν εἰκὼν καὶ
χρεῖαν ἔχει βοηθείας. 17 περὶ
δὲ κτημάτων καὶ γάμων
αὐτοῦ καὶ τέκνων
προσευχόμενος, οὐκ
αἰσχύνεται τῷ ἀψύχῳ
προσλαλῶν καὶ περὶ μὲν
υἱείας τὸ ἀσθενές
ἐπικαλεῖται, 18 περὶ δὲ ζωῆς
τὸν νεκρὸν ἄξιοι, περὶ δὲ
ἐπικουρίας τὸ ἀπειρότατον
ἰκετεύει, περὶ δὲ ὁδοιπορίας
τὸ μηδὲ βάσει χρῆσθαι
δυνάμενον, 19 περὶ δὲ
πορισμοῦ καὶ ἐργασίας καὶ
χειρῶν ἐπιτυχίας τὸ
ἀδρανέστατον ταῖς χερσὶν
εὐδράνειαν αἰτεῖται.

skill of experience, he gives it a
human shape

14 or perhaps he makes it into
some vile animal, smears it
with ochre, paints its surface
red, coats over all its
blemishes.

15 He next makes a worthy
home for it, lets it into the
wall, fixes it with an iron
clamp.

16 Thus he makes sure that
it will not fall down -- being
well aware that it cannot help
itself, since it is only an image,
and needs to be helped.

17 And yet, if he wishes to pray
for his goods, for his marriage,
for his children, he does not
blush to harangue this lifeless
thing -- for health, he invokes
what is weak,

18 for life, he pleads with what
is dead, for help, he goes
begging to total inexperience,
for a journey, what cannot
even use its feet,

19 for profit, an undertaking,
and success in pursuing his
craft, he asks skill from
something whose hands have
no skill whatever.

صَنَاعَتَهُ عَلَى شَكْلِ إِنْسَانٍ،
14 أَوْ يَمَثُلُ بِهَا حَيَوَانًا
خَسِيسًا، وَيَدْنِهَا بِالْإِسْفِيدَاجِ،
وَيَحْمَرُّ لَوْنَهَا بِالزَّنَجْفَرِ، وَيَطْلِي
كُلَّ لَطَخَةٍ بِهَا.

15 وَيَجْعَلُ لَهَا مَقَامًا يَلِيقُ بِهَا،
وَيَضَعُهَا فِي الْحَائِطِ وَيُوْتِقُهَا
بِالْحَدِيدِ،

16 وَيَتَحَفَّظُ عَلَيْهَا أَنْ لَا
تَسْقُطَ، لَعَلَّمَهُ بِأَنَّهَا لَا تَقُومُ
بِمَعُونَةِ نَفْسِهَا، إِذْ هِيَ تِمَثَالٌ
يَفْتَقِرُ إِلَى مَنْ يَعِينُهُ.

17 ثُمَّ يَتَضَرَّعُ إِلَيْهَا عَنْ أُمُورِهِ
وَأَزْوَاجِهِ وَبَنِيهِ، وَلَا يَخْجَلُ أَنْ
يُخَاطَبَ مِنْ لَا رُوحَ لَهُ.

18 فَيَطْلُبُ الْعَافِيَةَ مِنَ السَّقِيمِ،
وَيَسْأَلُ الْمَيِّتَ الْحَيَاةَ، وَيَسْتَغِيثُ

بِمَنْ هُوَ أَعْجَزُ شَيْءٍ عَنِ الْإِعَاثَةِ،
19 وَيَتَوَسَّلُ مِنْ أَجْلِ السَّفَرِ إِلَى

مَنْ لَا يَسْتَطِيعُ الْمَشْيَ، وَيَلْتَمِسُ
النُّصْرَةَ فِي الْكَسْبِ وَالتَّجَارَةِ
وَنَجْحِ الْمَسَاعِي مِمَّنْ هُوَ أَقْصَرُ
مَوْجُودٍ بَاعًا.

الأصاح الرابع عشر

Πλοῦν τις πάλιν στελλόμενος καὶ ἄγρια μέλλων διοδεύειν κύματα, τοῦ φέροντος αὐτὸν πλοίου σαθρότερον ξύλον ἐπιβοᾷται. 2 ἐκεῖνο μὲν γὰρ ὄρεξις πορισμῶν ἐπενόησε, τεχνίτις δὲ σοφία κατεσκεύασεν· 3 ἡ δὲ σὴ, πάτερ, διακυβερνᾷ πρόνοια, ὅτι ἔδωκας καὶ ἐν θαλάσση ὁδὸν καὶ ἐν κύμασι τρίβον ἀσφαλῆ, 4 δεικνὺς ὅτι δύνασαι ἐκ παντὸς σώζειν, ἵνα καὶ ἄνευ τέχνης τις ἐπιβῇ. 5 θέλεις δὲ μή ἀργὰ εἶναι τὰ τῆς σοφίας σου ἔργα, διὰ τοῦτο καὶ ἐλαχίστῳ ξύλῳ πιστεύουσιν ἄνθρωποι ψυχὰς καὶ διελθόντες κλύδωνα σχεδία διεσώθησαν. 6 καὶ ἀρχῆς γὰρ ἀπολλυμένων ὑπερηφάνων γιγάντων, ἡ ἐλπίς τοῦ κόσμου ἐπὶ σχεδίας καταφυγοῦσα ἀπέλιπεν αἰῶνι σπέρμα γενέσεως τῇ σῇ κυβερνηθεῖσα χειρί. 7 εὐλόγηται γὰρ ξύλον, δι' οὗ γίνεται δικαιοσύνη· 8 τὸ χειροποίητον δέ,	¹ Or someone else, taking ship to cross the wild waves, loudly invokes a piece of wood frailer than the vessel that bears him. ² Agreed, the ship is the product of a craving for gain, its building embodies the wisdom of the shipwright; ³ but your providence, Father, is what steers it, you having opened a pathway even through the sea, and a safe way over the waves, ⁴ showing that you can save, whatever happens, so that, even without experience, someone may put to sea. ⁵ It is not your will that the works of your Wisdom should be sterile, so people entrust their lives to the smallest piece of wood, cross the waves on a raft, yet are kept safe and sound. ⁶ Why, in the beginning, when the proud giants were perishing, the hope of the world took refuge on a raft and, steered by your hand, preserved the seed of a new generation for the ages to come. ⁷ For blessed is the wood which serves the cause of uprightness	1 وَآخِرُ، قَبْلَ أَنْ يَرْكَبَ الْبَحْرَ، وَيَسِيرَ عَلَى الْأَمْوَاجِ الْمَعْرَبَةِ، يَسْتَعِثُّ بِخَشَبٍ هُوَ أَقْصَفُ مِنَ الْمَرْكَبِ الَّذِي يَحْمِلُهُ. 2 لِأَنَّ الْمَرْكَبَ اخْتَرَعَهُ حُبُّ الْكَسْبِ، وَصَنَعَتْهُ الْحِكْمَةُ الْمُهَنْدِسَةُ، 3 لَكِنَّ عَنَانَيْتِكَ أَيُّهَا الْأَبُ هِيَ الَّتِي تُدْبِرُهُ، لِأَنَّكَ أَنْتَ الَّذِي فَتَحْتَ فِي الْبَحْرِ طَرِيقًا، وَفِي الْأَمْوَاجِ مَسْلَكًا آمِنًا، 4 وَبَيَّنْتَ أَنَّكَ قَادِرٌ أَنْ تَخْلُصَ مِنْ كُلِّ خَطَرٍ، وَلَوْ رَكِبَ الْبَحْرَ مَنْ يَجْهَلُ صِنَاعَتَهُ. 5 وَأَنْتَ تَحِبُّ أَنْ لَا تَكُونَ أَعْمَالُ حُكْمَتِكَ بَاطِلَةً؛ فَلِذَلِكَ يُودِعُ النَّاسُ أَنْفُسَهُمْ خَشَبًا صَغِيرًا؛ وَيَقْطَعُونَ اللُّجَّةَ فِي سَفِينَةٍ وَيَخْلُصُونَ. 6 وَفِي الْبَدْءِ أَيْضًا حِينَ هَلَكَ الْجَبَابِرَةُ الْمُتَكَبِّرُونَ، التَّجَا رَجَاءُ الْعَالَمِ إِلَى سَفِينَةٍ، وَأَرْشَدَتْهُ يَدُكَ فَأَبْقَى لِلدَّهْرِ ذُرِّيَّةً تَتَوَالَدُ. 7 فَالْخَشَبُ الَّذِي بِهِ يَحْصُلُ الْبِرُّ هُوَ مُبَارَكٌ،
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ἐπικατάρατον αὐτὸν καὶ ὁ ποιήσας αὐτό, ὅτι ὁ μὲν εἰργάζετο, τὸ δὲ φθαρτὸν θεὸς ὠνομάσθη. 9 ἐν ἴσῳ γὰρ μισητὰ Θεῷ καὶ ὁ ἀσεβῶν καὶ ἡ ἀσέβεια αὐτοῦ. 10 καὶ γὰρ τὸ πραχθὲν σὺν τῷ δράσαντι κολασθήσεται. 11 διὰ τοῦτο καὶ ἐν εἰδώλοις ἐθνῶν ἐπισκοπὴ ἔσται, ὅτι ἐν κτίσματι Θεοῦ εἰς βδέλυγμα ἐγενήθησαν καὶ εἰς σκάνδαλα ψυχῶν ἀνθρώπων καὶ εἰς παγίδα ποσὶν ἀφρόνων. 12 Ἀρχὴ γὰρ πορνείας ἐπίνοια εἰδώλων, εὐρεσις δὲ αὐτῶν φθορὰ ζωῆς. 13 οὔτε γὰρ ἦν ἀπ' ἀρχῆς, οὔτε εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα ἔσται. 14 κενοδοξία γὰρ ἀνθρώπων εἰσηλθεν εἰς κόσμον, καὶ διὰ τοῦτο σύντομον αὐτῶν τέλος ἐπενοήθη. 15 ἄωρῳ γὰρ πένθει τρυχόμενος πατήρ, τοῦ ταχέως ἀφαιρεθέντος τέκνου εἰκόνα ποιήσας, τὸν τότε νεκρὸν ἄνθρωπον νῦν ὡς Θεὸν ἐτίμησε καὶ παρέδωκε τοῖς ὑποχειρίοις μυστήρια καὶ τελετάς. 16 εἴτα ἐν χρόνῳ κρατυνθὲν τὸ ἀσεβὲς ἔθος	⁸ but accursed the man-made idol, yes, it and its maker, he for having made it, and it because, though perishable, it has been called god. ⁹ For God holds the godless and his godlessness in equal hatred; ¹⁰ both work and workman will alike be punished. ¹¹ Hence even the idols of the nations will have a visitation since, in God's creation, they have become an abomination, a scandal for human souls, a snare for the feet of the foolish. ¹² The idea of making idols was the origin of fornication, their discovery corrupted life. ¹³ They did not exist at the beginning, they will not exist for ever; ¹⁴ human vanity brought them into the world, and a quick end is therefore reserved for them. ¹⁵ A father afflicted by untimely mourning has an image made of his child so soon carried off, and now pays divine honours to what yesterday was only a corpse, handing on mysteries and ceremonies to his people; ¹⁶ time passes, the custom hardens and is observed as law. ¹⁷ Rulers were the ones who	8 أَمَّا الْخَشَبُ الْمَصْنُوعُ صَنِمًا فَمَلْعُونَ هُوَ وَصَانِعُهُ. أَمَّا هَذَا فَلَأَنَّهُ عَمِلَهُ، وَأَمَّا ذَاكَ فَلَأَنَّهُ مَعَ كَوْنِهِ فَاسِدًا سُمِّيَ إِلَهًا. 9 فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ يَبْغِضُ الْمُنَافِقَ وَنِفَاقَهُ عَلَى السَّوَاءِ، 10 فَيُصِيبُ الْعِقَابَ الْمَصْنُوعَ وَالصَّانِعَ. 11 لِذَلِكَ سَتَفْتَقِدُ أَصْنَامُ الْأُمَمِ أَيْضًا، لِأَنَّهَا صَارَتْ فِي خَلْقِ اللَّهِ رَجَسًا، وَمَعْتَرَةً لِنُفُوسِ النَّاسِ، وَفَخًا لِأَقْدَامِ الْجُهَالِ، 12 لِأَنَّ اخْتِرَاعَ الْأَصْنَامِ هُوَ أَصْلُ الْفُسْقِ، وَوَجَدَانَهَا فَسَادُ الْحَيَاةِ. 13 وَهِيَ لَمْ تَكُنْ فِي الْبَدْءِ، وَلَيْسَتْ تَدُومُ إِلَى الْأَبَدِ، 14 لِأَنَّهَا إِنَّمَا دَخَلَتْ الْعَالَمَ بِحُبِّ النَّاسِ لِلْمَجْدِ الْفَارِغِ، وَلِذَلِكَ قَدْ عَزِمَ عَلَى الْإِغَائِثِ عَنْ قَرِيبٍ. 15 وَذَلِكَ أَنَّ وَالِدًا قَدْ فُجِعَ بِتُكُلِّ مُعْجَلٍ؛ فَصَنَعَ تَمَثُّلًا لِابْنِهِ الَّذِي خُطِفَ سَرِيعًا، وَجَعَلَ يَعْبُدُ ذَلِكَ الْإِنْسَانَ الْمَيِّتَ بِمَنْزِلَةِ إِلَهٍ، وَرَسَمَ لِلَّذِينَ تَحْتَ يَدِهِ شَعَائِرَ وَذَبَائِحَ. 16 ثُمَّ عَلَى مَمَرِ الزَّمَانِ تَأَصَّلَتْ
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ὥς νόμος ἐφυλάχθη, καὶ
 τυράννων ἐπιταγαῖς
 ἐθρησκευέτο τὰ γλυπτὰ,
 17 οὓς ἐν ὄψει μὴ
 δυνάμενοι τιμᾶν
 ἄνθρωποι διὰ τὸ μακρὰν
 οἰκεῖν, τὴν πόρρωθεν ὄψιν
 ἀνατυπωσάμενοι, ἐμφανῇ
 εἰκόνα τοῦ τιμωμένου
 βασιλέως ἐποίησαν, ἵνα
 τὸν ἀπόντα ὡς παρόντα
 κολακεύωσι διὰ τῆς
 σπουδῆς. 18 εἰς ἐπίτασιν
 δὲ θρησκείας καὶ τοὺς
 ἀγνοοῦντας ἢ τοῦ
 τεχνίτου προετρέψατο
 φιλοτιμία· 19 ὁ μὲν γὰρ
 τάχα τῷ κρατοῦντι
 βουλόμενος ἀρέσαι,
 ἐξεβιάσατο τῇ τέχνῃ τὴν
 ὁμοιότητα ἐπὶ τὸ κάλλιον·
 20 τὸ δὲ πλῆθος
 ἐφελκόμενον διὰ τὸ
 εὐχαρι τῆς ἐργασίας, τὸν
 πρὸ ὀλίγου τιμηθέντα
 ἄνθρωπον νῦν σέβασμα
 ἐλογίσαντο. 21 καὶ τοῦτο
 ἐγένετο τῷ βίῳ εἰς
 ἔνεδρον, ὅτι ἡ συμφορὰ ἡ
 τυραννίδι δουλεύσαντες
 ἄνθρωποι τὸ ἀκοινώνητον
 ὄνομα λίθοις καὶ ξύλοις
 περιέθεσαν. 22 Εἶπ' οὐκ
 ἤρκεσε τὸ πλανᾶσθαι περὶ

ordered that statues should be
 worshipped: people who could
 not honour them in person,
 because they lived too far away,
 would have a portrait made of
 their distant countenance, to
 have an image that they could
 see of the king whom they
 honoured; meaning, by such
 zeal, to flatter the absent as if
 he were present.

¹⁸ Even people who did not
 know him were stimulated into
 spreading his cult by the artist's
 enthusiasm;

¹⁹ for the latter, doubtless
 wishing to please his ruler,
 exerted all his skill to surpass
 the reality,

²⁰ and the crowd, attracted by
 the beauty of the work, mistook
 for a god someone whom
 recently they had honoured as a
 man.

²¹ And this became a snare for
 life: that people, whether
 enslaved by misfortune or by
 tyranny, should have conferred
 the ineffable Name on sticks and
 stones.

²² It is not enough, however, for
 them to have such
 misconceptions about God; for,
 living in the fierce warfare of
 ignorance, they call these

تلك العادة الكفرية؛ فحفظت
 كشرعية، وبأوامر الملوك عبدت
 المنحوتات.

17 والذين لم يستطع الناس
 إكرامهم بمحضرهم لبعدهم مقامهم،
 صوروا هيئاتهم الغائبة، وجعلوا
 صورة الملك المكرم نصب العيون،
 حرصاً على تملكه في الغيبة كأنه
 حاضر.

18 ثم إن حب الصانع للمباهاة،
 كان داعيةً للجاهلين إلى المبالغة
 في هذه العبادة،

19 فإنهم رغبة في إرضاء الأمر،
 قد أفرغوا وسعهم في الصناعة،

لإخراج الصورة على غاية الكمال،
 20 فاستميل الجمهور ببهجة ذلك
 المصنوع، حتى إن الذي كانوا قبل
 قليل يكرمونه كأنسان عدوه إلهًا.

21 وبهذا كان اقتناص الخلق؛ فإن
 رزينة بعض الناس أو اقتسار الملوك
 استعبدتهم، حتى جعلوا على الحجر
 والخشب الاسم الذي لا يشرك فيه
 أحد.

22 ثم لم يكتفوا بضلالهم في
 معرفة الله، لكنهم غاصوا في حرب

τὴν τοῦ Θεοῦ γνῶσιν,
ἀλλὰ καὶ μεγάλῳ ζῶντες
ἀγνοίας πολέμῳ τὰ
τοσαῦτα κακὰ εἰρήνην
προσαγορεύουσιν. 23 ἢ
γὰρ τεκνοφόνους τελετὰς
ἢ κρύφια μυστήρια ἢ
ἐμμανεῖς ἐξ ἄλλων
θεσμῶν κώμους ἄγοντες,
24 οὔτε βίους οὔτε γάμους
καθαροὺς ἔτι
φυλάσσουσιν, ἕτερος δ'
ἕτερον ἢ λοχῶν ἀναιρεῖ ἢ
νοθεύων ὁδυνᾷ. 25 πάντα
δ' ἐπιμίξ ἔχει αἷμα καὶ
φόνος, κλοπὴ καὶ δόλος,
φθορά, ἀπιστία, ταραχή,
ἐπιорκία, θόρυβος
ἀγαθῶν, 26 χάριτος
ἀμνησία, ψυχῶν μiasμός,
γενέσεως ἐναλλαγή,
γάμων ἀταξία, μοιχεία καὶ
ἀσέλγεια. 27 ἢ γὰρ τῶν
ἀνωνύμων εἰδώλων
θρησκεία παντὸς ἀρχὴ
κακοῦ καὶ αἰτία καὶ πέρρας
ἐστίν· 28 ἢ γὰρ
εὐφραίνόμενοι μεμήνασιν
ἢ προφητεύουσι ψευδῇ ἢ
ζῶσιν ἀδίκως ἢ ἐπιорκοῦσι
ταχέως· 29 ἀψύχοις γὰρ
πεποιθότες εἰδώλοις
κακῶς ὁμόσαντες,
ἀδικηθῆναι οὐ

terrible evils peace.

²³ With their child-murdering
rites, their occult mysteries, or
their frenzied orgies with
outlandish customs,

²⁴ they no longer retain any
purity in their lives or their
marriages, one treacherously
murdering another or wronging
him by adultery.

²⁵ Everywhere a welter of blood
and murder, theft and fraud,
corruption, treachery, riot,
perjury,

²⁶ disturbance of decent people,
forgetfulness of favours,
pollution of souls, sins against
nature, disorder in
marriage, adultery and
debauchery.

²⁷ For the worship of idols with
no name is the beginning, cause,
and end of every evil.

²⁸ For these people either carry
their merrymaking to the point
of frenzy, or they prophesy what
is not true, or they live wicked
lives, or they perjure themselves
without hesitation;

²⁹ since they put their trust in
lifeless idols they do not reckon
their false oaths can harm them.

³⁰ But they will be justly
punished for this double crime:

الْجَهْلِ الشَّدِيدَةِ، وَهُمْ يَسْمُونِ مِثْلَ
هَذِهِ الشَّرُورِ سَلَامًا.

23 فَإِنَّهُمْ يَمَارِسُونَ ذَبَائِحَ مِنْ
بَنِيهِمْ، وَشَعَائِرَ خَفِيَّةً وَمَادِبَ جُنُونٍ
عَلَى أَسَالِيبَ أُخَرَ.

24 لَا يَرْعَوْنَ حُسْنَ السَّيْرِ وَلَا
طَهَارَةَ الزَّوْاجِ فَيَقْتُلُ الرَّجُلُ صَاحِبَهُ
بِالْاِغْتِيَالِ وَيَمْضِي بِالْفَاحِشَةِ.

25 شَرٌّ مُتَفَاعِمٌ فِي كُلِّ مَوْضِعٍ،
الدَّمُ وَالْقَتْلُ وَالسَّرِقَةُ وَالْمَكْرُ
وَالْفَسَادُ وَالْخِيَانَةُ وَالْفِتْنَةُ وَالْحِنْثُ
وَقَلْقُ الْأَبْرَارِ،

26 وَكَفْرَانُ النِّعْمَةِ وَتَدْنِسُ النُّفُوسِ
وَالْتِبَاسُ الْمَوَالِيدِ وَتَشْوِشُ الزَّوْاجِ
وَالْفَسْقُ وَالْعَهْرُ،

27 لِأَنَّ عِبَادَةَ الْأَصْنَامِ الْمَكْرُوهَةَ
هِيَ عِلَّةُ كُلِّ شَرٍّ وَابْتِدَآؤُهُ وَغَايَتُهُ.

28 فَإِنَّهُمْ إِذَا فَرَحُوا جُنُوءًا، أَوْ
تَنَبَّأُوا كَذِبًا، أَوْ عَامَلُوا ظَلَمًا، أَوْ
حَالَفُوا أَسْرَعُوا إِلَى الْحِنْثِ.

29 وَلَتَوَكَّلُهُمْ عَلَى أَصْنَامٍ لَا أَرْوَاحَ
لَهَا لَا، يَتَوَقَّعُونَ إِذَا أَقْسَمُوا بِالزُّورِ
أَنْ يَنَالَهُمُ الْخُسْرَانُ.

30 فَهَنَّاكَ أَمْرَانِ يَسْتَحِقُّونَ بِهِمَا
حُلُولَ الْعِقَابِ: سُوءُ اعْتِقَادِهِمْ فِي

προσδέχονται. 30 ἀμφοτέρω δὲ αὐτοὺς μετελεύσεται τὰ δίκαια, ὅτι κακῶς ἐφρόνησαν περὶ Θεοῦ προσχόντες εἰδώλοις καὶ ἀδίκως ὥμοσαν ἐν δόλῳ καταφρονήσαντες ὁσιότητος· 31 οὐ γὰρ ἡ τῶν ὁμνουμένων δύναμις, ἀλλ' ἡ τῶν ἁμαρτανόντων δίκη ἐπεξέρχεται ἀεὶ τὴν τῶν ἀδίκων παράβασιν.	for degrading the concept of God by adhering to idols; and for wickedly perjuring themselves in contempt for what is holy. ³¹ For it is not the power of the things by which they swear but the punishment reserved for sinners that always follows the offences of wicked people.	الله إِذِ اتَّبَعُوا الْأَصْنَامَ، وَقَسَمَهُمْ بِالظُّلْمِ وَالْمَكْرِ إِذِ اسْتَخَفُّوا بِالْقُدَّاسَةِ، 31 لِأَنَّ مَعْصِيَةَ الظَّالِمِينَ إِنَّمَا يَتَعَقَّبُهَا الْقَضَاءُ عَلَى الْخَطَاةِ لَا قُدْرَةُ الْمُقْسِمِ بِهِمْ.
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الأصحاح الخامس عشر

ΣΥ δὲ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν χρηστὸς καὶ ἀληθής, μακρόθυμος καὶ ἐν ἐλέει διοικῶν τὰ πάντα. 2 καὶ γὰρ ἐὰν ἁμαρτωμεν, σοὶ ἐσμεν, εἰδότες σου τὸ κράτος· οὐχ ἁμαρτησόμεθα δέ, εἰδότες ὅτι σοὶ λελογίσμεθα. 3 τὸ γὰρ ἐπίστασθαί σε ὁλόκληρος δικαιοσύνη, καὶ εἰδέναι τὸ κράτος σου ρίζα ἀθανασίας. 4 οὐτε γὰρ ἐπλάνησεν ἡμᾶς ἀνθρώπων κακότεχνος ἐπίνοια, οὐδὲ σκιαγράφων πόνος ἄκαρπος, εἶδος σπιλωθὲν χρώμασι διηλλαγμένοις, 5 ὧν ὅψις ἄφροσιν εἰς ὄνειδος ἔρχεται, ποθεῖ τε νεκρᾶς εἰκόνος	¹ But you, our God, are kind and true, slow to anger, governing the universe with mercy. ² Even if we sin, we are yours, since we acknowledge your power, but we will not sin, knowing we count as yours. ³ To know you is indeed the perfect virtue, and to know your power is the root of immortality. ⁴ We have not been duped by inventions of misapplied human skill, or by the sterile work of painters, by figures daubed with assorted colours, ⁵ the sight of which sets fools yearning and hankering for the	1 وَأَنْتَ يَا إِلَهَنَا ذُو صَلَاحٍ وَصِدْقٍ، طَوِيلُ الْأَنَاءِ وَمُدَبِّرُ الْجَمِيعِ بِالرَّحْمَةِ. 2 فَإِذَا خَطَيْنَا فَنَحْنُ فِي يَدِكَ، وَقَدْ عَلِمْنَا قُدْرَتَكَ، لَكِنَّا لَا نَخْتَارُ الْخَطَاةَ لَعَلَّمْنَا بِأَنَّا مِنْ خَاصَّتِكَ. 3 فَإِنَّ مَعْرِفَتَكَ هِيَ الْبِرُّ الْكَامِلُ، وَالْعِلْمُ بِقُدْرَتِكَ هُوَ أَصْلُ الْحَيَاةِ الدَّائِمَةِ. 4 لِذَلِكَ لَمْ يَغْوِنَا مَا اخْتَرَعَتْهُ صِنَاعَةُ النَّاسِ الْمَمْقُوتَةُ، وَلَا عَمَلُ الْمُصَوِّرِينَ الْعَقِيمِ مِنَ الصُّورِ الْمُلَطَّخَةِ بِالْأَلْوَانِ. 5 الَّتِي فِي النَّظَرِ إِلَيْهَا فَضِيحَةٌ
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εἶδος ἄπνουν. 6 κακῶν
ἐρασταὶ ἄξιοί τε τοιούτων
ἐλπίδων, καὶ οἱ δρῶντες καὶ
οἱ ποθοῦντες καὶ οἱ
σεβόμενοι. 7 Καὶ γὰρ
κεραμεὺς ἀπαλὴν γῆν
θλίβων ἐπίμοχθον πλάσσει
πρὸς ὑπηρεσίαν ἡμῶν ἐν
ἑκάστον· ἀλλ' ἐκ τοῦ αὐτοῦ
πηλοῦ ἀνεπλάσατο τὰ τε
τῶν καθαρῶν ἔργων δοῦλα
σκεύη τὰ τε ἐναντία, πάνθ'
ὁμοίως· τούτων δὲ ἑκατέρου
τίς ἐκάστω ἐστὶν ἡ χρῆσις,
κριτὴς ὁ πηλουργός· 8 καὶ
κακόμοχθος θεὸν μάταιον
ἐκ τοῦ αὐτοῦ πλάσσει
πηλοῦ, ὃς πρὸ μικροῦ γῆς
γεννηθεὶς μετ' ὀλίγον
πορεύεται ἐξ ἧς ἐλήφθη, τὸ
τῆς ψυχῆς ἀπαιτηθεὶς χρέος.
9 ἀλλ' ἔστιν αὐτῷ φροντὶς
οὐχ ὅτι μέλλει κάμνειν, ἀλλ'
ὅτι βραχυτελῆ βίον ἔχει,
ἀλλ' ἀντερείδεται μὲν
χρυσουργοῖς καὶ
ἀργυροχόοις,
χαλκοπλάστας τε μιμεῖται
καὶ δόξαν ἡγεῖται ὅτι
κίβδηλα πλάσσει. 10 σποδὸς
ἡ καρδιά αὐτοῦ, καὶ γῆς
εὐτελεστέρα ἡ ἐλπίς αὐτοῦ,
πηλοῦ τε ἀτιμότερος ὁ βίος
αὐτοῦ, 11 ὅτι ἡγνόησε τὸν

lifeless form of an unbreathing
image.

⁶ Lovers of evil and worthy of
such hopes are those who
make them, those who want
them and those who worship
them.

⁷ Take a potter, now,
laboriously working the soft
earth, shaping each object for
us to use. Out of the self-same
clay, he models vessels
intended for a noble use and
those for a contrary purpose,
all alike: but which of these
two uses each will have is for
the potter himself to decide.

⁸ Then -- ill -- spent effort!-
from the same clay he models
a futile god, although so
recently made out of earth
himself and shortly to return to
what he was taken from, when
asked to give back
the soul that has been lent to
him.

⁹ Even so, he does not worry
about having to die or about
the shortness of his life, but
strives to outdo the goldsmiths
and silversmiths, imitates the
bronzeworkers, and prides
himself on modelling
counterfeits.

¹⁰ Ashes, his heart; more vile

للسفهاء بعشقهم، صورة تمثال
ميت لا روح فيه.

6 لا جرم أن الذين يصنعونها
والذين يعشقونها والذين يعبدونها
هم كلّفون بالمنكرات، وهم أهل
لأن تكون آمالهم في أمثال هذه.

7 إن الخزاف يعني بعجن الطين
اللين، ويصنع منه كل إناء مما
نستخدمه؛ فيصنع من الطين
الواحد الآنية المستخدمة في
الأعمال الطاهرة والمستخدمه في
عكس ذلك، وأما تخصيص كل

إناء بواحدة من الخدمتين فإنما
يرجع إلى حكم صانع الطين.
8 وبعنائهم الممقوت يصنع من هذا
الطين إلهاً باطلاً، وهو إنما ولد
من الطين من حين يسير، وعن
قليل سيعود إلى ما أخذ منه حين
يطالب بدين نفسه.

9 غير أن همه ليس بأنه يتعب ولا
بأنه قريب الأجل، لكنه يباري
صاغة الذهب والفضة، ويعارض
النحاسين، ويعتد ما يصنعه من
الخصائس فخراً.

10 فقلبه رماد، ورجاؤه أخس

πλάσαντα αὐτὸν καὶ τὸν ἐμπνεύσαντα αὐτῷ ψυχὴν ἐνεργοῦσαν καὶ ἐμφυσήσαντα πνεῦμα ζωτικόν· 12 ἄλλ' ἐλογίσαντο παίγνιον εἶναι τὴν ζωὴν ἡμῶν καὶ τὸν βίον πανηγυρισμὸν ἐπικερδῆ· δεῖν γὰρ φησιν ὅθεν δῆ, καὶ ἐκ κακοῦ, πορίζειν. 13 οὗτος γὰρ παρὰ πάντα οἶδεν ὅτι ἀμαρτάνει, ὕλης γεώδους εὐθραυστα σκεύη καὶ γλυπτὰ δημιουργῶν. 14 πάντες δ' ἀφρονέστατοι καὶ τάλαντες ὑπὲρ ψυχὴν νηπίου οἱ ἐχθροὶ τοῦ λαοῦ σου καταδυναστεύσαντες αὐτόν, 15 ὅτι καὶ πάντα εἰδῶλα τῶν ἐθνῶν ἐλογίσαντο θεούς, οἷς οὔτε ὁμμάτων χρῆσις εἰς ὄρασιν οὔτε ῥῖνες εἰς συνολκὴν ἀέρος οὔτε ὦτα ἀκούειν οὔτε δάκτυλοι χειρῶν εἰς ψηλάφησιν, καὶ οἱ πόδες αὐτῶν ἀργοὶ πρὸς ἐπίβασιν. 16 ἄθρωπος γὰρ ἐποίησεν αὐτούς, καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα δεδανεισμένος ἔπλασεν αὐτούς· οὐδεὶς γὰρ αὐτῷ ὅμοιον ἄνθρωπος ἰσχύει πλάσαι Θεόν. 17 θνητὸς δὲ ὢν νεκρὸν ἐργάζεται χερσὶν	than earth, his hope; more wretched than clay, his life! 11 For he has misconceived the One who has modelled him, who breathed an active soul into him and inspired a living spirit. 12 What is more, he looks on this life of ours as a kind of game, and our time here like a fair, full of bargains. 'However foul the means,' he says, 'a man must make a living.' 13 He, more than any other, knows he is sinning, he who from one earthy stuff makes both brittle pots and idols. 14 But most foolish, more pitiable even than the soul of a little child, are the enemies who once played the tyrant with your people, 15 and have taken all the idols of the heathen for gods; these can use neither their eyes for seeing nor their nostrils for breathing the air nor their ears for hearing nor the fingers on their hands for handling nor their feet for walking. 16 They have been made, you see, by a human being, modelled by a being whose own breath is borrowed. No man can model a god to	مِنَ التُّرَابِ، وَحَيَاتِهِ أَهْقَرُ مِنَ الطِّينِ، 11 لِأَنَّهُ جَهَلَ مَنْ جَبَلَهُ، وَنَفَخَ فِيهِ نَفْسًا عَامِلَةً وَرُوحًا مُحْيِيًا. 12 بَلْ حَسِبَ حَيَاتَنَا عِبَثًا، وَعَمْرَنَا مَوْسِمًا لِلَاكْتِسَابِ، وَزَعَمَ أَنَّهُ لَا بَدَّ مِنَ الرِّيحِ بِكُلِّ حِيلَةٍ وَلَوْ بِالظُّلْمِ. 13 فَإِنَّهُ عَالِمٌ بِأَنَّهُ أَعْظَمُ جُرْمًا مِنَ الْجَمِيعِ، لِأَنَّهُ يَصْنَعُ مِنْ طِينِ الْأَرْضِ آنِيَةً قَصِصَةً وَمِنْحَوَاتٍ. 14 إِنَّ جَمِيعَ أَعْدَاءِ شَعْبِكَ الْمُسَلِّطِينَ عَلَيْهِمْ هُمْ أَجْهَلُ النَّاسِ، وَأَشَقَى مِنْ نُفُوسِ الْأَطْفَالِ، 15 لِأَنَّهُمْ حَسَبُوا جَمِيعَ أَصْنَامِ الْأُمَمِ آلِهَةً تِلْكَ الَّتِي لَا تَبْصُرُ بِعُيُونِهَا، وَلَا تَنْشِقُ الْهَوَاءَ بِأَنْوْفِهَا، وَلَا تَسْمَعُ بِأَذَانِهَا، وَلَا تَلْمَسُ بِأَصَابِعِ أَيْدِيهَا وَأَرْجُلُهَا، عَاجِزَةٌ عَنِ الْخَطْوِ، 16 لِأَنَّهَا إِنَّمَا عَمَلَهَا إِنْسَانٌ، وَالَّذِي أُعِيرَ رُوحًا صَنَعَهَا وَلَيْسَ فِي طَاقَةِ إِنْسَانٍ أَنْ يَصْنَعَ إِلَهًا مِثْلَهُ، 17 وَإِنَّمَا هُوَ فَإِنْ فَيَصْنَعُ بِيَدَيْهِ
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ἀνόμοις· κρείττων γάρ ἐστι τῶν σεβασμάτων αὐτοῦ, ὧν αὐτὸς μὲν ἔζησεν, ἐκεῖνα δὲ οὐδέποτε. 18 καὶ τὰ ζῶα δὲ τὰ ἔχθιστα σέβονται· ἀνοία γάρ συγκρινόμενα τῶν ἄλλων ἐστὶ χείρονα· 19 οὐδ' ὅσον ἐπιποθῆσαι ὡς ἐν ζώων ὄψει καλὰ τυγχάνει, ἐκπέφυγε δὲ καὶ τὸν τοῦ Θεοῦ ἔπαινον καὶ τὴν εὐλογία αὐτοῦ.	resemble himself; ¹⁷ subject to death, his impious hands can produce only something dead. He himself is worthier than the things he worships; he will at least have lived, but never they. ¹⁸ And they worship even the most loathsome of animals, worse than the rest in their degree of stupidity, ¹⁹ without a trace of beauty -- if that is what is attractive in animals- and excluded from God's praises and blessing.	الْأَيْمَتَيْنِ مَا لَا حَيَاةَ فِيهِ. فَهُوَ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ مَعْبُودَاتِهِ، إِذْ هُوَ قَدْ كَانَ حَيًّا، وَأَمَّا هِيَ فَلَمْ تَكُنْ حَيَّةً الْبَتَّةَ. 18 وَهُمْ يَعْبُدُونَ أَعْدَى الْحَيَوَانِ، مِمَّا هُوَ أَشَدُّ الْبِهَائِمِ عُجْمَةً، 19 وَلَيْسَ فِيهِ مَا فِي مَنْظَرِ الْحَيَوَانَاتِ الْآخِرَةِ مِنَ الْحُسْنِ الشَّائِقِ، إِذْ فَاتَهُ مَدْحُ اللَّهِ وَبَرَكَتُهُ.
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الأصحاح السادس عشر

ΔΙΑ τοῦτο δ' ὁμοίων ἐκολάσθησαν ἀξίως καὶ διὰ πλήθους κνωδάλων ἐβασανίσθησαν. 2 ἀνθ' ἧς κολάσεως εὐεργετήσας τὸν λαόν σου, εἰς ἐπιθυμίαν ὀρέξεως ξένην γεῦσιν, τροφήν ἡτοίμασας ὀρτυγομήτραν, 3 ἵνα ἐκεῖνοι μὲν ἐπιθυμοῦντες τροφήν διὰ τὴν εἰδέ χθελιν τῶν ἐπαπεσταλμένων καὶ τὴν ἀναγκαίαν ὀρεξιν ἀποστρέφονται, αὐτοὶ δὲ ἐπ' ὀλίγον ἐνδεεῖς γενόμενοι καὶ ξένης	¹ Thus they were appropriately punished by similar creatures and tormented by swarms of vermin. ² In contrast to this punishment, you did your people a kindness and, to satisfy their sharp appetite, provided quails -- a luscious rarity -- for them to eat. ³ Thus the Egyptians, at the repulsive sight of the creatures sent against them, were to find that, though they longed for food, they had lost their natural appetite; whereas your own people, after a short privation, were to have a rare relish for	1 لِذَلِكَ كَانُوا أَحْقَاءَ بَأَن يَعاقِبُوا بِأَمْثَالِ هَذِهِ، وَيَعَذِّبُوا بِجَمٍّ مِنَ الْحَشَرَاتِ. 2 أَمَّا شَعْبُكَ فَبَدَلًا مِنْ ذَلِكَ الْعِقَابِ، أَحْسَنْتَ إِلَيْهِمْ بِإِعْدَادِ السَّلْوَى مَأْكَلًا غَرِيبَ الطَّعْمِ، أَشْبَعْتَ بِهِ شَهْوَتَهُمْ. 3 حَتَّى إِنَّهُ بَيْنَمَا كَانَ أَوْلَئِكَ مَعَ جُوعِهِمْ فَاقْدَى كُلُّ شَهْوَةٍ لِلطَّعَامِ مِنْ كَرَاهَةٍ مَا بَعَثَتْ عَلَيْهِمْ، كَانَ هَؤُلَاءِ بَعْدَ عَوَزٍ يَسِيرٍ يَتَنَاوَلُونَ مَأْكَلًا غَرِيبَ الطَّعْمِ.
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μετάσχωσι γεύσεως. 4 ἔδει γὰρ ἐκείνοις μὲν ἀπαραίτητον ἔνδειαν ἐπελθεῖν τυραννοῦσι, τούτοις δὲ μόνον δειχθῆναι πῶς οἱ ἐχθροὶ αὐτῶν ἐβασανίζοντο. 5 Καὶ γὰρ ὅτε αὐτοῖς δεινὸς ἐπῆλθε θηρίων θυμὸς δῆγμασί τε σκολιῶν διεφθείροντο ὄφρων, οὐ μέχρι τέλους ἔμεινεν ἡ ὀργή σου. 6 εἰς νοθεσίαν δὲ πρὸς ὀλίγον ἐταράχθησαν, σύμβουλον ἔχοντες σωτηρίας εἰς ἀνάμνησιν ἐντολῆς νόμου σου. 7 ὁ γὰρ ἐπιστραφεὶς οὐ διὰ τὸ θεωρούμενον ἐσώζετο, ἀλλὰ διὰ σὲ τὸν πάντων σωτῆρα. 8 καὶ ἐν τούτῳ δὲ ἔπεισας τοὺς ἐχθροὺς ἡμῶν, ὅτι σὺ εἶ ὁ ρυόμενος ἐκ παντὸς κακοῦ. 9 οὓς μὲν γὰρ ἀκρίδων καὶ μυιῶν ἀπέκτεινε δῆγματα, καὶ οὐχ εὐρέθη ἰαματὴ ψυχῇ αὐτῶν, ὅτι ἄξιοι ἦσαν ὑπὸ τοιούτων κολασθῆναι. 10 τοὺς δὲ υἱούς σου οὐδὲ ἰοβόλων δρακόντων ἐνίκησαν ὀδόντες, τὸ ἔλεος γὰρ σου ἀντιπαρῆλθε καὶ ἰάσατο αὐτούς. 11 εἰς γὰρ ὑπόμνησιν τῶν λογίων σου	their portion. ⁴ Inevitable that relentless want should seize on the former oppressors; enough for your people to be shown how their enemies were being tortured. ⁵ Even when the fearful rage of wild animals overtook them and they were perishing from the bites of writhing snakes, your retribution did not continue to the end. ⁶ Affliction struck them briefly, by way of warning, and they had a saving token to remind them of the commandment of your Law, ⁷ for whoever turned to it was saved, not by what he looked at, but by you, the Saviour of all. ⁸ And by such means you proved to our enemies that you are the one who delivers from every evil; ⁹ for them, the bites of locusts and flies proved fatal and no remedy could be found to save their lives, since they deserved to be punished by such creatures. ¹⁰ But your children, not even the fangs of poisonous snakes could bring them down; for your mercy came to their help and	4 فَإِنَّهُ كَانَ يَنْبَغِي لِأُولَئِكَ الْمُقْتَسِرِينَ أَنْ تَنْزَلَ بِهِمْ فَاقَةً لَا مَنَاصَ مِنْهَا، وَلِهَذَا أَنْ يَرَوْا كَيْفَ يَعَذِّبُ أَعْدَاؤُهُمْ لَا غَيْرَ. 5 وَلَمَّا اقْتَحَمَ هَؤُلَاءِ حَنَقَ الْوَحُوشِ الْهَائِلِ، وَأَهْلَكَهُمْ لَدَغُ الْحَيَّاتِ الْخَبِيثَةِ، 6 لَمْ يَسْتَمِرَّ غَضَبُكَ إِلَى الْمُنْتَهَى، بَلْ إِنَّمَا أَقْلَقُوا إِلَى حِينٍ إِذْ ذَرَأَ لَهُمْ، وَنَصَبْتَ لَهُمْ عَلَامَةً لِلْخَلَاصِ، تَذَكَّرَهُمْ وَصِيَّةَ شَرِيعَتِكَ، 7 فَكَانَ الْمُتَلَفَتُ إِلَيْهَا يَخْلُصُ، لَا بِذَلِكَ الْمَنْظُورِ بَلْ بِكَ، يَا مُخَلِّصَ الْجَمِيعِ. 8 وَبِذَلِكَ أَثَبْتَ لِأَعْدَائِنَا، أَنَّكَ أَنْتَ الْمُنْقِذُ مِنْ كُلِّ سُوءٍ، 9 لِأَنَّ أُولَئِكَ قَتَلَهُمْ لَسَعُ الْجَرَادِ وَالذَّبَابِ، وَلَمْ يَوْجَدْ لِنَفْسِهِمْ شِفَاءً، إِذْ هُمْ أَهْلٌ لِأَنْ يَعَاقِبُوا بِمِثْلِ ذَلِكَ. 10 أَمَّا بَنُوكَ فَلَمْ تَقْوَعْ عَلَيْهِمْ أَنْيَابُ التَّنَّيْنِ السَّامَةِ، لِأَنَّ رَحْمَتَكَ أَقْبَلْتَ وَشَفْتَهُمْ. 11 وَإِنَّمَا نَحْسُوا لِيَتَذَكَّرُوا
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ἐνεκεντρίζοντο καὶ ὀξέως διεσώζοντο, ἵνα μὴ εἰς βαθεῖαν ἐμπεσόντες λήθην ἀπερίσπαστοι γένωνται τῆς σῆς εὐεργεσίας. 12 καὶ γὰρ οὔτε βοτάνη οὔτε μάλαγμα ἐθεράπευσεν αὐτούς, ἀλλὰ ὁ σός, Κύριε, λόγος ὁ πάντα ἰώμενος. 13 σὺ γὰρ ζωῆς καὶ θανάτου ἐξουσίαν ἔχεις καὶ κατάγεις εἰς πύλας ᾗδου καὶ ἀνάγεις. 14 ἄνθρωπος δὲ ἀποκτείνει μὲν τῇ κακίᾳ αὐτοῦ, ἐξελθὼν δὲ πνεῦμα οὐκ ἀναστρέφει οὐδὲ ἀναλύει ψυχὴν παραληφθεῖσαν. 15 Τὴν δὲ σὴν χειρὰ φυγεῖν ἀδύνατόν ἐστιν. 16 ἀρνούμενοι γὰρ σε εἰδέναι ἀσεβεῖς, ἐν ἰσχυρί βραχίονός σου ἐμαστιγώθησαν, ξένοις ὑετοῖς καὶ χαλάζαις καὶ ὄμβροις διωκόμενοι ἀπαραιτήτοις καὶ πυρὶ καταναλισκόμενοι. 17 τὸ γὰρ παραδοξότατον, ἐν τῷ πάντα σβεννύντι ὕδατι πλεῖον ἐνήργει τὸ πῦρ, ὑπέρμαχος γὰρ ὁ κόσμος ἐστὶ δικαίων. 18 ποτὲ μὲν γὰρ ἡμεροῦτο φλόξ, ἵνα μὴ καταφλέξῃ τὰ ἐπ' ἀσεβεῖς ἀπεσταλμένα ζῶα, ἀλλ'	cured them. 11 One sting -- how quickly healed! -- to remind them of your pronouncements rather than that, by sinking into deep forgetfulness, they should be cut off from your kindness. 12 No herb, no poultice cured them, but your all-healing word, Lord. 13 Yes, you are the one with power over life and death, bringing to the gates of Hades and back again. 14 A human being out of malice may put to death, but cannot bring the departed spirit back or free the soul that Hades has once received. 15 It is not possible to escape your hand. 16 The godless who refused to acknowledge you were scourged by the strength of your arm, pursued by no ordinary rains, hail and unrelenting downpours, and consumed by fire. 17 Even more wonderful, in the water -- which quenches all -- the fire raged fiercer than ever; for the elements fight for the upright. 18 At one moment, the fire would die down, to avoid	أَقْوَالَكَ، ثُمَّ خَلَصُوا سَرِيعًا، لئَلَّا يَسْقُطُوا فِي نِسْيَانٍ عَمِيقٍ؛ فَيَحْرَمُوا إِحْسَانَكَ. 12 وَمَا شَفَاهُمْ نَبْتٌ وَلَا مَرَّهْمٌ، بَلْ كَلِمَتُكَ، يَا رَبُّ، الَّتِي تَشْفِي الْجَمِيعَ، 13 لِأَنَّ لَكَ سُلْطَانَ الْحَيَاةِ وَالْمَوْتِ؛ فَتَحْدُرُ إِلَى أَبْوَابِ الْجَحِيمِ وَتَصْعَدُ. 14 أَمَّا الْإِنْسَانُ فَيَقْتُلُ بِخَبْثِهِ، لَكِنَّهُ لَا يَعِيدُ الرُّوحَ الَّذِي قَدْ خَرَجَ، وَلَا يَسْتَرْجِعُ النَّفْسَ الْمُقْبُوضَةَ. 15 إِنَّهُ لَيْسَ أَحَدٌ يَسْتَطِيعُ أَنْ يَهْرَبَ مِنْ يَدِكَ، 16 فَإِنَّكَ قَدْ جَلَدْتَ بِقُوَّةٍ ذَرَاعَكَ الْمُنَافِقِينَ، الَّذِينَ جَحَدُوا مَعْرِفَتَكَ، وَأَطْلَقْتَ فِي إِثْرِهِمْ سَيُولًا وَبَرَدًا وَأَمْطَارًا غَرِيبةً وَنَارًا أَكَلَةً. 17 وَأَغْرَبُ شَيْءٍ أَنَّ النَّارَ كَانَتْ فِي الْمَاءِ، الَّذِي يُطْفِئُ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ، تَزْدَادُ حِدَةً لِأَنَّ عَنَاصِرَ الْعَالَمِ تَقَاتِلُ عَنِ الصَّادِقِينَ. 18 وَكَانَ اللَّهْيَبُ تَارَةً يَسْكُنُ
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αὐτοὶ βλέποντες ἴδωσιν, ὅτι
 Θεοῦ κρίσει ἐλαύνονται. 19
 ποτὲ δὲ καὶ μεταξὺ ὕδατος
 ὑπὲρ τὴν πυρὸς δύναμιν
 φλέγει, ἵνα ἀδίκου γῆς
 γεννήματα διαφθείρῃ. 20
 ἀνθ' ὧν ἀγγέλων τροφήν
 ἐψώμισας τὸν λαόν σου καὶ
 ἔτοιμον ἄρτον αὐτοῖς ἀπ'
 οὐρανοῦ ἔπεμψας
 ἀκοπιάτως πᾶσαν ἡδονὴν
 ἰσχύοντα καὶ πρὸς πᾶσαν
 ἀρμόνιον γεῦσιν. 21 ἡ μὲν
 γὰρ ὑπόστασις σου τὴν σὴν
 γλυκύτητα πρὸς τέκνα
 ἐνεφάνισε, τῇ δὲ τοῦ
 προσφερομένου ἐπιθυμία
 ὑπηρετῶν πρὸς ὃ τις
 ἐβούλετο μετεκρινᾶτο. 22
 χιῶν δὲ καὶ κρύσταλλος
 ὑπέμεινε πῦρ καὶ οὐκ
 ἐτήκετο, ἵνα γνῶσιν ὅτι
 τοὺς τῶν ἐχθρῶν καρπούς
 κατέφθειρε πῦρ
 φλεγόμενον ἐν τῇ χαλάζῃ
 καὶ ἐν τοῖς ὑετοῖς
 διαστράπτει. 23 τοῦτο
 πάλιν δ' ἵνα τραφῶσι
 δίκαιοι, καὶ τῆς ἰδίας
 ἐπιλελησθαι δυνάμεως. 24
 ἡ γὰρ κτίσις σοι τῷ
 ποιήσαντι ὑπηρετοῦσα
 ἐπιτείνεται εἰς κόλασιν
 κατὰ τῶν ἀδίκων καὶ

consuming the animals sent
 against the godless and to make
 clear to them by that sight, that
 the sentence of God was
 pursuing them;

¹⁹ at another, in the very heart
 of the water, it would burn
 more fiercely than fire to ruin
 the produce of a wicked land.

²⁰ How differently with your
 people! You gave them the food
 of angels,
 from heaven untiringly providing
 them bread already prepared,
 containing every delight, to
 satisfy every taste.

²¹ And the substance you gave
 showed your sweetness towards
 your children, for, conforming to
 the taste of whoever ate it, it
 transformed itself into what
 each eater wished.

²² Snow and ice endured the
 fire, without melting; this was to
 show them that, to destroy the
 harvests of their enemies, fire
 would burn even in hail and
 flare in falling rain,

²³ whereas, on the other hand, it
 would even forget its
 own strength in the service of
 feeding the upright.

²⁴ For the creation, being at the
 service of you, its Creator,
 tautens to punish the wicked

لئلاَّ يَحْرَقَ مَا أُرْسِلَ عَلَى الْمُنَافِقِينَ
 مِنَ الْحَيَوَانِ، وَلَكِي يُبْصِرُوا
 فَيَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ قَضَاءَ اللَّهِ عَلَى
 أَعْقَابِهِمْ،

19 وَتَارَةً يَخْرُجُ عَنْ طَبْعِ النَّارِ
 فَيَتَأَجَّجُ فِي الْمَاءِ، لِكِي يَسْتَأْصِلَ
 أَنْبَتَةَ الْأَرْضِ الْأَثِيمَةِ.

20 أَمَّا شَعْبُكَ فَبَدَلًا مِنْ ذَلِكَ
 أَطْعَمْتَهُمْ طَعَامَ الْمَلَائِكَةِ، وَأُرْسَلَتْ
 لَهُمْ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ خَبْزًا مُعَدًّا لَا تَعَبَ
 فِيهِ، يَتَضَمَّنُ كُلُّ لَذَّةٍ، وَيُلَائِمُ كُلَّ
 ذَوْقٍ،

21 لِأَنَّ جَوْهَرَكَ أَبَدَى عَذُوبَتِكَ
 لِبَنِيكَ، فَكَانَ يَخْدُمُ شَهْوَةَ
 الْمُتَنَاوِلِ، وَيَتَحَوَّلُ إِلَى مَا شَاءَ كُلُّ
 وَاحِدٍ.

22 وَكَانَ الثَّلْجُ وَالْجَلِيدُ يَثْبَتَانِ
 فِي النَّارِ وَلَا يَذُوبَانِ، لِكِي يَعْلَمَ
 كَيْفَ أَكَلَتْ ثَمَارَ الْأَعْدَاءِ نَارٌ
 تَلْتَهَبُ فِي الْبَرْدِ، وَتَبْرُقُ فِي
 الْمَطَرِ.

23 أَمَّا عِنْدَ هَؤُلَاءِ فَقَدْ تَنَاسَتْ
 الْقُوَّةُ الَّتِي لَهَا، لِكِي يَغْتَذِيَ
 الْقَدِيسُونَ.

24 إِذِ الْخَلِيقَةُ الْخَادِمَةُ لَكَ أَنْتَ

ἀνίεται εἰς εὐεργεσίαν ὕπὲρ τῶν εἰς σὲ πεποιθότων. 25 διὰ τοῦτο καὶ τότε εἰς πάντα μεταλλευομένη τῇ παντοτρόφῳ σου δωρεᾷ ὑπηρετεῖ πρὸς τὴν τῶν δεομένων θέλησιν, 26 ἵνα μάθωσιν οἱ υἱοὶ σου, οὓς ἠγάπησας, Κύριε, ὅτι οὐχ αἱ γενέσεις τῶν καρπῶν τρέφουσιν ἄνθρωπον, ἀλλὰ τὸ ρῆμά σου τοὺς σοὶ πιστεύοντας διατηρεῖ. 27 τὸ γὰρ ὑπὸ πυρὸς μὴ φθειρόμενον ἀπλῶς ὑπὸ βραχείας ἀκτίνος ἡλίου θερμαινόμενον ἐτήκετο, 28 ὅπως γνωστὸν ᾗ ὅτι δεῖ φθάνειν τὸν ἥλιον ἐπ’ εὐχαριστίαν σου καὶ πρὸς ἀνατολὴν φωτὸς ἐντυγχάνειν σοι. 29 ἀχαρίστου γὰρ ἐλπίς ὡς χειμέριος πάχνη τακῆσεται καὶ ρυήσεται ὡς ὕδωρ ἄχρηστον.	and slackens for the benefit of those who trust in you. ²⁵ And this is why, by changing into all things, it obediently served your all-nourishing bounty, conforming to the wishes of those who were in need; ²⁶ so that your beloved children, Lord, might learn that the various crops are not what provide nourishment, but your word which preserves all who believe in you. ²⁷ For that which fire could not destroy melted in the heat of a single fleeting sunbeam, ²⁸ to show that, to give you thanks, we must rise before the sun and meet you at the dawning of the day; ²⁹ whereas the hope of the ungrateful melts like winter frost and flows away like water running to waste.	صَانَعَهَا تَتَشَدَّدُ، لَتَعَاقِبَ الْمُجْرِمِينَ، وَتَتَرَاخَى لِتُحْسِنَ إِلَى الْمُتَوَكِّلِينَ عَلَيْكَ. 25 لِذَلِكَ كَانَتْ حِينَئِذٍ تَتَحَوَّلُ إِلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، لِتَخْدُمَ نِعْمَتَكَ الْغَاذِيَةَ الْجَمِيعَ عَلَى مَا يَشَاءُ كُلُّ مُحْتَاجٍ، 26 لَكِي يَعْلَمَ بَنُوكَ الَّذِينَ أَحْبَبْتَهُمْ، أَيُّهَا الرَّبُّ، أَنَّ لَيْسَ مَا تُخْرِجُ الْأَرْضُ مِنَ الثَّمَارِ هُوَ يَغْذُو الْإِنْسَانَ، لَكِنْ كَلِمَتُكَ هِيَ الَّتِي تَحْفَظُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ بِكَ. 27 إِذْ مَا لَمْ تَكُنِ النَّارُ تَحُلُّهُ، كَانَتْ شُعَاعَةٌ يَسِيرُهُ مِنَ الشَّمْسِ تَحْمِيهِ فَيَذُوبُ، 28 حَتَّى يَعْلَمَ أَنَّهُ يَجِبُ أَنْ نَسْبِقَ الشَّمْسَ إِلَى شُكْرِكَ، وَنَحْضُرَ أَمَامَكَ عِنْدَ شُرُوقِ النُّورِ. 29 لِأَنَّ رَجَاءَ مَنْ لَا شُكْرَ لَهُ يَذُوبُ كَجَلِيدِ شَتْوَى، وَيَذْهَبُ كَمَاءٍ لَا مَنَفْعَةَ فِيهِ.
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الأصاح السابيع عشر

ΜΕΓΑΛΑΙ γάρ σου αἰ κρίσεις καὶ δυσδιήγητοι· διὰ τοῦτο ἀπαίδευτοι ψυχὰι ἐπλανήθησαν. 2 ὑπειληφότες γὰρ καταδυναστεύειν ἔθνος ἅγιον ἄνομοι, δέσμιοι σκότους καὶ μακρᾶς πεδῆται νυκτὸς κατακλεισθέντες ὀρόφοις, φυγάδες τῆς αἰωνίου προνοίας ἔκειντο. 3 λανθάνειν γὰρ νομίζοντες ἐπὶ κρυφαίοις ἁμαρτήμασιν, ἀφεγγεῖ λήθης παρακαλύμματι ἐσκορπίσθησαν, θαμβούμενοι δεινῶς καὶ ἰνδάλμασιν ἐκταρασσόμενοι. 4 οὐδὲ γὰρ ὁ κατέχων αὐτοὺς μυχὸς ἀφόβως διεφύλασσε, ἦχοι δὲ καταράσσοντες αὐτοὺς περιεκόμπουν, καὶ φάσματα ἀμειδίτοις κατηφῇ προσώποις ἐνεφανίζετο. 5 καὶ πυρὸς μὲν οὐδεμία βία κατίσχυε φωτίζειν, οὔτε ἄστρων ἑκλαμπροὶ φλόγες καταυγάζειν ὑπέμενον τὴν στυγνὴν ἐκείνην νύκτα. 6 διεφαίνετο δ' αὐτοῖς μόνον αὐτομάτη πυρὰ φόβου πλήρης, ἐκδειματούμενοι δὲ	¹ Yes, your judgements are great and impenetrable, which is why uninstructed souls have gone astray. ² While the wicked supposed they had a holy nation in their power, they themselves lay prisoners of the dark, in the fetters of long night, confined under their own roofs, banished from eternal providence. ³ While they thought to remain unnoticed with their secret sins, curtained by dark forgetfulness, they were scattered in fearful dismay, terrified by apparitions. ⁴ The hiding place sheltering them could not ward off their fear; terrifying noises echoed round them; and gloomy, grim-faced spectres haunted them. ⁵ No fire had power enough to give them light, nor could the brightly blazing stars illuminate that dreadful night. ⁶ The only light for them was a great, spontaneous blaze -- a fearful sight to see! And in their terror, once that sight had vanished, they thought what they had seen more terrible than ever. ⁷ Their magical illusions were	1 إِنْ أَحْكَامَكَ عَظِيمَةً لَا يَعْبُرُ عَنْهَا، وَلِذَلِكَ ضَلَّتِ النُّفُوسُ الَّتِي لَا تَأْدِيبَ لَهَا. 2 فَإِنَّهُ لَمَّا تَوَهَّمِ الْمَجْرِمُونَ أَنَّهُمْ يَتَسَلَّطُونَ عَلَى الْأُمَّةِ الْقُدِّيسَةِ، إِذَا هُمْ مَلْقُونُ فِي أَسْرِ الظُّلْمَةِ وَقِيُودِ اللَّيْلِ الطَّوِيلِ، مَحْبُوسُونَ تَحْتَ سَقُوفِهِمْ، مَنْفِيُّونَ عَنِ الْعِنَايَةِ الْأَبَدِيَّةِ. 3 وَإِذْ حَسَبُوا أَنَّهُمْ مُسْتَتَرُونَ فِي خَطَايَاهُمْ الْخَفِيَّةِ، فَفَرَّقَ بَيْنَهُمْ سِتْرَ النَّسْيَانِ الْمَظْلَمِ، وَهُمْ فِي رَعْبٍ شَدِيدٍ تَقْلُقُهُمُ الْأَخِيلَةُ. 4 وَلَمْ تَكُنْ الْأَكْنَةُ الَّتِي لَبِثُوا فِيهَا لِتَقِيَهُمْ مِنَ الذَّعْرِ؛ فَقَدْ كَانَتْ أَصْوَاتٌ قَاصِفَةٌ تَدْوِي مِنْ حَوْلِهِمْ، وَأَشْبَاحٌ مُكْفَهَرَةٌ تَتَرَاءَى أَمَامَ وَجُوهِهِمُ الْكَاسِفَةِ. 5 وَلَمْ يَكُنْ فِي قُوَّةِ النَّارِ مَهْمَا اشْتَدَّتْ أَنْ تَأْتِيَ بَضِيَاءً، وَلَا فِي بَرِيقِ النُّجُومِ أَنْ يَنْبِيرَ ذَلِكَ اللَّيْلِ الْمَدْلِهِمْ. 6 وَإِنَّمَا كَانَتْ تَلْمَعُ لَهُمْ بَغْتَةً نِيرَانٌ مُخِيفَةٌ؛ فَيَرْتَعِدُونَ مِنْ ذَلِكَ
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τῆς μὴ θεωρουμένης ἐκείνης ὄψεως ἡγοῦντο χεῖρω τὰ βλεπόμενα. 7 μαγικῆς δὲ ἐμπαίγματα κατέκειτο τέχνης, καὶ τῆς ἐπὶ φρονήσει ἀλαζονείας ἔλεγχος ἐφύβριστος· 8 οἱ γὰρ ὑπισχνούμενοι δείματα καὶ ταραχὰς ἀπελαύνειν ψυχῆς νοσοῦσης, οὗτοι καταγέλαστον εὐλάβειαν ἐνόσουν. 9 καὶ γὰρ εἰ μηδὲν αὐτοὺς ταραχῶδες ἐφόβει, κνωδάλων παρόδοις καὶ ἔρπετῶν συριγμοῖς ἐκσεσοβημένοι, 10 διώλλυντο ἔντρομοι καὶ τὸν μηθαμόθεν φευκτὸν ἀέρα προσιδεῖν ἀρνούμενοι. 11 δειλὸν γὰρ ἰδίως πονηρία μαρτυρεῖ καταδικαζομένη, αἰεὶ δὲ προσείληφε τὰ χαλεπὰ συνεχομένη τῇ συνειδήσει· 12 οὐθὲν γὰρ ἐστι φόβος εἰ μὴ προδοσία τῶν ἀπὸ λογισμοῦ βοηθημάτων. 13 ἔνδοθεν δὲ οὐσα ἥττων ἢ προσδοκία, πλείονα λογίζεται τὴν ἄγνοιαν τῆς παρεχούσης τὴν βάσανον αἰτίας. 14 οἱ δὲ τὴν ἀδύνατον ὄντως νύκτα καὶ ἐξ ἀδυνάτου ἄδου μυχῶν ἐπελθοῦσαν, τὸν αὐτὸν	powerless now, and their claims to intelligence were ignominiously confounded; ⁸ for those who promised to drive out fears and disorders from sick souls were now themselves sick with ludicrous fright. ⁹ Even when there was nothing frightful to scare them, the vermin creeping past and the hissing of reptiles filled them with panic; ¹⁰ they died convulsed with fright, refusing even to look at empty air, which cannot be eluded anyhow! ¹¹ Wickedness is confessedly very cowardly, and it condemns itself; under pressure from conscience it always assumes the worst. ¹² Fear, indeed, is nothing other than the failure of the help offered by reason; ¹³ the less you rely within yourself on this, the more alarming it is not to know the cause of your suffering. ¹⁴ And they, all locked in the same sleep, while that darkness lasted -- which was in fact quite powerless and had issued from the depths of equally powerless	المنظر المبهم، ويتوهمون ما يظهر لهم أهول مما هو. 7 حينئذ بطلت صناعة السحر وشعوذته، وبرز على افتخارهم بالحكمة حجة مخزية، 8 إذ الذين وعدوا بنفي الجزع والبلبال عن النفس الدنفة، هؤلاء أدنفهم خوف مضحك. 9 فإنهم وإن لم يصبهم شيء هائل، كان مرور الوحوش وفحيح الأفاعي يدحرهم فيهلكون من الخوف، ويتوقون حتى الهواء الذي لا محيد عنه. 10 لأن الخبث ملازم للجبن؛ فهو يقضي على نفسه بشهادته، ولقلق الضمير لا يزال متخيلاً الضربات. 11 فإن الخوف إنما هو ترك المدد الذي من العقل، 12 وانتظار المدد من الداخل أضعف، ولذلك تحسب مجلبة العذاب المجهولة أشد. 13 فالذين ناموا تلك النومة في ذلك الليل الذي لا يطاق، الوارد من أخادير الجحيم الفظيعة،
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ὑπνον κοιμώμενοι, 15 τὰ μὲν τέρασιν ἡλαύνοντο φαντασμάτων, τὰ δὲ τῆς ψυχῆς παρελύοντο προδοσίᾳ· αἰφνίδιος γὰρ αὐτοῖς καὶ ἀπροσδόκητος φόβος ἐπῆλθεν. 16 εἴθ' οὕτως, ὃς δήποτ' οὖν ἦν ἐκεῖ καταπίπτων, ἐφρουρεῖτο εἰς τὴν ἀσίδηρον εἰρκτὴν κατακλεισθείς· 17 εἴτε γὰρ γεωργὸς ἦν τις ἢ ποιμὴν ἢ τῶν κατ' ἐρημίαν ἐργάτης μόχθων, προληφθεὶς τὴν δυσάλυκτον ἔμενεν ἀνάγκην, 18 μιᾷ γὰρ ἀλύσει σκότους πάντες ἐδέθησαν· εἴτε πνεῦμα συρίζον ἢ περὶ ἀμφιλαφεῖς κλάδους ὀρνέων ἦχος εὐμελὴς ἢ ρυθμὸς ὕδατος πορευομένου βία ἢ κτύπος ἀπηνῆς καταρριπτομένων πετρῶν, 19 ἢ σκιρτώντων ζῶων δρόμος ἀθεώρητος ἢ ὠρυομένων ἀπηνεστάτων θηρίων φωνὴ ἢ ἀντανακλωμένη ἐκ κοιλοτάτων ὀρέων ἡχώ, παρέλυσεν αὐτοὺς ἐκφοβοῦντα. 20 ὅλος γὰρ ὁ κόσμος λαμπρῶ καταλάμπετο φωτὶ καὶ ἀνεμποδίστοις συνείχετο	Hades- 15 were now chased by monstrous spectres, now paralysed by the fainting of their souls; for a sudden, unexpected terror had attacked them. 16 And thus, whoever it might be that fell there stayed clamped to the spot in this prison without bars. 17 Whether he was ploughman or shepherd, or somebody at work in the desert, he was still overtaken and suffered the inevitable fate, for all had been bound by the one same chain of darkness. 18 The sougning of the wind, the tuneful noise of birds in the spreading branches, the measured beat of water in its powerful course, the headlong din of rocks cascading down, 19 the unseen course of bounding animals, the roaring of the most savage of wild beasts, the echo rebounding from the clefts in the mountains, all held them paralysed with fear. 20 For the whole world shone with the light of day and, unhindered, went about its work; 21 over them alone there spread a heavy darkness, image of the	14 كَانُوا تَارَةً تَقْتَحِمُهُم الْأَخِيلَةَ، وَتَارَةً تَحُلُّ قَوَاهِمَ مِنْ انْخِلَاعِ قُلُوبِهِمْ لَمَّا غَشِيَهُمْ مِنْ مُفَاجَأَةِ الْخَوْفِ الْغَيْرِ الْمَتَوَقَّعِ. 15 ثُمَّ حَيْثُمَا سَقَطَ أَحَدٌ بَقِيَ مَحْبُوسًا فِي سَجْنٍ لَا حَدِيدَ فِيهِ. 16 فَإِنْ كَانَ فَلَاحًا أَوْ رَاعِيًا أَوْ صَاحِبَ عَمَلٍ مِنْ أَعْمَالِ الصَّحْرَاءِ، أُخِذَ بَغْتَةً فَوَقَعَ فِي قَسْرٍ لَا انْفِكَاكَ عَنْهُ، 17 إِذْ جَمِيعُهُمْ كَانُوا مُقِيدِينَ بِسُلْسَلَةٍ وَاحِدَةٍ مِنَ الظَّلَامِ. فَدَوَى الرِّيحِ وَأَغَارِيدُ الطُّيُورِ عَلَى الْأَغْصَانِ الْمُتَلَفِّفَةِ، وَصَوْتُ الْمِيَاهِ الْمُنْدَفِعَةِ بِقُوَّةٍ، 18 وَقَعْقَعَةُ الْحَجَارَةِ الْمُتَدَحْرِجَةِ، وَرَكْضُ الْحَيَوَانَاتِ الَّذِي لَا يَرَى، وَزَيْثُ الْوَحُوشِ الضَّارِيَةِ، وَالصَّدى الْمَتَرَدِّدِ فِي بُطُونِ الْجِبَالِ، كُلُّ ذَلِكَ كَانَ يُذَيِّبُهُمْ مِنَ الْخَوْفِ. 19 وَبَيْنَمَا كَانَ سَائِرُ الْعَالَمِ يُضِيئُهُ نَوْرٌ سَاطِعٌ، وَيَتَعَاطَى أَعْمَالُهُ بِغَيْرِ مَانِعٍ، 20 كَانَ أَوْلَيْكَ مُنْفَرِدِينَ فِي
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ἔργοις· 21 μόνοις δὲ ἐκείνοις ἐπετέτατο βαρεῖα νύξ, εἰκὼν τοῦ μέλλοντος αὐτοὺς διαδέχεσθαι σκότους, ἑαυτοῖς δὲ ἦσαν βαρύτεροι σκότους.	dark that would receive them. But heavier than the darkness was the burden they were to themselves.	ظَلٌّ لَّيْلٌ مُدْلِهِمْ، مُشَاكِلٌ لِّمَا سَيَغْشَاهُمْ مِنَ الظُّلْمَةِ. لَكِنْهُمْ كَانُوا عَلَى أَنْفُسِهِمْ أَثْقَلٌ مِنَ الظُّلْمَةِ.
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الأصاحاح الثامن عشر

ΤΟΙΣ δὲ ὁσίοις σου μέγιστον ἦν φῶς· ὦν φωνὴν μὲν ἀκούοντες, μορφὴν δὲ οὐχ ὁρῶντες, ὅτι μὲν οὐ κακεῖνοι ἐπεπόνθεισαν, ἐμακάριζον, 2 ὅτι δὲ οὐ βλάπτουσι προηδικημένοι, ηὐχαρίστουν καὶ τοῦ διενεχθῆναι χάριν ἐδέοντο. 3 ἀνθ' ὧν πυριφλεγῆ στυλὸν, ὁδηγὸν μὲν ἀγνώστου ὁδοιπορίας, ἥλιον δὲ ἀβλαβῆ φιλοτίμου ξενιτείας παρέσχες. 4 ἄξιοι μὲν γὰρ ἐκεῖνοι στερηθῆναι φωτὸς καὶ φυλακισθῆναι ἐν σκότει, οἱ κατακλείστους φυλάξαντες τοὺς υἱούς σου, δι' ὧν ἤμελλε τὸ ἄφθαρτον νόμου φῶς τῷ αἰῶνι δίδοσθαι. 5 Βουλευσαμένους δ' αὐτοὺς τὰ τῶν ὁσίων ἀποκτεῖναι νήπια καὶ ἐνὸς ἐκτεθέντος	¹ For your holy ones, however, there was a very great light. The Egyptians, who could hear them but not see them, called them fortunate because they had not suffered too; ² they thanked them for doing no injury in return for previous wrongs and asked forgiveness for their past ill-will. ³ In contrast to the darkness, you gave your people a pillar of blazing fire to guide them on their unknown journey, a mild sun for their ambitious migration. ⁴ But well those others deserved to be deprived of light and imprisoned in darkness, for they had kept in captivity your children, by whom the incorruptible light of the Law was to be given to the world. ⁵ As they had resolved to kill the infants of the holy ones, and as	1 أَمَّا قَدِيسُوكَ فَكَانَ عِنْدَهُمْ نُورٌ عَظِيمٌ، وَكَانَ أَوْلُوكَ يَسْمَعُونَ أَصْوَاتَهُمْ بَغِيرَ أَنْ يَبْصُرُوا أَشْخَاصَهُمْ، وَيَغْبِطُونَهُمْ عَلَى أَنَّهُمْ لَا يَقَاسُونَ مِثْلَ حَالِهِمْ، 2 وَيَشْكُرُونَهُمْ عَلَى أَنَّهُمْ لَا يُؤْذُونَ، الَّذِينَ قَدْ ظَلَمُوهُمْ وَيَسْتَغْفِرُونَهُمْ مِنْ مَعَادَاتِهِمْ لَهُمْ. 3 وَبِإِزَاءِ ذَلِكَ جَعَلْتَ لَهُمْ لَهْؤْلَاءَ عَمُودَ نَارٍ، دَلِيلًا فِي طَرِيقٍ لَمْ يَعْرِفُوهُ، شَمْسًا لِنُورِكَ الضِّيَافَةِ الْكَرِيمَةِ لَا أَذَى بِهَا. 4 أَمَّا أَوْلُوكَ فَكَانَ جَدِيرًا بِهِمْ أَنْ يَفْقَدُوا النُّورَ، وَيَحْبِسُوا فِي الظُّلْمَةِ، لِأَنَّهُمْ حَبَسُوا بَنِيكَ الَّذِينَ بِهِمْ سَيَمْنَحُ الدَّهْرُ نُورَ شَرِيعَتِكَ الْغَيْرِ الْفَانِي. 5 وَلَمَّا اتَّعَمَرُوا أَنْ يَقْتُلُوا أَطْفَالَ
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τέκνου καὶ σωθέντος, εἰς ἔλεγχον τὸ αὐτῶν ἀφείλω πληθος τέκνων καὶ ὁμοθυμαδὸν ἀπώλεσας ἐν ὕδατι σφοδρῶ. 6 ἐκεῖνη ἡ νύξ προεγνώσθη πατράσιν ἡμῶν, ἵνα ἀσφαλῶς εἰδότες οἷς ἐπίστευσαν ὅρκους ἐπευθυμήσωσι. 7 προσεδέχθη δὲ ὑπὸ λαοῦ σου σωτηρία μὲν δικαίων, ἐχθρῶν δὲ ἀπώλεια· 8 ὥ γὰρ ἐτιμωρήσω τοὺς ὑπεναντίους, τοῦτο ἡμᾶς προσκαλεσάμενος ἐδόξασας. 9 κρυφῇ γὰρ ἐθυσίαζον ὅσοι παῖδες ἀγαθῶν καὶ τὸν τῆς θειότητος νόμον ἐν ὁμονοίᾳ διέθεντο τῶν αὐτῶν ὁμοίως καὶ ἀγαθῶν καὶ κινδύνων μεταλήψεσθαι τοὺς ἀγίους, πατέρων ἤδη προαναμέλποντες αἶνους. 10 ἀντήχει δ' ἀσύμφωνος ἐχθρῶν βοή, καὶ οἰκτρὰ διεφέρετο θρηνουμένων παίδων· 11 ὁμοίᾳ δὲ δίκη δοῦλος ἅμα δεσπότη κολασθεὶς καὶ δημότης βασιλεῖ τὰ αὐτὰ πάσχων, 12 ὁμοθυμαδὸν δὲ πάντες ἐν ἐνὶ ὀνόματι θανάτου	of those exposed only one child had been saved, you punished them by carrying off their horde of children and by destroying them all in the wild water. ⁶ That night had been known in advance to our ancestors, so that, well knowing him in whom they had put their trust, they would be sure of his promises. ⁷ Your people thus were waiting both for the rescue of the upright and for the ruin of the enemy; ⁸ for by the very vengeance that you exacted on our adversaries, you glorified us by calling us to you. ⁹ So the holy children of the good offered sacrifice in secret and with one accord enacted this holy law: that the holy ones should share good things and dangers alike; and forthwith they chanted the hymns of the ancestors. ¹⁰ In echo came the discordant cries of their enemies, and the pitiful wails of people mourning for their children could be heard from far away. ¹¹ One and the same punishment had struck slave and master alike, and now commoner and king had the	القديسين، وعرض واحد منهم لذلك ثم خلص، عاقبتهم أنت بإهلاك جمهور أولادهم، ثم دمرتهم جميعاً في الماء الغامر. 6 وتلك الليلة قد أُخبر بها آبائنا من قبل، لكي تطيب نفوسهم، لعلمهم اليقين ما الأقسام التي يثقون بها. 7 ففاز شعبك بخلاص الصديقين وهلاك الأعداء. 8 فإن الذي عاقبت به المقاومين، هو الذي جذبتنا به إليك ومجدتنا. 9 فإن القديسين بني الصالحين كانوا يذبحون خفية، ويوجبون على أنفسهم شريعة الله هذه أن يشترك القديسون في السراء والضراء على السواء. وكانوا يرنمون بتسابيح الآباء، 10 وقد رفع الأعداء جلبة أصواتهم بالبكاء والنحيب على أطفالهم. 11 وكان قضاء واحد على العبد والمولى، وضربة واحدة نالت الشعب والمملك.
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νεκρούς εἶχον ἀναριθμήτους· οὐδὲ γὰρ πρὸς τὸ θάψαι οἱ ζῶντες ἦσαν ἱκανοί, ἐπεὶ πρὸς μίαν ροπὴν ἢ ἐντιμότερα γένεσις αὐτῶν διέφθαρτο. 13 πάντα γὰρ ἀπιστοῦντες διὰ τὰς φαρμακείας ἐπὶ τῷ τῶν πρωτοτόκων ὀλέθρῳ, ὡμολόγησαν Θεοῦ υἱὸν λαὸν εἶναι. 14 ἡσύχου γὰρ σιγῆς περιεχούσης τὰ πάντα καὶ νυκτὸς ἐν ἰδίῳ τάχει μεσαζούσης, 15 ὁ παντοδύναμός σου λόγος ἀπ' οὐρανῶν ἐκ θρόνων βασιλειῶν ἀπότομος πολεμιστῆς εἰς μέσον τῆς ὀλεθρίας ἤλατο γῆς, 16 ξίφος ὃ ξὺν τὴν ἀνυπόκριτον ἐπιταγὴν σου φέρων, καὶ στάς ἐπλήρωσε τὰ πάντα θανάτου· καὶ οὐρανοῦ μὲν ἤπτετο, βεβήκει δ' ἐπὶ γῆς. 17 τότε παραχρῆμα φαντασίαι μὲν ὀνείρων δεινῶς ἐξετάραξαν αὐτούς, φόβοι δὲ ἐπέστησαν ἀδόκητοι, 18 καὶ ἄλλος ἄλλαχῇ ριφεῖς ἡμίθνητος δι' ἣν ἔθνησκεν αἰτίαν ἐνεφάνιζεν· 19 οἱ γὰρ ὄνειροι θορυβήσαντες αὐτοὺς τοῦτο	same sufferings to endure. 12 Struck by the same death, all had innumerable dead. There were not enough living left to bury them, for, at one stroke, the flower of their offspring had perished. 13 Those whose spells had made them completely incredulous, when faced with the destruction of their first-born, acknowledged this people to be child of God. 14 When peaceful silence lay over all, and night had run the half of her swift course, 15 down from the heavens, from the royal throne, leapt your all- powerful Word like a pitiless warrior into the heart of a land doomed to destruction. Carrying your unambiguous command like a sharp sword, 16 it stood, and filled the universe with death; though standing on the earth, it touched the sky. 17 Immediately, dreams and gruesome visions overwhelmed them with terror, unexpected fears assailed them. 18 Hurlled down, some here, some there, half dead, they were able to say why they were	12 وَكَانَ لِكُلِّهِمْ أَجْمَعِينَ أَمْوَاتٌ لَّا يُحْصُونَ قَدْ مَاتُوا مِيتَةً وَاحِدَةً، حَتَّىٰ إِنَّ الْأَحْيَاءَ لَمْ يَكْفُوا لِدْفَنِ الْمَوْتَى، إِذْ فِي لَحْظَةٍ أُبِيدَ نَسْلُهُمُ الْأَعَزُّ. 13 وَبَعْدَ أَنْ أَبَوْا بِسَبَبِ السَّحْرِ أَنْ يُؤْمِنُوا بِشَيْءٍ، اعْتَرَفُوا عِنْدَ هَلَاكِ الْأَبْكَارِ بِأَنَّ الشَّعْبَ هُوَ ابْنُ لِلهِ. 14 وَحِينَ شَمَلَ كُلُّ شَيْءٍ هَدُوءُ السَّكُوتِ، وَانْتَصَفَ مَسِيرُ اللَّيْلِ، 15 هَجَمَتْ كَلِمَتُكَ الْقَدِيرَةُ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مِنَ الْعُرُوشِ الْمَلَكِيَّةِ عَلَى أَرْضِ الْخَرَابِ بِمَنْزِلَةِ مُبَارِزٍ عَنِيفٍ، 16 وَسَيْفٍ صَارِمٍ يُمِضِي قَضَاءَكَ الْمَحْتُمِ؛ فَوَقَّفَ وَمَلَأَ كُلَّ مَكَانٍ قَتْلًا، وَكَانَ رَأْسُهُ فِي السَّمَاءِ وَقَدَمَاهُ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ. 17 حِينَئِذٍ بَلْبَلَتْهُمْ بَغْتَةً أَحْيِلَةُ الْأَحْلَامِ بَلْبَلَةً شَدِيدَةً، وَغَشِيَتْهُمْ أَهْوَالٌ مُفَاجِئَةٌ. 18 وَكَانَ كُلُّ وَاحِدٍ عِنْدَ صَرَعهِ بَيْنَ حَيٍّ وَمَيِّتٍ يَعْلَنُ لِأَيِّ سَبَبٍ يَمُوتُ،
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προεμήνυσαν, ἵνα μὴ
 ἄγνοοῦντες δι' ὃ κακῶς
 πάσχουσιν ἀπόλωνται. 20
 Ἦψατο δὲ καὶ δικαίων
 πεῖρα θανάτου, καὶ
 θραῦσις ἐν ἐρήμῳ ἐγένετο
 πλήθους. ἀλλ' οὐκ ἐπὶ
 πολὺ ἔμεινεν ἡ ὀργή· 21
 σπεύσας γὰρ ἀνὴρ
 ἄμεμπτος προεμάχησε τὸ
 τῆς ἰδίας λειτουργίας
 ὄπλον, προσευχὴν καὶ
 θυμιάματος ἐξιλασμὸν
 κομίσας, ἀντέστη τῷ θυμῷ
 καὶ πέρας ἐπέθηκε τῇ
 συμφορᾷ, δεικνὺς ὅτι σὸς
 ἐστι θεράπων. 22 ἐνίκησε
 δὲ τὸν ὄχλον οὐκ ἰσχυρὶ τοῦ
 σώματος, οὐχ ὅπλων
 ἐνεργείᾳ, ἀλλὰ λόγῳ τὸν
 κολάζοντα ὑπέταξεν,
 ὅρκους πατέρων καὶ
 διαθήκας ὑπομνήσας. 23
 σωρηδὸν γὰρ ἦδη
 πεπτωκότων ἐπ' ἀλλήλων
 νεκρῶν, μεταξὺ στάς,
 ἀνέκοψε τὴν ὀργὴν καὶ
 διέσχισε τὴν πρὸς τοὺς
 ζῶντας ὁδόν. 24 ἐπὶ γὰρ
 ποδήρους ἐνδύματος ἦν
 ὅλος ὁ κόσμος, καὶ
 πατέρων δόξαι ἐπὶ
 τετραστίχου λίθου γλυφῆς,
 καὶ μεγαλωσύνη σου ἐπὶ

dying;

¹⁹ for the dreams that had troubled them had warned them why beforehand, so that they should not perish without knowing why they were being afflicted.

²⁰ Experience of death, however, touched the upright too, and a great many were struck down in the desert. But the Retribution did not last long,

²¹ for a blameless man hurried to their defence. Wielding the weapons of his sacred office, prayer and expiating incense, he confronted Retribution and put an end to the plague, thus showing that he was your servant.

²² He overcame Hostility, not by physical strength, nor by force of arms; but by word he prevailed over the Punisher, by recalling the oaths made to the Fathers, and the covenants.

²³ Already the corpses lay piled in heaps, when he interposed and beat Retribution back and cut off its approach to the living.

²⁴ For the whole world was on his flowing robe, the glorious names of the Fathers engraved on the four rows of stones, and your Majesty on the diadem on

19 لَأَنَّ الْأَحْلَامَ الَّتِي أَقْلَقْتَهُمْ،
 أَنْبَأَتْهُمْ بِذَلِكَ لَعَلَّا يَهْلِكُوا، وَهُمْ
 يَجْهَلُونَ مَجْلِبَةَ هَلَاكِهِمْ
 20 وَالصَّدِيقُونَ أَيْضًا مُسْتَهْمُونَ
 مَحَنَةِ الْمَوْتِ، وَوَقَعَتِ الضَّرْبَةُ
 عَلَى جَمِّ مِنْهُمْ فِي الْبَرِيَّةِ، لَكِنَّ
 الْغَضَبَ لَمْ يَلْبَثْ طَوِيلًا،
 21 لَأَنَّ رَجُلًا لَا عَيْبَ فِيهِ بَادَرَ
 لِحِمَايَتِهِمْ؛ فَبَرَزَ بِسِلَاحِ خِدْمَتِهِ
 الَّذِي هُوَ الصَّلَاةُ وَالتَّكْفِيرُ
 بِالْبَخُورِ، وَقَاوَمَ الْغَضَبَ وَأَزَالَ
 النَّازِلَةَ؛ فَتَبَيَّنَ أَنَّهُ خَادِمُكَ.
 22 فَانْتَصَرَ عَلَى الْجَمْعِ لَا بِقُوَّةِ
 الْجَسَدِ وَلَا بِأَعْمَالِ السِّلَاحِ،
 وَلَكِنَّهُ بِالْكَلَامِ كَفَّ الْمُعَاقِبَ،
 مُذَكِّرًا الْأَقْسَامَ وَالْعُهُودَ لِلآبَاءِ.
 23 فَإِنَّهُ إِذْ كَانَ الْقَتْلَى يَتَسَاقَطُونَ
 جَمَاعَاتٍ، وَقَفَ فِي الْوَسْطِ
 فَحَسَمَ السُّخْطَ وَقَطَعَ الْمَسْلُوكَ
 إِلَى الْأَحْيَاءِ،
 24 لِأَنَّهُ كَانَ عَلَى ثَوْبِهِ السَّابِغِ
 الْعَالَمِ كُلِّهِ، وَأَسْمَاءُ الْآبَاءِ الْمَجِيدَةِ
 مَنْقُوشَةٌ فِي أَرْبَعَةِ أَسْطُرٍ مِنْ
 الْحِجَارَةِ الْكَرِيمَةِ، وَعَظَمْتُكَ عَلَى
 تَاجِ رَأْسِهِ،

الأصباح التاسع عشر

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εὕρωσι θάνατον. 6 ὅλη γὰρ ἡ κτίσις ἐν ἰδίῳ γένει πάλιν ἄνωθεν διευτυποῦτο ὑπηρετοῦσα ταῖς σαῖς ἐπιταγαῖς. ἵνα οἱ σοὶ παῖδες φυλαχθῶσιν ἀβλαβεῖς. 7 ἡ τὴν παρεμβολὴν σκιάζουσα νεφέλη, ἐκ δὲ προϋφεστῶτος ὕδατος ξηρᾶς ἀνάδυσις γῆς ἐθεωρήθη, ἐξ ἐρυθρᾶς θαλάσσης ὁδὸς ἀνεμπόδιστος καὶ χλοηφόρον πεδῖον ἐκ κλύδωνος βιαίου· 8 δι' οὗ πανεθνὶ διηλθον οἱ τῇ σῇ σκεπαζόμενοι χειρὶ, θεωρήσαντες θαυμαστὰ τέρατα. 9 ὥς γὰρ ἵπποι ἐνεμήθησαν καὶ ὥς ἄμνοι διεσκίρτησαν αἰνοῦντές σε, Κύριε, τὸν ρυόμενον αὐτούς. 10 ἐμέμνηντο γὰρ ἔτι τῶν ἐν τῇ παροικίᾳ αὐτῶν, πῶς ἀντὶ μὲν γενέσεως ζώων ἐξήγαγεν ἡ γῆ σκνῖπα, ἀντὶ δὲ ἐνύδρων ἐξηρεύξατο ὁ ποταμὸς πλῆθος βατράχων. 11 ἐφ' ὅστερῳ δὲ εἶδον καὶ νέαν γένεσιν ὀρνέων, ὅτι ἐπιθυμία προαχθέντες ἠτήσαντο ἐδέσματα τρυφῆς· 12 εἰς γὰρ	extraordinary death. ⁶ For the whole creation, submissive to your commands, had its very nature re-created, so that your children should be preserved from harm. ⁷ Overshadowing the camp there was the cloud; where there had been water, dry land was seen to rise; the Red Sea became an unimpeded way, the tempestuous waves, a green plain; ⁸ sheltered by your hand, the whole nation passed across, gazing at these amazing prodigies. ⁹ They were like horses at pasture, they skipped like lambs, singing your praises, Lord, their deliverer. ¹⁰ For they still remembered the events of their exile, how the land had bred mosquitoes instead of animals and the River had disgorged millions of frogs instead of fish. ¹¹ Later they were to see a new way for birds to come into being, when, goaded by greed, they demanded something tasty, ¹² and quails came up out of the sea to satisfy them.	6 وَكَانَتْ جَمِيعُ الْخَلْقِ، كُلِّ وَاحِدَةٍ فِي جَنْسِهَا، تَسْتَبْدِلُ طَبْعَهَا وَتَخْدُمُكَ بِحَسَبِ مَا رُسِمَ لَهَا، لِكَيْ يَحْفَظَ بَنُوكَ بِغَيْرِ ضَرٍّ. 7 فَالْغَمَامُ ظَلَّلَ الْمَحَلَّةَ، وَمِمَّا كَانَ قَبْلًا يَغْمُرُ بِالْمِيَاهِ، بَرَزَتْ أَرْضٌ يَابِسَةٌ، طَرِيقٌ مَمْهَدٌ فِي الْبَحْرِ الْأَحْمَرِ، وَمَرَجٌ أَخْضَرٌ فِي قَعْرِ لُجَّةٍ عَظِيمَةٍ. 8 هُنَاكَ عَبَرَتِ الْأُمَّةُ كُلُّهَا، وَهُمْ فِي سِتْرِ يَدِكَ يَرَوْنَ عَجَائِبَ الْآيَاتِ، 9 وَرَتَعُوا كَالْخَيْلِ، وَوَثَبُوا كَالْحُمَلَانِ مُسَبِّحِينَ لَكَ، أَيُّهَا الرَّبُّ مَخْلَصَهُمْ، 10 مُتَذَكِّرِينَ مَا وَقَعَ فِي غُرْبَتِهِمْ، كَيْفَ أَخْرَجْتَ الْأَرْضَ الدُّبَابَ بَدَلًا مِنْ نَتَاجِ الْحَيَوَانِ، وَفَاضَ النَّهْرُ بِجَمٍّ مِنَ الضَّفَادِعِ عَوْضَ الْأَسْمَاكِ. 11 وَأَخِيرًا رَأَوْا صَنْفًا جَدِيدًا مِنَ الطَّيْرِ، حِينَ حَثَّتْهُمْ شَهَوَتُهُمْ أَنْ يَتَطَلَّبُوا طَعَامًا لَذِيذًا، 12 فَصَعَدَتِ السَّلَوَى مِنَ الْبَحْرِ تَسْلِيَةً لَهُمْ. أَمَّا الْخَطَاةُ فَتَزَلَّ عَلَيْهِمْ
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παραμυθίαν ἀνέβη αὐτοῖς
ἀπὸ θαλάσσης
ὀρυγομήτρα. 13 καὶ αἱ
τιμωρίαι τοῖς ἁμαρτωλοῖς
ἐπῆλθον οὐκ ἄνευ τῶν
προγεγονότων τεκμηρίων
τῇ βίᾳ τῶν κεραυνῶν·
δικαίως γὰρ ἔπασχον ταῖς
ιδίαις αὐτῶν πονηρίαις, καὶ
γὰρ χαλεπωτέραν
μισοξενίαν ἐπετήδευσαν.
14 οἱ μὲν γὰρ τοὺς
ἀγνοοῦντας οὐκ ἐδέχοντο
παρόντας, οὗτοι δὲ
εὐεργέτας ξένους
ἐδουλοῦντο. 15 καὶ οὐ
μόνον, ἀλλ' ἢ τις ἐπισκοπῇ
ἔσται αὐτῶν, ἐπεὶ ἀπεχθῶς
προσεδέχοντο τοὺς
ἄλλοτριους· 16 οἱ δὲ μετὰ
ἐορτασμάτων εἰσδεξάμενοι
τοὺς ἤδη τῶν αὐτῶν
μετεσχηκότας δικαίων,
δεινοῖς ἐκάκωσαν πόνοις.
17 ἐπλήγησαν δὲ καὶ
ἀορασίᾳ, ὥσπερ ἐκεῖνοι ἐπὶ
ταῖς τοῦ δικαίου θύραις, ὅτε
ἀχανεῖ περιβληθέντες
σκότει, ἕκαστος τῶν αὐτοῦ
θυρῶν τὴν δίοδον ἐζήτει. 18
δι' ἑαυτῶν γὰρ τὰ στοιχεῖα
μεθαρμοζόμενα, ὥσπερ ἐν
ψαλτηρίῳ φθόγγοι τοῦ
ρυθμοῦ τὸ ὄνομα

¹³ On the sinners, however,
punishments rained down not
without violent thunder as early
warning; and they suffered what
their own crimes had justly
deserved since they had shown
such bitter hatred to foreigners.

¹⁴ Others, indeed, had failed to
welcome strangers who came to
them, but the Egyptians had
enslaved their own guests and
benefactors.

¹⁵ The sinners,
moreover, will certainly be
punished for it, since they gave
the foreigners a hostile
welcome;

¹⁶ but the latter, having given a
festive reception to people who
already shared the same rights
as themselves, later
overwhelmed them with terrible
labours.

¹⁷ Hence they were struck with
blindness, like the sinners at the
gate of the upright, when,
yawning darkness all around
them, each had to grope his way
through his own door.

¹⁸ A new attuning of the
elements occurred, as on a harp
the notes may change their
rhythm, though all the while
preserving the same tone; and
this is just what happened:

الانتقام، مع ما له من العلائم
القديمة التي هي شدة الصواعق.
وإنما أصابهم ما استحققت
فواحشهم،

13 إِذْ كَانَتْ مُعَامَلَتُهُمْ لِلْأَضْيَافِ
أَشَدَّ كَرَاهِيَةً. فَإِنَّ أَوْلَئِكَ أَبَوًا أَنْ
يَقْبَلُوا غُرَبَاءَ لَمْ يَعْرِفُوهُمْ، أَمَّا
هَؤُلَاءِ فَاسْتَعْبَدُوا أَضْيَافًا قَدْ
أَحْسَنُوا إِلَيْهِمْ.

14 وَفَضْلًا عَنْ ذَلِكَ فَإِنَّ عَلَيْهِمْ
اِفْتِقَادًا آخَرَ، إِذْ إِنْ أَوْلَئِكَ إِنَّمَا
قَبِلُوا قَوْمًا أَجْنَبِيَّينَ كَرِهًا،

15 أَمَّا هَؤُلَاءِ فَإِنَّهُمْ قَبِلُوا أَضْيَافًا
بِاحْتِفَالٍ وَفَرَحٍ، وَأَشْرَكُوهُمْ فِي
حَقُوقِهِمْ، ثُمَّ أَسَاءُوا إِلَيْهِمْ
بِصُنُوفِ الْعَذَابِ الشَّدِيدِ.

16 فَضَرَبُوا بِالْعَمَى مِثْلَ أَوْلَئِكَ
الْوَاقِفِينَ عَلَى بَابِ الصِّدِّيقِ، الَّذِينَ
شَمَلَتْهُمْ ظُلْمَةٌ هَائِلَةٌ؛ فَجَعَلَ كُلُّ
مِنْهُمْ يَتَلَمَسُ طَالِبًا مَدْخَلَ بَابِهِ.

17 إِذْ تَغَيَّرَتْ نِسْبُ الْعَنَاصِرِ
بَعْضُهَا إِلَى بَعْضٍ، كَمَا يَتَغَيَّرُ فِي
الْعُودِ اسْمُ صَوْتٍ مِنَ اللَّحْنِ،
وَالصَّوْتُ بَاقٍ، وَذَلِكَ بَيْنَ لِمَنْ
تَأْمَلُ تِلْكَ الْحَوَادِثَ.

διαλλάσσουσι, πάντοτε μένοντα ἥχῳ, ὅπερ ἐστὶν εἰκάσαι ἐκ τῆς τῶν γεγονότων ὀψεως ἀκριβῶς. 19 χερσαῖα γὰρ εἰς ἔνυδρα μετεβάλλετο, καὶ νηκτὰ μετέβαινεν ἐπὶ γῆς· 20 πῦρ ἴσχυεν ἐν ὕδατι τῆς ἰδίας δυνάμεως, καὶ ὕδωρ τῆς σβεστικῆς δυνάμεως ἐπελανθάνετο· 21 φλόγες ἀνάπαλιν εὐφθάρτων ζώων οὐκ ἐμάραναν σάρκας ἐμπεριπατούντων, οὐδὲ τηκτὸν κρυσταλλοειδὲς εὐτηκτον γένος ἀμβροσίας τροφῆς. 22 Κατὰ πάντα γάρ, Κύριε, ἐμεγάλυνας τὸν λαόν σου καὶ ἐδόξασας καὶ οὐχ ὑπερεῖδες ἐν παντὶ καιρῷ καὶ τόπῳ παριστάμενος.	¹⁹ land animals became aquatic, swimming ones took to the land, ²⁰ fire reinforced its strength in water, and water forgot the power of extinguishing it; ²¹ flames, on the other hand, did not char the flesh of delicate animals that ventured into them; nor did they melt the heavenly food resembling ice and as easily melted. ²² Yes, Lord, in every way you have made your people great and glorious; you have never failed to help them at any time or place.	18 فَلَا أَرْضِيَّاتٌ تَحَوَّلَتْ إِلَى مَائِيَّاتٍ، وَالسَّابِحَاتُ سَعَتْ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ، 19 وَالنَّارُ كَانَتْ لَهَا قُوَّةٌ فِي الْمَاءِ، أَشَدُّ مِنْ قُوَّتِهَا الْغَرِيزِيَّةِ، وَالْمَاءُ نَسِيَ قُوَّتَهُ الْمُطْفِئَةَ. 20 وَبِالْعَكْسِ اللَّهْيَبُ لَمْ يُؤْذِ جِسْمَ السَّرِيعِ الْفَسَادِ مِنَ الْحَيَوَانِ، إِذْ كَانَ يَمْشِي فِيهِ وَلَمْ يَذِبِ الطَّعَامَ السَّمَائِيَّ السَّرِيعَ الذُّوْبَانِ كَالْجَلِيدِ، لِأَنَّكَ يَا رَبُّ عَظَّمْتَ شَعْبَكَ فِي كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، وَمَجَّدْتَهُ وَلَمْ تَهْمَلْهُ، بَلْ كُنْتَ مُؤَاوِزًا لَهُ فِي كُلِّ زَمَانٍ وَمَكَانٍ.
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تم سفر الحكمة يليه سفر يشوع بن سيراخ